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Bhojshala dispute: SC orders Friday prayers at alternative site

Bench declines to pass order restoring status quo, will examine dispute in detail

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 14

THE SUPREME Court declined to pass any order restoring status quo at the disputed Bhojshala-Kamal Maula mosque complex in Madhya Pradesh and directed that Muslim worshippers be provided an alternative space adjacent to the premises for Friday prayers until it examines the dispute in detail. On May 15, the Madhya Pradesh High Court had held that



The Bhojshala-Kamal Maula mosque complex in MP

the complex has a religious character as a temple, following
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

After nearly 2 decades, author Taslima Nasrin set for Kolkata return

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, July 14

ALMOST TWO decades after she was forced to leave Kolkata following protests against her writing, Bangladesh-born author Taslima Nasrin is set to appear in a public event in the city on August 1.

The programme at the city's Rabindra Sadan cultural centre is being organised by three organisations: Secular Mission, Paschimbonger Jonno (For West Bengal), and Human Rights



Author Taslima Nasrin

Beyond Frontiers. The organisers said Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari and author Shirshendu Mukhopadhyay were
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

TRUMP U-TURN: NO HORMUZ TRANSIT FEE, WANT TRADE, INVESTMENT DEALS INSTEAD

Another Indian killed as Iran hits UAE tankers in Hormuz

MEA summons Iran's deputy chief of mission, lodges protest

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 14

AS THE US and Iran stepped up attacks and battled for control over the Strait of Hormuz, two UAE-flagged oil tankers with Indian seafarers came under fire from Tehran on Tuesday, leaving one dead and 10 injured. The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) summoned the Iranian Deputy Chief of Mission and lodged a strong protest.



A vessel at the Strait of Hormuz, as seen from Oman, Tuesday.
REUTERS RELATED REPORTS, P 16

(Reuters adds: US President Donald Trump stepped back from a proposal to charge a 20% transit fee to guard the strait, saying he would instead seek investment deals with Gulf states. US forces carried
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Dashboard to monitor seafarers, liaison officers for families, says Govt

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, July 14

WITH ANOTHER Indian seafarer being killed in the US-Iran conflict, the Centre on Tuesday ordered a series of measures, including an operational dashboard to track every Indian on every vessel — regardless of the country it belongs to — and a dedicated liaison officer for every seafarer who is killed or injured, to act as the “single

point of contact” for the affected family.

The decisions were taken at an inter-ministerial meeting chaired by Sarbananda Sonowal, Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, soon after the fresh attacks on two oil tankers with Indian crew on Tuesday.

According to sources in the ministry, nine Indian seafarers have died, one is presumed
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Amid new US tariff plan, Govt prohibits import of goods made using forced labour

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, July 14

THE COMMERCE and Industry Ministry on Tuesday prohibited the import of goods manufactured using forced labour, weeks after the United States Trade Representative (USTR) proposed 12.5 per cent tariffs on India linked to the issue.

The US had launched two Section 301 probes on India in March and subsequently proposed fresh tariffs on June 3 after the outcome of its first investigation found that India failed to “effectively enforce” a forced labour import prohibition, which had purportedly hurt US commerce. The outcome of the second investigation relating to excess capacity is yet to be released.

The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), in an order dated July 13, has inserted a new paragraph in the Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) regarding “forced labour”, stating that the

E. EXPLAINED

Global benchmark

Experts say the notification on forced labour indicates India is tightening its domestic legal framework to match global benchmarks. The move could strengthen its position in trade negotiations and discussions on market access.

import of goods produced or manufactured, “wholly or in part”, through the use of forced labour is “prohibited”.

“The Central Government may, from time to time, specify, by notification, the goods whose import shall be prohibited under this paragraph, having regard to the findings of such enquiry or such other material as it may consider appropriate. The procedure for
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY

Ruling Party's big hearts are busy — bleeding for the poll-bound heartland.



SATLUJ DIRECTOR: DO NOT ABDUCT KHALRA AGAIN... LET US TELL HIS STORY PAGE 8

Tough measures on table as Railways seeks to curb linen theft in AC coaches

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, July 14

A DAY after *The Indian Express* reported that about 1.27 crore linen items were stolen from AC coaches of the Indian Railways over four years, Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw directed officials to come up with a reform to curb such theft.

Turning to top Railway officials at a press conference Tuesday on Railways’ “52 reforms in 52 weeks” initiative, Vaishnaw referred to *The Indian Express*



The Indian Express report on linen theft published Monday

report and sought a timeline for the issue to be resolved. The officials responded by

seeking two months to formalise a way to fix the issue.

On Monday, *The Indian Express* reported that between January 2022, when bedroll services had fully resumed after the pandemic, and May 2026, at least 1.27 crore bedroll pieces were stolen from the AC coaches. A linen bedroll consists of two bedsheets, a blanket, a pillow, a pillow cover, and a face towel.

The report was based on Right to Information (RTI)
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Happening today

● INDIA-UK FTA takes effect. It entails wide sectoral coverage and deep reduction in both tariff and non-tariff barriers.

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THE BIG PICTURE

‘Counsel, you are on mute’

THE WORLD OF VIRTUAL COURTS
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SCAN TO KNOW MORE



A videograb of the house in Bikaner's Loonkaransar

Gangster Godara's Bikaner house found demolished; probe on

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, July 14

A "SIGNIFICANT" portion of gangster Rohit Godara's ancestral home in Bikaner's Loonkaransar was demolished by "unknown persons", Rajasthan Police said on Tuesday.

No one was present at the house when the incident took place overnight, they said.

Loonkaransar Circle Officer (CO) Ranveer Singh told *The Indian Express* on Tuesday, "We were informed about the incident around 9 am today. The Station House Officer (SHO) himself went to the spot. It seemed that the demolition had been carried out with a JCB machine. A significant portion has been damaged."

According to Singh, local residents claimed they had "no knowledge" of how and when the action was carried out, because "the *dhanis* (hutments) are far away from each other". "They (locals) also said that the noise may have been drowned out by the noise of air coolers in the area." Police are analysing CCTV footage and other evidence to find and track the people behind the razing.

Godara's parents, Sant Das and Gita, as well brother, Hanu-

man Swami, and Hanuman's wife and children, used to live in the house. However, none of them were there at the time of the demolition. Officials said Godara's parents and brother are lodged in jail in different extortion cases.

While Hanuman was arrested in an extortion case in Sri Ganganagar, his parents were allegedly involved in another case in Ratangarh in Churu. Godara is said to be absconding, allegedly in Azerbaijan now. Police said that Hanuman's wife had left the home around "10-12 days" ago with her children, asking neighbours to take care of the crops in their absence. "No report has been received yet. We will take further action once we get a report," Singh said.

Last week, Godara's name had figured in 'Operation Hard-ball' — the coordinated action against Indian crime syndicates by law enforcement from the US, Canada, and Europe, leading to the arrest of 24 people connected to crimes including Hardeep Singh Nijjar's assassination, as per the US Department of Justice (DOJ). Godara had been designated as the European leader of the "Lawrence Bishnoi enterprise", it said.

Paramedical student stabbed to death at Pilibhit Medical College

Express News Service
Lucknow, July 14

A 22-YEAR-OLD paramedical student was stabbed to death allegedly by a fellow student at the Pilibhit Medical College and Hospital on Tuesday morning.

Kashish Patel, a first-year student pursuing a Diploma in CT Scan Technology at the government medical college, was rushed to a hospital in Bareilly, where she succumbed to injuries. Police arrested the accused, Sagar Singh, 24, a student from X-ray technician course.

Police suspect the attack could be the fallout of a "one-sided relationship", though the exact motive is still being probed. "We are investigating whether the attack was premeditated," a police officer involved in the investigation said.

According to the police, Kashish was working in the CT scan room on Tuesday morning when Sagar came with a knife. "The two spoke briefly before an

argument broke out. Sagar then pulled out the knife and attacked her. Kashish tried to flee, but he chased her and stabbed her," said the officer.

A staff nurse, 32-year-old Nidhi Sehgal, who was present in the CT scan room, intervened to stop the assault and suffered a minor knife injury to her hand.

"After Kashish collapsed, Sagar tried to flee but was overpowered by hospital security and other staff before our team arrived," the officer added.

"Police have registered a murder case against Sagar. Both Sagar and Kashish were first-year paramedical students. Kashish was a resident of Bareilly, while Sagar hails from Kanpur," Superintendent of Police (Pilibhit) Sukirti Madhav said.

PTI adds: The principal of the medical college, DrSangeeta Aneja, said a three-member committee been constituted to look into sequence of events, security arrangements, and circumstances leading to attack.

Court sentences convict in 2020 IS-linked terror conspiracy to 7 yrs in jail

Express News Service
Bengaluru, July 14

A SPECIAL court in Bengaluru on Tuesday convicted and sentenced an Islamic State-linked terror conspiracy accused to seven years in prison after he pleaded guilty to all the charges brought against him.

Mohammed Haneef, 31, a resident of Bengaluru who was accused of being a member of the Al Hind module, was sentenced on eight counts of terrorism, one of conspiracy and one of illegal procurement of guns.

He is one the 20 accused named in the NIA chargesheet in the 2020 case of Islamic State terror plot, which emerged in 2019-2020 spanning the southern states of Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. The Al Hind module allegedly radicalised youth at the instance of foreign handlers and notorious terror suspects, said the police.

"The offender/Accused No.9 (Haneef) is sentenced to undergo rigorous imprisonment for a period of seven (7) years and is liable to pay a fine of Rs.5,000/ for the offence

punishable under Section 17 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967. In default of payment of the fine, he shall undergo rigorous imprisonment for a period of two months," the special court said.

Haneef, who originally hails from Mandya, pleaded guilty to charges of raising funds for terrorist activities, organising terrorist camps, recruitments, harboring terrorists, being a member of a terrorist group, under the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act, 1967.

In September 2025, Haneef had chosen to plead not guilty. He changed his mind earlier this year and told the special court that he wanted to plead 'guilty' to the charges. The special court accepted the guilty plea to convict and sentence Haneef.

"The substantial sentences imposed on the offender / Accused No.9 shall run concurrently. The period of detention undergone by the offender / Accused No.9 is in judicial custody shall be set off against term of imprisonment imposed, as provided under Section 428 of the CrPC," the special court ruled.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Another Indian killed

out waves of attacks for the third night in a row after Tehran said it had closed the strait, prompting Trump on Monday to reinstate a blockade of Iranian shipping and propose the fee.

But just a little under five hours before the fee had been due to come into effect, Trump said the strait was open to all shipping traffic except that of Iran. "Based on highly productive conversations with Middle East leadership, I have decided to replace the 20% United States reimbursement fee with trade and investment deals that the various Gulf states will be making into the United States," he said in a post on Truth Social.)

Condemning Tuesday's attacks, India called for an immediate cessation of violence, particularly the targeting of commercial shipping and civilian infrastructure, and restoration of "free and unimpeded navigation and commerce through international waterways in the region".

The incident came days after an Indian seafarer went missing as a Cyprus-flagged ship transiting the Strait of Hormuz was targeted by Iran on Sunday. On

Tuesday, his family in Pune said his death had been confirmed.

"India is deeply concerned by the attacks on two vessels, MT Al Bahiyah and MT Mombasa, during their transit through the Strait of Hormuz today," the MEA said in a statement.

It said of the total 46 crew members on the two vessels, 30 were Indians. "Of the 12 Indian nationals onboard *MT Al Bahiyah*, one has tragically lost his life and another has been injured," the MEA said. "Of the 18 Indian nationals onboard *MT Mombasa*, nine have sustained injuries, including two who are reported to be seriously injured," it said.

(Agencies add: The defence ministry of the UAE said on social media that *MT Mombasa* and *MT Al Bahiyah* were "targeted by two Iranian cruise missiles while transiting the southern shipping lane of the Strait of Hormuz, within Omani territorial waters". Abu Dhabi National Oil Company's shipping arm ADNOC L&S said the vessels had sustained "significant damage".

The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) said that

Railways

applications filed with all 69 divisions of the Railways. Replies were obtained from 54 divisions across 16 of the 18 Railway zones. The data showed a 56% rise in such thefts from 2022 to 2025.

The investigation also showed that the theft cost bedrol contractors an estimated Rs 104.51 crore over the past four years -- money that coach attendants employed by the contractors say is mostly deducted from their salaries.

The Railways is now exploring multiple options to tackle the problem, senior officials told this

newspaper Tuesday.

Granting the Railway Protection Force (RPF) the power to arrest offenders is one possible measure under consideration, an official said. This will be a part of the Railways' "52 reforms in 52 weeks", which was launched at the beginning of the year to make key structural and procedural changes in the national carrier.

"This issue is complex and will require wider consultation. It is difficult to track these passengers. We have to do something to disincentivise it. One way is to grant the RPF the power to arrest such offenders. Along with this, RPF can be asked to search a suspicious passenger's luggage if the linen is not re-

turned," the official said.

Under the Railway Property (Unlawful Possession) Act, theft of railway towels, bedsheets or blankets is a non-bailable offence. In September 2015, the Railway Board had prescribed that linen distribution staff advise passengers to hand over used linen at least 30 minutes before disembarking. It also directed that a watch be kept on regular defaulters with suitable counselling, training and penalties.

Currently, the primary response to curb linen theft across divisions has been to counsel the bedrol attendants to remain vigilant, monitor linen closely, ensure prompt collection, and stay alert during duty hours.

Dashboard

dead, and seven have been injured since the start of the West Asia crisis. There have been 29 incidents of attacks on vessels carrying Indian seafarers -- four involving Indian-flagged vessels and the rest involving foreign-flagged vessels.

According to the ministry, each liaison officer will serve as "the single point of contact for families, coordinating medical updates, travel documentation, family assistance, repatriation, seafarers welfare fund support, outstanding wages, contractual entitlements and other compensations".

Sonowal also ordered real-time vessel-by-vessel monitoring and round-the-clock coordination by his ministry, in association with the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), Indian Navy, Directorate General of Shipping (DGS), Indian Missions in Iran and Oman, and other maritime stakeholders.

He directed the Secretary, Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, and the Director General of Shipping to establish a comprehensive operational

dashboard to account for every Indian on every vessel, irrespective of their flags, operating in the Persian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz and Gulf of Oman.

The dashboard is aimed at providing real-time information on vessel position, ownership, cargo, crew strength, crew welfare, threat assessment, intended voyage, next port of call, and the availability of food, fuel, medicines and communication facilities.

Officials would work closely with Indian Missions in Iran, Oman, the United Arab Emirates and other affected countries in the region to obtain verified and real-time information regarding navigational safety, coastal state advisories, route status, port-of-refuge arrangements, hospitals, medical evacuation, repatriation procedures, management of mortal remains, and the status of ongoing investigations.

The meeting underlined that vessel movement through the affected region should only be undertaken after a fresh threat assessment, the professional judgement of the ship's Master, and close coordination with competent maritime authorities.

Sonowal told officials that

shipowners, vessel managers, and Recruitment and Placement Service Licence (RPSTL) agencies employing Indian seafarers in the region should be immediately made to provide compliance reports and a confirmation that no Indian seafarer was being compelled to sail without adequate information, protection and support.

"The Government of India has communicated with all the multilateral forums of the International Maritime Organisation (IMO) and also with the representatives of the concerned flag administration involved in the multiple incidents that contravened international conventions and fundamental requirements of seafarers' security and safety, and protection of right of innocent passage for merchant vessels. We will continue to make every effort to ensure resolution of the issues and remain committed to all stakeholders in this trying and challenging time," Sonowal said.

Criticising the "irresponsible, unwarranted and uncalled for attacks" on cargo ships, he assured Indian seafarers and their families that the government was committed to assisting them at all costs.

Bhojshala dispute

which the Muslim appellants sought an interim stay and the restoration of status quo ante. On Tuesday, a three-judge bench, presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said it will fix the matter for final hearing after two or three weeks.

"Meanwhile... without prejudice to the rights of both sides, it is directed that a separate open space adjacent/ near the subject premises may be provided to the appellant and other members of the Muslim community for offering namaz on Friday between 1-3 pm," the bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said.

"It shall be ensured that no disturbance is caused to both sides in the performance of religious rites. The arrangement shall be ad-hoc in nature and subject to the final outcome of the appeal," the bench said.

The bench also directed that "structural alterations" to the complex, "if proposed by the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI), will not be carried out without leave of this court".

During the hearing Tuesday, CJI Kant said, "These are very sensitive matters".

"What is happening inside Court No. 1 can unnecessarily create a wrong impression, a wrong message. We should be extremely careful in using any expressions... The state's helplessness in maintaining law and order has been noted. That's why we just thought whatever system is there, if we can list it after 10-15 days before a bench," he said.

As the appellants pressed for restoring the status quo, as it existed before the High Court judgment, the CJI said: "Please be over-cautious. Let us not pass any order that leads to the creation of tension and a law-and-order crisis at the spot. We are ready to hear the matter on a day-to-day basis... Resolve the issue finally... It's a matter where both sides, we will request, should have patience."

The medieval structure in Madhya Pradesh's Dhar has long been the subject of competing claims. While Hindus consider the ASI-protected complex as a temple dedicated

to Goddess Vagdevi, Muslims regard it as the Kamal Maula mosque. Under a 2003 arrangement, Hindus performed puja at the complex on Tuesdays and Muslims offered namaz on Fridays.

In 2024, the Madhya Pradesh High Court ordered an ASI survey of the complex, observing that its nature and character need to be "demystified and freed from the shackles of confusion". The ASI report stated that the "existing structure was made from the parts of earlier temples".

Appearing for the Muslim appellants, Senior Advocate A M Singhvi said the situation which prevailed before the High Court decision should continue. "India is a country with layers of history... If you go behind layers, there is no end. If it's eye for an eye, everybody will be blind. That's the rationale behind the 1991 (Places of Worship) Act. It makes an exemption for Ayodhya....," he said.

Singhvi said some of the disputed sites may have had a temple. "For instance, the Jain temple under Qutub Minar... As a Jain, I was taken there and shown something. But that is no reason to go back on layers of history till time starts... There is the larger public interest of 1991 Act to be preserved. Otherwise, there will be chaos in this country. There will be no end to it," he said.

Singhvi pointed out that there is an Allahabad High Court order, which said somebody must start a survey of the Taj Mahal. "This can go on endlessly," he submitted while arguing that the Madhya Pradesh High Court order "does a sleight of hand in interpreting the Act".

Singhvi said there is a continuous history of 700 years of daily namaz at the spot and also cited records, which name the mosque. He described the 2003 arrangement as an "excellent example of communal harmony".

Senior Advocate Huzefa Ahmadi, also appearing for the Muslim parties, said, "Today, we have been completely ousted. And it's completely unfair." Ahmadi contended that

the matter raised several questions, including reliance on ASI reports, and said that those who prepared were not even cross-examined.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who appeared for the Madhya Pradesh government, said that two months had passed since the High Court order and there are several administrative problems in restoring status quo.

"Several things have happened... Right now, your Lordships' suggestion that it may be heard at the earliest, we can assist on that. We have ensured that both communities keep calm... Once you come after two months and seek status quo ante, administrative problems come."

When one of the parties pointed out that the plea had been filed much earlier, the bench said no urgent hearing was sought on it. The CJI said the earlier interim arrangement was before the matter was decided by the High Court but now, rightly or wrongly, there is a judicial determination of the character of the place.

Ahmadi said, "We have been elbowed out, and we are sought to be presented with a fait accompli... In all fairness, is it proper to oust out one community, which has been there for many, many years?"

The CJI, too, stressed the importance of appealing without delay in such matters. "In some matters, even a day of delay can have serious consequences," he said. Justice Bagchi also pointed out that some of the directions in the Madhya Pradesh High Court judgment have already been given effect to.

Appearing for the Hindu parties, Senior Advocate Guru Krishnakumar opposed the prayer for restoring status quo ante in brief submissions.

The arguments also briefly touched upon the High Court's direction to the Central government to bring back the Goddess Saraswati idol from the London Museum.

Justice Bagchi said, "We do not want, as a constitutional court, to make any comment about all the artefacts in foreign museums of colonised countries, but at least one Indian court has issued a mandamus to the government to bring back an idol."

Forced labour

conducting an enquiry by the DGFT into the use of forced labour. The provisions of this notification shall come into effect after the expiry of 30 days from the date of its publication in the Official Gazette," the notification said.

A senior Government official told *The Indian Express* that there are already certain provisions within existing regulations to take care of issues like forced labour, but the July 13 notification is "explicitly stating" it.

The official said that the use of "suo motu" makes it clear that we are not dependent on a complaint to take action. "We had implicit powers, but we have made it explicit, and it may have implications in the discussions that are going on," the official said, hinting at the ongoing trade deal negotiations with US.

While India has sought the review of proposed US tariffs of 12.5% citing inconsistencies in its Section 301 investigation, Joint Secretary in the Department of Commerce Brij Mohan Mishra, during a public hearing last week, said the country takes the elimination of forced labour seriously as a constitutional obligation, and as a matter of international law and principle.

According to international standards, forced labour means all work or service that is exacted from a person under threat of penalty and not offered volun-

tarily.

Manoj Mishra, Partner and Tax Controversy Management Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat, said the introduction of a prohibition on imports of goods produced through forced labour marks a significant policy shift in the trade framework.

While India has so far relied largely on labour and criminal laws to address forced labour domestically, the FTP now incorporates a dedicated trade measure aligned with international standards under the ILO Forced Labour Convention, Mishra said.

"Announced amid heightened global scrutiny of supply chains and the ongoing USTR Section 301 investigation, the move strengthens India's regulatory framework on ethical sourcing. However, its practical impact will largely depend on the enquiry mechanism and implementation framework to be prescribed under the Handbook of Procedures, which will determine the scope of compliance for importers," Mishra said.

Agneshwar Sen, Trade Policy Leader, EY India, said the latest move is a pragmatic piece of trade diplomacy. "The 30-day delayed commencement and DGFT-administered enquiry process gives India room to calibrate scope and pace. It converts this instrument into a reciprocal, rules-based instrument po-

tentially usable in future BTAs, that is arguably WTO-consistent," Sen said.

Former trade officer and head of think tank GTRI, Ajay Srivastava, said the measure will take effect in 30 days, adding that the order establishes a legal framework rather than an immediate import ban. Its effectiveness will depend on how the government conducts investigations, the evidence required to establish forced labour, and the products it ultimately targets, he said. "The US has launched Section 301 investigations covering about 60 economies, including India, and has proposed a 12.5% tariff on imports from India and most other countries under review. The EU and Pakistan are proposed to face a lower 10% tariff after introducing domestic measures to prohibit imports made with forced labour. Against this backdrop, India's notification signals that it is strengthening its domestic legal framework in line with international standards, a step that could strengthen its position in future trade negotiations and market-access discussions," he said.

According to GTRI, US authorities consider products such as cotton, textiles, solar-panel polysilicon, seafood, metals, batteries and electronics vulnerable to forced-labour risks, particularly when linked to China's Xinjiang region. Yet, the US and the EU continue to import many such products from China, underscoring the challenges of enforcing forced-labour rules.

Taslima

also expected to attend the event. This will be Nasrin's first public appearance in Kolkata since 2007, when protests against her book *Dwikhondito* (Split: A Life) forced her to leave the city she had made her home since her exile from Bangladesh a decade earlier.

"The event is organised by three organisations, including ours. It will feature Nasrin's poems and songs. The CM will also be present," Mohit Roy of "Paschimbonger Jonno" told *The Indian Express*.

"Kolkata is known as the cultural capital of India. She (Nasrin) was driven away from here because of protests by fundamentalists and that pained us. We tried to organise her visit during the previous government, but were unsuccessful. This time, we approached Adhikari, who assured us that proper security arrangements would be made. We then contacted the

author and she agreed to visit Kolkata and participate in the event. She will speak about her years in exile, recount the circumstances under which she had to leave Kolkata, and read her poems," said Osman Mallick of Secular Mission. Mallick, an advocate at the Calcutta High Court, is one of the nine members of the panel set up by the West Bengal government to submit a report on the implementation of the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in the state.

Nasrin has been at the centre of controversy over her writings for decades. Her writing primarily focuses on women's rights, gender equality, patriarchal norms, and domestic and structural violence that women face. Her best-known novel, *Lajja* (*Shame*), published in 1993, brought her international recognition. The book chronicled the persecution of a fictional Hindu family in Bangladesh in the aftermath of the Babri Masjid's demolition.

Facing death threats and protests, Nasrin fled Bangladesh

in 1994 and lived in exile across Europe, including Germany, and North America. During this period, Sweden granted her citizenship. She subsequently found refuge in Kolkata, the city closest to her home culturally.

In 1998, Nasrin published *Meyebela* (*My Bengali Girlhood*), the first volume of her autobiography. However, her troubles began in 2003 after *Dwikhondito*, the second volume of her autobiography, was published. The book contained passages that were deemed offensive to religious sentiments. On November 18, 2003, the Calcutta High Court approved an injunction against the publication of the book after poet Sayed Hasmat Jalal filed a defamation suit against Nasrin. Ten days later, the Buddhadeb Bhattacharya-led Left Front government banned the book, concerned that it might cause communal discord. However, the publisher challenged the ban. In September 2005, the High Court struck it down, ruling that the book did not intend

to outrage religious feelings and declaring the government's move unjustified.

By then, Nasrin had received a temporary residence permit from the Union government (in 2004) and moved to Kolkata, where she regularly wrote columns for Bengali newspapers. However, the tension over the book continued to simmer. In June 2006, Syed Noor-ur-Rehman Barkati, then the imam of Kolkata's Tipu Sultan Mosque, announced a reward for anyone who "blackened" Nasrin's face. Several organisations also demanded that she leave the country. In August 2007, while attending an event in Hyderabad related to the Telugu translation of her novel *Shodh* (*Revenge*), Nasrin was roughed up by alleged members of the AIMIM.

Though the controversial pages were retracted that year, in November 2007, the tensions spilt over onto the roads as demonstrations organised by the All India Minority Forum led to road blockades and incidents of

arson in parts of Kolkata. To bring the situation under control, the Left Front government led by Buddhadeb Bhattacharya called in the Army to help restore order. Facing political pressure and worried about the situation spiralling out of control if Nasrin remained in the city, the government pressured her to leave, with senior CPI(M) leaders such as Biman Bose publicly calling on her to move elsewhere to allow the political situation in Kolkata to cool down.

Nasrin moved to New Delhi and in March 2008, she left the country, staying away for at least two years. Nasrin continued to live in India, receiving a residence permit. In 2024, the author publicly thanked Union Home Minister Amit Shah after her request to extend the permit was granted hours after she put up a post on social media expressing concern about her legal status.

While the Trinamool Congress that succeeded the Left Front government avoided the

issue despite periodic demands from members of civil society, the BJP has sought to project her as a symbol of resistance against religious orthodoxy. The BJP has claimed that Nasrin's ordeal was the result of the "appeasement politics" of the Left and the TMC.

"The CPI(M) buckled under pressure from religious fundamentalists. They bowed their head to such forces and drove out Taslima Nasrin. Thereafter, Mamata Banerjee engaged in appeasement. Now the BJP government is here. The terror of fundamentalists has ended. Now there is freedom of speech for everyone. West Bengal is for everyone and the door is wide open," said BJP's Rajya Sabha MP Rahul Sinha.

Urban Development Minister Agnimitra Paul told reporters, "Under the leadership of CM Suvenud Adhikari, Taslima Nasrin is returning (to Kolkata). The government is helping her. This is a proud moment for us. I spoke to her this morning."



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, with Education Minister Ashish Sood, unveils the official Mascot of the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026, in New Delhi on Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Govt set to distribute bicycles to Class 9 girls from July-end

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 14

IN SOME good news for Class IX girl students studying in Delhi government schools, the BJP government is set to launch its free bicycle scheme and begin distributing cycles to around 1.3 lakh students by the end of July, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The 'free bicycle scheme' for Class IX girl students of government schools was one of the major announcements made by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta in the Delhi Budget presented for 2026-27.

According to officials, the procurement process for the bicycles has already begun, and batches of cycles have started arriving. "Batches of cycles have already started coming and distribution to Class IX girl students will begin by the end of this month. It will start from schools located in CM Gupta's Shalimar Bagh constituency and will subsequently be extended to all other constituencies," said an official.

After implementation of the scheme, students entering class

IX can avail it's benefits every academic year, said an official.

"The procurement process for the bicycles was started around two months ago with the beginning of the new academic year, and the government's plan was to distribute them after the summer vacation. Now, as schools have reopened after the holidays, the work to distribute cycles has started. The CM has given directions to prepare a list of schools and students. Work on organising an event for launching the scheme is also underway. A formal date for the launch of the scheme will soon be announced," said a senior official.

The government has allocated a budget of Rs 90 crore for the free bicycle scheme.

While announcing the scheme during the presentation of the Delhi Budget this year in March, Gupta had said, "Many girl students drop out of school because of lack of connectivity. We want our girl students to study and become independent. So, to empower them, we have decided to provide free bicycles to girl students of Class IX of Delhi Government schools..."

Single-machine tech introduced to repair potholes under 5 mins

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 14

TO REPAIR potholes under five minutes, the Delhi government has introduced a 'Spray, Injection, Patching' technology, a fully mechanised and single-machine method, officials said on Tuesday. The PWD on Tuesday launched trials of the technology in Central Delhi.

"Today, I witnessed a trial of 'Spray, Injection, Patching' technology, a fully mechanised solution for permanent pothole repairs. The technology offers faster, more durable and all-weather road maintenance with minimal inconvenience to commuters," said PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh.

He said that based on trial, the wider adoption of the method will be explored to strengthen Delhi's road maintenance system. "Our focus is to embrace proven, modern technologies that deliver better roads, greater efficiency and a smoother travel experience for the people of Delhi," he added.

As per officials, the new technology involves cleaning of potholes with high-velocity air using a machine, application of



Parvesh Sahib Singh at a trial on using the technology to fix potholes. X/@P_SAHIBSINGH

a bonding coat of bitumen emulsion and injection of emulsion-coated aggregate under high pressure. The compaction is achieved through the injection velocity, eliminating the need for rolling, they said.

Officials said a single machine with a small crew can repair around 100-150 potholes per day. The mobile, self-contained operation also ensures minimal traffic disruption, with no requirement for lane closures. "Each pothole can be repaired in two to five minutes and the road can be opened for traffic immediately after the repair," said an official. The technology offers durable and permanent repairs as the emulsion bonds the filling material to the pothole walls, officials added.

ANKIT SHARMA'S MURDER DURING 2020 NORTHEAST DELHI RIOTS

'Savage and relentless assault' on IB staffer, says court on Tahir Hussain's conviction

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 14

FINDING THAT the prosecution had proved its case "beyond reasonable doubt," the Delhi court convicted former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain of the murder of IB staffer Ankit Sharma (26) during the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots. The court said Hussain was part of a "heavily armed" mob that abducted Sharma before killing him in what it described as a "savage and relentless assault upon his person."

Relying on the testimony of five eyewitnesses, the court found that prosecutors had proved beyond reasonable doubt that Hussain was part of a large mob that had gathered at Chand Bagh Pulia around 5 pm on February 25, 2020.

"...accused Tahir Hussain at around 5.00 p.m on 25.02.2020, was a member of a large crowd and unlawful assembly which, with animus against Hindus, had assembled at Chand Bagh Pulia with a common object to commit rioting, loot, arson and to cause damage to the property and person of the members of the Hindu community," ASJ Praveen Singh said.

The finding was based on the testimony of five eyewitnesses: Pradeep Verma, a parking lot operator; Aakash, a tea vendor and long-time Khajuri Khas resident; his brother Bharat; Deepak Pradhan, a Chandu Nagar resident; and advocate Priyanka Gaur, who lived in Moonga Nagar on Karawal Nagar Road.

The court also ruled that any "prudent" person who is a part of an unlawful assembly knows that in such clashes members of the opposite community could be killed.

"Hence, any prudent person, being a member of this assembly, would have known...in such clashes which were based upon communal hatred, it was likely that a person belonging to the opposite community could be killed," ASJ Singh said.

Key witnesses

The court relied on the testimony of five eyewitnesses who said they saw Tahir Hussain in the mob. One of them deposed in court that "Tahir Hussain was...stating that Hindus had vandalised and burnt Muslim houses and shops and had molested Muslim women, and therefore the 'Kafirs' should be taught a lesson".

The witness went further,



Ankit Sharma

stating that the mob "assaulted a boy (Sharma) with knives, dandas (sticks), swords, bricks and iron rods and threw him into the drain from the opposite side."

Another eyewitness said that he saw a 20 to 25 people assaulting a young boy while Hussain was standing in front of the mosque, saying "maaro maaro". He also deposed that the body was thrown into a drain. Another eyewitness said that Hussain "was joining the mob off and on and, in between, would return to his house". Another witness said she allegedly saw Tahir in the mob, which was carrying dandas, petrol bombs and stones.

Police witness

The prosecution examined 91 witnesses. Other than the five eyewitnesses, it also cited two police witnesses (then head constables). The court noted that there were "considerable improvements" in the statements of these two witnesses who claimed to have been on duty at Main Karawal Nagar road on February 25, 2020.

"...However, when asked, whether these facts which they had added...instead of putting forward an explanation for not stating these facts, they either simply admitted not stating these facts, or stated that they did not remember whether these facts were stated or not. The improvements made by these witnesses are not minor variations, embellishments or small additions..." ASJ Singh said in his judgement.

Defence arguments

Defence lawyers challenged the testimonies of witnesses saying they were either "chance" witnesses — discovered by the Investigating Officer by chance and who identified the accused by chance — or "stock witnesses", who were witnesses in multiple FIRs. The court, however, rejected these arguments.

"...merely because they were the passers-by, that too at a place not far away from their house, these witnesses cannot be termed as chance witnesses to strike at their credibility."

Before Hussain's conviction, judicial panel visited scene of crime

Alok Singh & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 14

ON MAY 11, the lanes of Chand Bagh — one of the worst-affected localities during the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots — witnessed heavy police deployment. This is where IB staffer Ankit Sharma was allegedly murdered in February 2020.

A judicial panel led by Additional Sessions Judge Praveen Singh of the Karkardooma Court arrived, accompanied by court staff, defence and prosecution counsel, local police and Crime Branch officers — who probed

the case — to visit the scene of the crime in order to verify the testimonies of witnesses. "We had seen a similar development during the 2002 Gujarat riots. Judicial panels usually visit the site to understand the topography and verify witness testimonies," an officer said.

The officer added that the panel visited all the locations from where Sharma was allegedly picked up and dragged by the mob. The team also visited Gali 6 where Sharma lived in Khajuri Khas. The drain below the Chand Bagh Pulia, where his body was found, is around 200 m away from his street.

Court relies on the testimony of key witness to convict four and acquit two

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 14

WHILE THE trial court found prosecution witness Pradeep Verma to be credible despite his being cited as a witness in nine other riot-related FIRs, it relied on his testimony to convict four accused, including Tahir Hussain, but declined to rely on the same to convict two others who were acquitted.

Verma, who ran a parking lot at Khajuri Khas, claimed to have witnessed the rioting in the area on February 25, 2020, when IB staffer Ankit Sharma was killed. The defence argued that Verma was running an illegal parking lot and was therefore under police pressure to depose falsely. Verma denied the allegation.

Also, while Verma initially denied seeing Hussain in the mob, he later said that he felt Hussain was near Chand Bagh Pulia, though he did not actually see him among the mob.

While Hussain argued that Verma was the only prosecution witness "who could have witnessed the incident" and relied on him as a "truthful and natural witness", the other accused contended that his testimony could not be relied upon. The judge also noted, "I find it interesting to note that as per one set of accused, (Verma) is one of the most natural witness who could have clearly seen this incident, whereas to some other accused, he not only is a chance and partisan, but he could not have been in a position to see anything..."

The court, however, rejected that Verma could not be termed either a "chance" or a "partisan" witness. It observed



At least 53 people were killed in the riots in 2020. FILE

that although he had been cited as a prosecution witness in several riot-related cases, there was no material to show that he had been a witness in any criminal case before the 2020 riots.

Tahir Hussain

The court examined seven prosecution eyewitnesses to establish Hussain's involvement — two being police eyewitnesses, who were deemed to be not credible by the court, and the remaining being public witnesses, one of which was Verma.

The court recorded that Verma had "turned hostile" and not supported the prosecution's case that Hussain was part of the unlawful assembly or instigating the mob. Ultimately, it relied on Verma's testimony, along with that of others to hold that the prosecution's case against Hussain has been proved for charges of rioting and murder, while acquitting him for the charges of instigation, abetment, exhorting the mob and criminal conspiracy.

Nazim and Kasim

In their case, the court had to solely rely on Verma's testimony after it found another witness to be unreliable. Nazim and Kasim

were identified by Verma, who said Nazim was carrying a knife in his hand on February 25.

The court relied on Verma's identification of Nazim and Kasim as members of the mob, despite his having mistakenly identified another accused, Hassan, as Nazim. It concluded, "Merely because a confusion appeared and it was allowed to remain by the defence as well as the prosecution, the original identification of accused Nazim by this witness cannot be wished away." It convicted both for rioting and murder.

Javed

Again, the court noted that the only witness to establish the accused as a member of the mob was Verma. Javed had questioned Verma's credibility because he had earlier identified him in another riot case (FIR 98/2020) lodged at Khajuri Khas police station, in which he was later discharged.

The court, however, reasoned that the discharge order reveals that "there is not a single sentence written about the credibility of this witness", and rather the discharge had followed owing to Verma being the sole witness in the case..." The

court held Javed to be guilty of rioting and murder.

Firoz

The court declined to rely solely on Verma's testimony against Firoz. Firoz had contended that "due to personal reasons", Verma had falsely implicated him. Initially, Verma had denied knowing Firoz. But Firoz had said that during Verma's testimony in riot case (FIR 98/2020), Verma had deposed that he had known Firoz "for about 10-12 years..."

The court concluded that Verma "may have deposed against him due to ulterior motives". It held that it will be unsafe to convict Firoz solely on the basis of Verma's testimony, without corroborative evidence. The court acquitted Firoz of all charges.

Muntazim alias Musa

The prosecution solely relied on Verma's testimony to prove its case against Muntazim. He was identified by Verma more than two years after the incident, in November 2022. Owing to the delay, the court held that the accused's arrest did not inspire confidence and acquitted him of all charges.

BJP demands apology from Kejriwal, Congress

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, July 14

A DAY after former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain was convicted in the case of murder of IB officer Ankit Sharma during the 2020 northeast Delhi riots, the BJP Tuesday demanded an apology from AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal.

Blaming Congress for the

riots too, the saffron party demanded an "unconditional apology" from Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi, alleging that they indulged in "culture politics" and "appeasement politics".

A Delhi court Monday convicted Hussain and four others in the case. Hussain, who was an AAP councillor at the time of the incident, was later sus-

pended by the party when his name surfaced in the case.

"The biggest culprit here is Arvind Kejriwal on whose behalf this happened. Attempts were made to cover up the case and political protection was given to Tahir Hussain," Bhatia said, adding that Hussain's "ties" with Kejriwal is intact even today.

"Sonia Gandhi is equally

culpable, as is Rahul Gandhi. After the Citizenship Amendment Act was passed, they created an atmosphere of confusion by claiming that Muslims would lose their citizenship," Bhatia alleged. "When a conspiracy was being hatched for the riots, Sonia Gandhi said 'Yeh aar paar ki ladai hai' (it's a do-or-die battle)," he said.



Tahir Hussain.

In his order, the judge observed that one of the witnesses had never claimed that she saw the incident while standing inside the gate of Gali 6.

The judge, while referring to the testimony of the witness, said in his order: "...the fact that she is a witness to the riots of

25.02.2020 has not been challenged. What has been challenged is that, as she was inside the gate of her gali, she could not have seen the Chand Bagh Pulia. It is contended that this fact was established during my visit to the scene of crime. However, it is to be noticed that the witness had never stated in her examination-in-chief that she had witnessed this incident from inside the gate of Gali 6."

"Her statement that she had come up to the gate of her gali and then seen the incident cannot be interpreted to mean that she remained inside the gate. Her exact position near the

gate... was never clarified. Nor did she depose that the gate... remained closed throughout her visits. Rather, she stated that it was open and that only during her last visit did she find it closed," the order added.

During the inspection, the court found that even from inside the gate of Gali 6, Hussain's house and the parking area of prosecution witness Pradeep Verma were visible. "From the corner of the street where it joins Main Karawal Nagar Road, Chand Bagh Pulia is clearly visible. Even otherwise, the witness had not stated that she had seen accused Tahir Hussain at Chand

Bagh Pulia. She stated that she had seen him near his (Sharma's) house, which was close to Chand Bagh Pulia. During the scene of crime inspection, I observed that even if one stood inside the gate of Gali 6, Hussain's house and Pradeep's parking area were visible, and one could see up to 5-10 m before the starting point of the Pulia," the order said.

Observing that the rioting had spread across that area, the court held that the mob would have been within the witness's field of vision. "If Tahir Hussain was present with the mob near his house, she could very well have seen him," it added.

● EMILY EDEN TRAVELLED FROM CALCUTTA TO LAHORE IN THE 1830s, CAPTURING RAJAS, SERVANTS, AND OTHERS

India through art of a remarkable early Victorian woman, now on display in Capital

Trisha Mukherjee
New Delhi, July 14

ALMOST 200 years ago, an aristocratic English lady of remarkable talents travelled across North India, recording her experiences in words and in art.

Emily Eden, a correspondent of Queen Victoria and the sister of a Governor-General of India, sketched Indian princes, soldiers, and servants. Her artworks featured a number of Indian cities — among them Calcutta, Lahore, Punjab, Simla, and Kabul. But she ignored Delhi — for she found "nothing to see" in the city that had then recently passed under the rule of the last Mughal king Bahadur Shah Zafar.

The art of Emily Eden is

now back in the city that she barely found worth sketching. An exhibition titled Princes & People of India: Portraits by Emily Eden, featuring almost 30 hand-coloured lithographs and the Eden Family Archives, both now part of the DAG collection, is ongoing at DAG on Janpath until August 1.

Eden travelled from Calcutta, the capital of British India until 1911, to Lahore in the company of her brother George Eden, the 1st Earl of Auckland and Governor-General of India from 1836 to 1842, and their sister Fanny. The siblings began their journey in 1837, their 1,700-mile

trip ending in the court of Maharaja Ranjit Singh in Lahore. It was the intention of the Governor-General to cement an alliance with the founder of the Sikh Empire against the Barakzais of Kabul, and as a hedge against the expansionism of Russia's Tsar Nicholas I.

"Emily Eden's first portrait in India was that of a young student from Hindu College in Calcutta (which has evolved into today's Presidency University)," art historian Mary Ann Prior, who has curated the exhibition, said. The image of the young man in his jewels and ornate turban and robe speaks to the prosperity of Calcutta in the



A Group of Thibet Tartars (left) and The Raja of Putteealla, on his state elephant. EXPRESS

early 19th century.

The Punjab provided Emily with the richest repository of inspirational subjects. "Her portrait of Ranjit Singh (painted

towards the end of the Maharaja's life) captures simplicity, frailty, yet authority," Prior said.

In between Calcutta and Lahore, Emily drew a lot else —



portraits of the Raja of Nahun (present-day Himachal Pradesh), a prince in Simla, and the Raja of Patiala ("Putteealla") on his elephant, as well as fakirs,

jemadaars, servants of nawabs, and "Thibet Tartars" (traders from Tibet). But Delhi did not find a place in her sketchbook.

A fort that forms the indistinct backdrop to her portrait of the Maratha nobleman Raja Hindu Rao, brother-in-law of Maharaja Daulat Rao Scindia of Gwalior, could have been Delhi, for Hindu Rao had made the capital of Mughal India his home after retirement — but such structures were scattered across the subcontinent at the time. Emily did not say where she had sketched the man whom she described as "an unintelligent, native aide-de-camp".

Indeed, Emily saw the city in which she spent close to a week, as a ghost town. In a letter to her nephew William Eden, she

wrote that around the city, "there is nothing to be seen but gigantic ruins of mosques and palaces".

The British artists who painted India before Emily — Thomas Daniell and his nephew William Daniell, William Hodges, and several others — were all men, and they largely painted landscapes of the "picturesque" country they ruled. In their paintings, humans appeared only incidentally — Emily, by contrast, made people her primary subjects.

"She is likely one of the first British women artists whose works you're seeing. She was niche, having access to Indian royalty, which was unique. Few women had that experience," Prior said.



Fight, Forward

AFTER DEFEATING the TMC in West Bengal, BJP now seems to be picking up fights with smaller parties. State BJP chief Shamik Bhattacharya's recent remark that both Subhas Chandra Bose and his brother Sarat Chandra Bose had ignored Syama Prasad Mookerjee's request to raise their voice against torture of Hindus in Bangladesh has irked the All India Forward Bloc leadership. Bhattacharya had also termed the Forward Bloc leaders as "goons". Forward Bloc leaders alleged that BJP MLAs were trying to change the names of the roads named after Netaji. Finding no response from the state BJP leadership, Forward Bloc general secretary G Devrajan has now written to BJP national president Nitin Nabin, warning against attempts to "diminish Netaji's legacy".

Bypoll Bid

NOT JUST a dedicated office, the BJP has listed a battery of star campaigners in its bid to retain Bihar's Bankipur seat, vacated by party chief Nitin Nabin following his nomination to the Rajya Sabha, in the July 30 bypoll. Nabin represented the Bankipur segment for four consecutive terms between 2010 and 2025. While Nabin is the top star campaigner, the others on the list include Union ministers Giriraj Singh and Nityanand Rai, Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, among others. The names of Bhojpuri actor-singers Manoj Tiwari and Pawan Singh are also there.

Late night meet with Fadnavis fuels buzz over NCP(SP)'s shift

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, July 14

POLITICAL SPECULATION over Sharad Pawar's next move intensified late Tuesday after senior leaders from both factions of the NCP held a closed door meeting with Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, just days after NCP (SP) leaders indicated that a section of the party favours joining the NDA. Sources informed The Indian Express that NCP (SP) state president Jayant Patil first met Sharad Pawar at his South Mumbai residence, Silver Oak, before heading to meet Fadnavis later in the evening. NCP leaders Sunil Tatkar and Praful Patel, too, held a meeting with CM Fadnavis in the night. The meetings come against the backdrop of a rethink within the NCP (SP) over the party's political direction. Party sources told *The Indian Express* that at least half of its 10 MLAs favour joining the ruling NDA, arguing that remaining in the Opposition has made it difficult to secure development funds and administrative approvals for their constituencies. Jayant Patil had recently conveyed this sentiment to party legislators, saying a significant section of the MLAs was inclined towards the NDA. Sharad Pawar, however, has so far remained silent on the issue and has not publicly indicated which way the party is headed. Tuesday's meetings are the latest in a series of political developments that have kept the possibility of a realignment alive. They also come a day after the ruling NCP received a legal notice from former national secretary Sachchidanand Singh challenging the election of party president Sunetra Pawar.

Ladakh groups slam new hill councils: 'Maximum govt, minimum governance'

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, July 14

THE LADAKH administration's decision to create Autonomous Hill Development Councils (AHDs) in each of the Union Territory's seven districts is likely to face stiff opposition from civil society groups, with both the Apex Body, Leh (ABL) and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) alleging it is aimed at diluting the powers of the proposed representative government for Ladakh under Article 371.

The administration Monday announced that AHDs would be constituted in the five new districts — Drass, Sham, Nubra, Changthang and Zaskar — of the UT. Currently, such councils exist only in Leh and Kargil.

Announcing the decision, Ladakh Chief Secretary Ashish Kundra said the move was in response to long-pending demands from residents of the new districts and would strengthen democratic decentralisation and grassroots governance. Kundra said that following recent discussions between leaders from Ladakh and the Centre, there was broad agreement that a UT-level representative body would be created under a customised framework under Article 371 of the Constitution, drawing from the best features of similar arrangements in other states.

According to the administration, the proposed body would exercise legislative, executive, fi-

Apex Body, Leh says move dilutes powers of representatives; Kargil Democratic Alliance questions timing, intent of move



ABL and KDA leaders following their May 22 meeting with senior MHA officials. They had objected to the proposal to establish a hill council in each district, it is learnt. FILE

nancial and administrative powers, with the framework currently under examination.

However, leaders spearheading the movement for constitutional safeguards in Ladakh said the creation of seven hill councils would weaken, rather than strengthen, representative governance. "This is a plan to dilute the powers of the proposed representative government that is going to take shape under Article 371. If all the powers are going to be given to the hill councils, what will the representative government do? Ladakh does not have such a big

population that you need so much decentralisation," ABL co-chairman Chherring Dorje Lakruk told *The Indian Express*.

The KDA echoed similar concerns, questioning both the timing and intent behind the decision. "This decision has been taken unilaterally. Neither KDA nor ABL has been consulted. Given the history of how things have panned out here, it makes us question the intent. I don't understand how seven hill councils will improve administration when the existing hill councils of Leh and Kargil are toothless at the moment.

These kinds of cosmetic administrative changes are not going to help us. This is a plan for maximum government and minimum governance," KDA co-chairman Sajjad Kargili said.

Reigniting old issue

The announcement also revives an issue that had surfaced during the Centre's ongoing negotiations with Ladakh's civil society groups over constitutional safeguards.

Sources familiar with the discussions said that after the creation of seven districts, the government had informed Ladakh representatives of its proposal to establish a hill council in each district. According to them, both the KDA and the ABL objected to the proposal during their May 22 meeting with senior Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) officials.

The proposal, sources said, was initially recorded in the Minutes of the Meeting (MoM). "Objecting to this and other issues, we refused to sign the MoM. Following this, another MoM was prepared from which this point was removed. We signed that MoM. Now the government has gone ahead and announced it without taking us into confidence," a senior leader from Ladakh said.

The move comes against the backdrop of prolonged negotiations between the Centre and the joint platform of the ABL and KDA over Ladakh's political future after it was carved out as a Union Territory in 2019 follow-

ing the abrogation of Article 370.

The two organisations have jointly been demanding constitutional safeguards, including statehood or a legislative framework under Article 371, protection over land and jobs, and enhanced political representation. Last year they submitted a draft framework to the MHA proposing a representative body with legislative and financial powers.

The latest disagreement also mirrors the distrust that has marked Centre-civil society engagement over the past year. When the Centre announced the creation of five new districts in April, the administration had argued that the reorganisation would improve governance in the geographically vast region by reducing travel distances for citizens, decentralising administration and generating employment through new administrative infrastructure.

The KDA, however, had alleged that the exercise altered the demographic balance by creating five Buddhist-majority districts and only two Muslim-majority districts, describing it as a move that risked fragmenting the political unity forged between Leh and Kargil over their common demands for constitutional safeguards. The creation of new hill councils is now set to become another contentious issue in the continuing negotiations between Ladakh's civil society groups and the Centre over the region's future political structure.

Fodder scam: SC refuses to cancel Lalu Prasad's bail

New Delhi: The Supreme Court Tuesday refused to interfere with a Jharkhand HC order granting bail to RJD chief Lalu Prasad in the Deoghar treasury fodder scam case and asked the HC to decide his appeal against conviction within six months.

"Upon hearing the learned counsels, we are not inclined to interfere with the order particularly since seven years have elapsed since then. The appeals are of 2018, and it will only be appropriate to request the high court to expedite the hearing," a bench of Justices MM Sundresh and PB Varale ordered, hearing the CBI's appeal challenging the HC order. The case relates to the fraudulent withdrawal of Rs 89.27 lakh from the district treasury between 1990 and 1994. ENS

'Committed to combat terror, organised crime': India on gangsters' indictment in Nijjar killing

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 14

IN ITS first remarks since the indictment of jailed gangster Lawrence Bishnoi and Canada's statement on pro-Khalistan separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar's killing, India said on Tuesday that Delhi has consistently maintained that transnational organised crime "posed a serious threat". It also said that "India remains committed to working with our partners in combating terrorism and transnational organised crime..."

Responding to Canadian police's statement that there is "no evidence" to suggest that Indian government officials are involved, Delhi said that the remarks are consistent with the recently unsealed US indictment that attributes responsibility to the members of the Lawrence Bishnoi organised crime group.

Almost three years since Canadian PM Justin Trudeau dropped the bombshell allegation that Canadian security agencies have been actively pursuing credible allegations of a "potential link" between agents of the Government of India and the killing of Nijjar, the US last week charged jailed gangster Bishnoi and his aide Goldy Brar with ordering his assassination.

The latest twist in the case happened after an operation against three criminal gangs involved in a spate of transnational crimes. Named 'Operation

Passport a document to regulate departure of Indian citizens from country: MEA

Divya A
New Delhi, July 14

THE PASSPORT is a document issued by the government to "regulate the departure" of Indian citizens from the country and not a proof of citizenship, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Tuesday.

"An Indian passport is a document that, as per the Passports Act, 1967, is issued by the Government of India to regulate the departure from India of citizens of India," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on Tuesday in response to a question on the legal status of the passport during his weekly briefing. He said less than 8 per cent of Indian citizens currently hold the document.

Amid a raging debate last month on what document establishes citizenship in India in the wake of Special Intensive Revision (SIR) initiated by the Election Commission across the country, senior MEA officials had said that though a

passport is issued only to Indian citizens, it doesn't establish citizenship.

They had earlier described it as a travel document that identifies nationality but doesn't establish citizenship in response to a question whether the passport can be used as proof of citizenship for SIR of electoral rolls.

The remarks triggered sharp reactions from certain opposition parties, including the Congress, which said the government was laying the groundwork to arbitrarily deny citizenship rights to Indians with whom it disagrees.

Sources said citizenship is governed by the Citizenship Act of 1955, while the passport is issued as per the guidelines of the Passport Act, 1967. Citizenship is the domain of the Home Ministry, while the passport is issued by the External Affairs Ministry, they said, adding the passport does not independently prove or confer citizenship.

EC extends SIR in Andhra Pradesh, Haryana by 10 days

Express News Service
New Delhi, Chandigarh, Hyderabad, July 14

THE ELECTION Commission on Tuesday extended the schedule of the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in Haryana and Andhra Pradesh by 10 days, with electors' deadline for submitting enumeration forms now changed from July 14 to July 24 and the publication of the draft roll on July 31 instead of July 21.

As per the new schedule, the house-to-house visits by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will continue till July 24. After that, the draft rolls will be published on July 31, and the claims and objections will be filed between July 31 and August 30. Notices for claims and objections are to be disposed of by September 28, and the final roll is to be published on October 3.

The EC announced the third phase of the SIR covering 16 states and three UTs on May 14. The enumeration phase in

Andhra Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Haryana and Chandigarh started on June 5.

In Haryana, around 36 lakh voters are yet to be cleared, and enumeration forms are still awaited from nearly 2.88 lakh electors. The remaining over 33 lakh voters have been placed in the ASDD (Absent, Shifted, Duplicate or Dead) category.

Haryana Chief Electoral Officer A Sreenivas said enumeration forms have been received from around 1.70 crore electors (82.38% of the state's 2.06 crore registered voters) till 6 pm on Tuesday, and all the forms received have been digitised. "We requested the Election Commission because... We want to ensure that not even a single eligible elector is left out," Sreenivas said.

Andhra Pradesh Chief Electoral Officer Vivek Yadav also sought the extension of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise as 40 lakh enumeration forms (9%) are yet to be collected.

3-LANGUAGE POLICY

Come to us if dismissed, we can reinstate, SC assures teachers

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 14

LEARNING A language never goes waste, the Supreme Court said Tuesday as it sought to assure that it will protect teachers who may face action in case any problem arises with regard to implementation of the CBSE's three-language policy.

"Come to us... If dismissed, we can reinstate," said Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, presiding over a three-judges bench comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana.

The bench was hearing petitions challenging the CBSE's decision to implement the three-language policy from the current academic session.

Appearing for a petitioner, Senior Advocate Shyam Divan told the bench that as per the National Education Policy (NEP), the three-language policy was to be introduced from 2030 but CBSE had advanced it.

Senior Advocate Gopal Saranarayanan said the policy treated English as a non-native language. Justice Bagchi said, "The notification is carrying ahead the constitutional goal of learning Hindi and other Indian languages. Nomenclature may require some relook... Question is can India consider English as indigenous Indian language. At one point Parsi was language of this court, but is it there in the 8th schedule?" The court fixed the matter for hearing on July 22.

{ DR MUSTAFA KAMAL • 1942-2026 }

Farooq Abdullah's brother, ex-minister who balanced politics with medical career, dies

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, July 14

SENIOR NATIONAL Conference leader and uncle of Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, Dr Mustafa Kamal, died on Tuesday evening in Srinagar. The 84-year-old was the younger brother of National Conference (NC) president and former chief minister Farooq Abdullah.

"My father's younger brother, Dr Mustafa Kamal, passed away earlier this evening at Paras Hospital in Srinagar. Uncle Mustafa had been unwell for some months but took a turn for the worse four days ago," CM Omar wrote on X. "He put up a brave fight, holding on against the odds. Doctors and staff treating him were amazing, but Allah called him for his final journey.



Dr Mustafa Kamal died in Srinagar on Tuesday evening

May Allah grant uncle Mustafa the highest place in Jannat."

Son of NC founder Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah, Kamal was a trained medical doctor. He started his political career in 1983 when he was, for the first time, elected as a member of the erstwhile J&K Legislative Council. Immediately after his election as MLC, he was inducted into the Cabinet by his older

brother and then CM, Farooq. After the Farooq government was toppled in 1984 and fresh polls were held in 1987, Kamal successfully contested on a NC ticket from the Tangmarg/Gulmarg Assembly seat. He returned to the Assembly from the constituency for a second consecutive term in 1996. During both these terms, he was inducted into Farooq's Cabinet.

Kamal, who lived in Tangmarg, continued to run his medical clinic even during his political career, earning goodwill from the people of the region. In 2002, Kamal lost the Assembly polls to the People's Democratic Party's Ghulam Hassan Mir. He has not won a poll since. He was an additional secretary in the NC at the time of his death. Kamal often landed in controversies over his statements. In 2019, the BJP de-

manded a sedition case against him for saying the government was behind the 2016 Uri and the 2019 Pulwama attacks.

Communist leader MY Tarigami paid tribute to the leader, saying, "Dr Kamal was known for speaking his mind without hesitation and stayed engaged with political developments over the years... His passing away brings down the curtain on a long political journey."

The NC termed Kamal's death an irreparable loss. "Dr Kamal Sahib devoted decades of his life to public service and to strengthening the ideals and legacy of the NC. His unwavering commitment, principled leadership, and steadfast dedication to the people of Jammu and Kashmir earned him immense respect across political and social spheres," the party said.

EXPRESS special

Pre-poll masterstroke, post-poll burden: Ladki Bahin scheme's Maharashtra journey

Shubhangi Khapre
Mumbai, July 14

TWO YEARS back, the Mahayuti government in Maharashtra, then led by Eknath Shinde, announced the Ladki Bahin Yojana with an eye on the crucial women's votes ahead of the Assembly polls. Under this scheme, eligible women beneficiaries will be entitled to Rs 1,500 every month, deposited directly into their bank accounts.

The maths was clear: Of the 9.5 crore voters in Maharashtra, women accounted for 4.6 crore. About 2.46 crore women in the 21-65 years age group — over 50% of the total women voters — were eligible for the Ladki Bahin Yojana. Purse strings were loosened, and the NDA alliance targeted the dividends in the state polls, scoring a thumping victory against the Maha Vikas Agnadi, months after the Mahayuti setback in the Lok Sabha poll.

But populism comes with a price. At the time, the Mahayuti government was willing to overlook the Bill. Cut to July 2026: the Mahayuti government led by CM Devendra Fadnavis has dropped 92 lakh beneficiaries, citing non-eligibility. Currently, 1.51 crore women qualify for the Ladki Bahin Yojana — a 37% drop in beneficiaries. For the state government, it is a calcu-



During the 'Ladki Bahin Yojana' in Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar. FILE

lated gamble. There are no polls on the horizon, and the ruling coalition faces no major crisis.

Some key questions, however, remain unanswered. Why did the government enforce the scheme without verification? And why were ineligible beneficiaries allowed for two years? Aditi Tatkar, the state's Women and Child Development Minister, said that verification of beneficiaries was "cumbersome" given the scope of the scheme. "The administration had also left it to the beneficiaries to conform to terms and conditions of the scheme," she said.

The explanation is hardly convincing, considering that farmers seeking loan waiver come under scrutiny by the state

administration before they get the benefit. So, it is no secret that the government did not want to downsize the populist scheme and antagonise women voters before all elections, including to the local bodies and municipal

corporations, were over. Now that the BJP-led coalition has scored the poll points, the state government has turned to secure the coffers.

Assuring that the scheme is here to stay, CM Fadnavis has said, "There is no ambiguity that Ladki Bahin Yojana will continue." This commitment, however, is driven by political compulsion and the government is trying to reduce its bills by weeding out ineligible beneficiaries.

Right from its inception, the



ED arrests Ebix chairman in Mahadev app case

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 14

THE Enforcement Directorate (ED) has arrested Ebix Chairman Vikas Garg in connection with its money laundering probe linked to the Mahadev online betting app case, officials said.

Garg was arrested from his Delhi home and produced before a special court, which granted the agency 24-hour custody to take him to Raipur in Chhattisgarh where the probe is taking place. He is expected to be produced before the PMLA Court in Raipur on Wednesday.

The arrest comes weeks after the ED provisionally attached properties worth Rs 940.77 crore belonging to Garg, his family members, and entities allegedly owned or controlled by him. The attached assets include residential properties, land parcels, equity shares and other securities. "The attachment forms part of the money laundering probe into the Mahadev Online

Book/ Skyexchange illegal on-line betting case," an official said.

The ED has alleged that proceeds generated through the illegal betting app were routed into these entities and layered through companies. "The funds were allegedly used for acquiring shares, securities and other assets. Garg is the promoter of three listed companies — Vikas Ecotech Limited, Vikas Lifecare Limited and Eraaya Lifespaces Limited," a source said.

The ED found that Garg had allegedly acquired a 64% stake in EbixCash through Eraaya Lifespaces Limited using funds suspected to have been generated from illegal betting. The ED initiated its probe based on an FIR registered by the Chhattisgarh Police in Durg, along with other FIRs registered in Chhattisgarh, Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal and other states.

"The betting syndicate allegedly operated through a

franchise-based panel network run from abroad and generated proceeds of crime of over Rs 450 crore per month through illegal betting operations," an ED spokesperson alleged.

"The probe also revealed that the proceeds of crime generated from Mahadev Online Book and Skyexchange were allegedly laundered through a multi-layered structure of accommodation entries arranged against cash....," the spokesperson said.

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) INVITATION

INVITING EOI FROM QUALIFIED INDUSTRIES FOR TECHNOLOGY TRANSFER /
COMMERCIALIZATION OF TECHNOLOGIES DEVELOPED UNDER
NATIONAL MISSION ON POWER ELECTRONICS TECHNOLOGY (NaMPET)

For further details, visit www.cdac.in

Last Date of Submission of EOI : 25th July 2026



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Phone: +91-471-272-333



ई-निविदा नगर पालिक निगम ग्वालियर दिनांक : 09/07/2026					
क्र.	एन्टर नं.	कार्य का नाम	सागत	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य एवं ई.एस.सी.	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
1	2026_UAD_505152_2	'निगम निवि' वार्ड-12 अन्तर्गत लाइन नं. 03 में बी.टी. रोड निर्माण कार्य।	11574918.00/-	12500/- 57874.59/-	22-07-2026

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Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj
International Airport, Mumbai
1st floor, Terminal 1, Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Santacruz (E), Mumbai - 400 099.

EXTENSION OF EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

Mumbai International Airport Limited (MIAL), the concessionaire of CSMA, Mumbai is inviting accredited agencies to submit their EOI for "Civil and Infrastructure works of building & pavement in Landside and Airside of CSMA"

Interested agencies are requested to visit the website, www.csmia.adaniairports.com and obtain the EOI documents. EOI documents shall be available for download till 5:00 pm IST on 22nd July 2026.

COEP TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
Shivajinagar, Pune - 411 005
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Walk-in Interviews For Recruitment of Assistant Professor on 11 Months, Contractual Basis.

COEP Technological University Pune invites applications from dynamic, eligible and qualified candidates with passion towards research and academics to work as **Assistant Professor on 11 Months, Contractual Basis, non-vacational, dying post in Civil Engineering (Planning); Manufacturing Engineering & Industrial Management; Master of Business Administration (Business Analytics);** purely on temporary basis, to engage academic load for AY: 2026-27 in various Engineering and Science disciplines.

Please visit University website (www.coeptech.ac.in/career) for requirements, qualifications, experience, salary and other details under "Careers" tab. Reservation policy will be followed as per the norms. All interested candidates are requested to visit the COEP Technological University website for further details and submit an **online application form** with applicable application fees **on or before 20.07.2026**

Walk-in Interviews : Wednesday, 22.07.2026
The candidates shall report at 10.00 a.m. to the respective departments.

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भारत निर्वाचन आयोग
Election Commission of India

SIR-2026

HARYANA

Special Intensive Revision (SIR)



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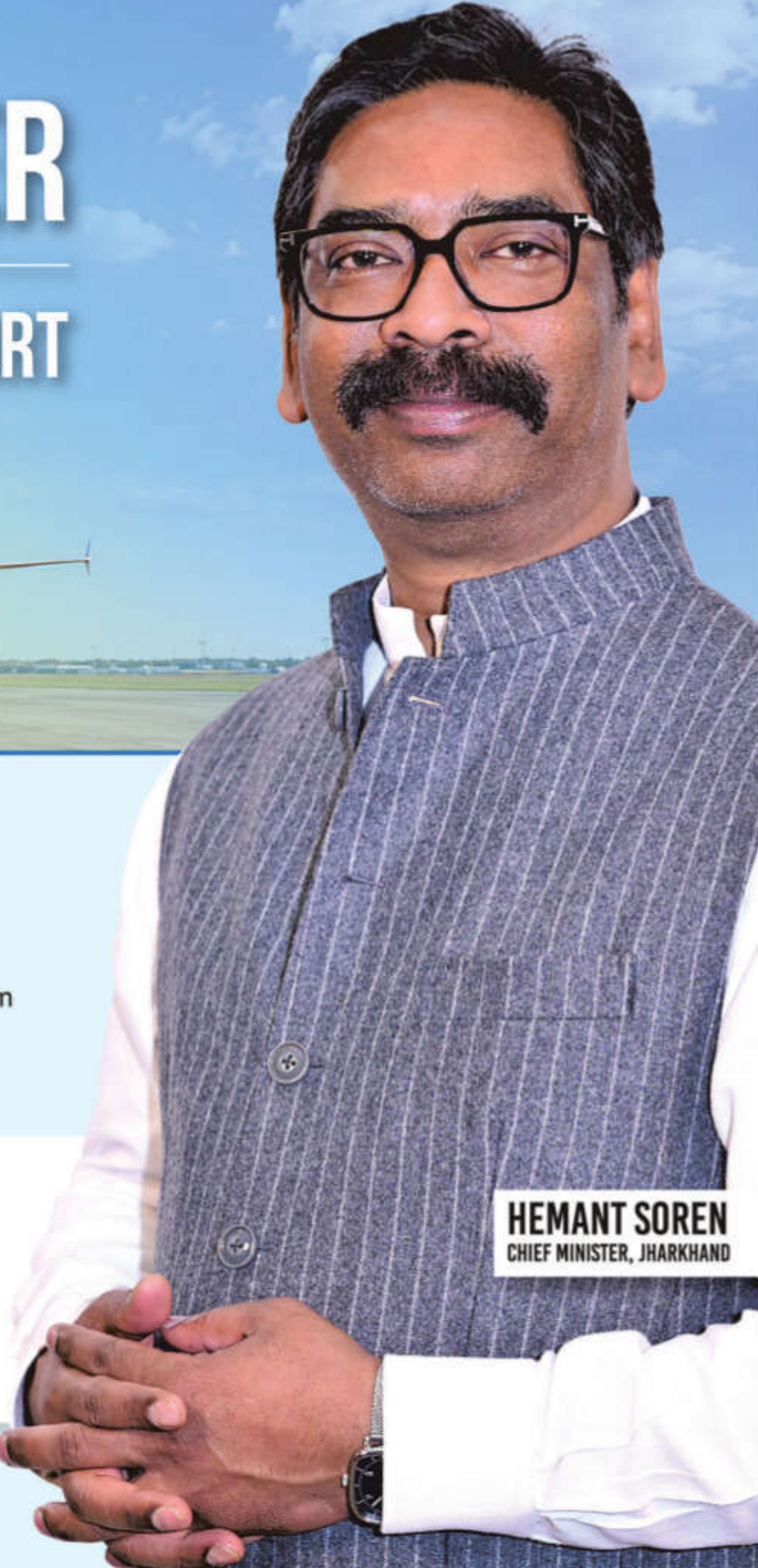
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CHIEF MINISTER, JHARKHAND

Department of Cabinet Secretariat & Vigilance (Civil Aviation Division), Government of Jharkhand
PR-NO-384903 (Civil Aviation) 2026-27
epaper.indianexpress.com
New Delhi

Over 1,000, mostly bureaucrats, apply for Ram Mandir CEO post

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, July 14

OVER 1,000 people from across the country have applied for the post of Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Ram Mandir, with retired bureaucrats dominating the list of applicants.

Applications poured into the official email address of the selection committee within 24 hours of the recruitment notification being issued on Monday.

The Shri Ram Jannbhoomi Teerth Kshetra constituted the three-member committee to identify a new CEO, who will oversee the day-to-day management of the temple trust, amid the ongoing controversy over the alleged theft of donations at the temple.

With July 18 being the deadline for applications, the selection committee has decided to appoint a secretary to help them segregate the applications based on the eligibility

criteria decided by them.

“Within a few hours of issuing the notification, we received around 750 applications on the first day. Given the response in less than 24 hours, we expect the number to run into thousands by the July 18 deadline. We, therefore, need a secretary to compile and scrutinise the applications based on the prescribed criteria,” a member of the selection committee told *The Indian Express*.

He added that the committee will meet on July 19 to begin scrutinising the applications and schedule interviews.

Sources said the secretary is likely to be a retired officer.

Among those who have publicly confirmed applying is former IPS officer and social activist Amitabh Thakur (58). “Finding myself suitable under the criteria laid down by the Ram Jannabhoomi Trust for the post of CEO, I have submitted my application,” he said.



Given the high response of applications, the selection committee expect the number to run into thousands by July 18 deadline. FILE

Thakur, who has courted controversy in the past, was arrested by the Lucknow Police last year in connection with a case of alleged fraud to secure an industrial plot in Deoria district in 1999.

The committee comprises retired Supreme Court judge Justice Pramod Kohli, retired Lieutenant General Vishnu-

kant Chaturvedi, and retired nuclear scientist and former chairperson of the Shri Saibaba Sansthan Trust in Shirdi Suresh Haware.

On Monday, the committee laid down the eligibility criteria: Applicants must be between 50 and 70 years of age, have at least 20 years of administrative experience, and be willing to

reside in Ayodhya.

In a key eligibility condition, it said the applicant must be a “practising Hindu” with “devotion to Lord Ram” and should be proficient in both Hindi and English.

Sources said the applications include a significant number of retired bureaucrats, some of whom have experience of working in managerial positions in religious places.

After scrutiny, sources said candidates well suited to the role will be called for interviews or discussions. Considering the seniority of the candidates, the panel will be open to online interviews, if required, but a final call will be taken after the July 19 meeting.

The Trust is also scheduled to meet on July 22 by which time the selection committee is expected to present its progress. The next meeting of the selection committee is likely to be in Delhi.

‘Criminal conspiracy’ behind errors in Odisha textbooks, senior bureaucrat held

Sujit Bisoyi

Bhubaneswar, July 14

THE CRIME Branch of the Odisha Police on Tuesday arrested Manoj Kumar Padhy, former director of the State Council of Educational Research and Training (SCERT), on charges of “criminal conspiracy” in connection with the errors seen in school textbooks for classes 1 to 8.

Padhy, a senior Odisha Administrative Service (OAS) officer, had headed SCERT at the time the textbooks were prepared. SCERT is entrusted with the overall supervision, coordination, monitoring and approval of the textbook development process as per the National Education Policy-2020.

The Crime Branch initiated its probe into the matter on Tuesday, a day after SCERT lodged a formal complaint about the alleged criminal conspiracy behind the large number of errors in the textbooks. The case was registered under various sections of the BNS, including criminal breach of trust, criminal conspiracy and framing incorrect official documents knowingly.

Earlier, Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi also suspected a “larger conspiracy” behind the errors in the textbooks, and subsequently ordered for a Crime Branch probe.

In a statement, the Crime Branch alleged that Padhy “dishonestly” failed to discharge the official duties entrusted to him and knowingly approved and forwarded print-ready



Arrested OAS officer Manoj Kumar Padhy

manuscripts for publication without ensuring verification of their factual, scientific, geographical,

translation and pictorial contents amounting to criminal negligence.

“Such acts and omissions resulted in the publication and distribution of erroneous textbooks, causing wrongful loss to the State Exchequer to the tune of approximately Rs 175 crore and corresponding injury to public interest,” read the statement.

Crime Branch sources said more officials from SCERT are under the scanner, and teachers engaged in the preparation of textbooks would also be questioned.

On June 26, the state government suspended Padhy, along with three assistant directors, over the errors, and initiated disciplinary action against six more assistant directors.

As many as 1,678 errors were detected across 55 new SCERT textbooks for students in classes 1 to 8, including factual inaccuracies, grammatical errors, spelling mistakes and wrong references. The class 8 textbooks have the highest number of errors — 705.



Shaurya Vijay Yatra

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh launches the ‘Shaurya Vijay Yatra’ motorcycle expedition, from National War Memorial to Kargil War Memorial in Dras, Ladakh, honouring the Indian armed forces and former servicemen, in New Delhi, Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

PAHALGAM ATTACK

Non-bailable warrant against Hafiz Saeed paves way for trial in absentia

Arun Sharma
Jammu, July 14

THE SPECIAL NIA Court in Jammu has issued a non-bailable warrant against Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Taiba chief Hafiz Saeed in the Pahalgam terror attack case.

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) had sought an “open-dated non-bailable warrant” against Saeed, a resident of Sargodha in Pakistan’s Punjab province, in connection with the case. The warrant was issued by the Special Judge of the NIA Court on July 8, two days after the NIA filed a supplementary chargesheet against Saeed.

“Arrest and custodial interrogation of the accused (Saeed) are necessary for a fair, complete and effective investigation. As

such, a non-bailable warrant of arrest is issued against him and is forwarded to the Deputy Inspector General (DIG), NIA Jammu, for execution in accordance with law,” the court said.

The court’s order paves the way for the initiation of a trial against Saeed in absentia.

In its supplementary chargesheet filed before the NIA court, the probe agency charged 76-year-old Saeed in both his personal capacity and as the chief of the proscribed Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) outfit and its proxy front, the Resistance Front (TRF).

He has been booked under multiple provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023, and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967.

In the supplementary chargesheet, the NIA specifically

mentions Saeed’s role in planning and monitoring the terror attack, besides additional forensic evidence collected from the attack site.

Saeed, who has been designated a global terrorist by India and the United States, is also considered the mastermind of the 2008 Mumbai terror attacks.

Last year, on April 22, terrorists gunned down 25 tourists and a local man in the Baisaran valley in J&K’s Pahalgam. In the first chargesheet filed in the case in December last year, three terrorists directly involved in the attack were named, including Suleiman, a top Lashkar militant commander from Pakistan. The three were killed in a joint operation by the military, the J&K Police and the CRPF in July last year.

‘Do not abduct Khalra again... I want Centre to have a larger heart, let us tell his story’

THE DILJIT Dosanjh-starrer, *Satluj*, has been mired in controversies — a long censorship battle, a silent OTT release, and an abrupt takedown. Based on the life of human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalra, it released on ZEE5 on July 3, but was blocked in India within 48 hours, and later taken down worldwide. **JASPREET SINGH** spoke to the movie’s director, **HONEY TREHAN**, whose earlier works include the Netflix show *Raat Akeli Hai*. Excerpts:

It was a hush-hush release. Even the teasers came out after the release on ZEE5. What was behind the decision?

That was a decision taken by my producers and the platform, because every time we announced the release, we were pressured by the government and had to stall the release. So it was completely their call that let’s just release it without any promos. I got to know about the release a couple of days beforehand; the producers called and said ZEE5 wanted to release ‘Punjab ’95’ under another title. I had no issues with that. I just told them there should be no cuts at all. They agreed. I told them we also have the name *Satluj* registered with us. Then we released it.

The movie was blocked in India within 48 hours, and later taken down from ZEE5 worldwide. What was your reaction?

I was heartbroken... The ban pushes you into a corner, and you’re forced to ask yourself... are we seriously living in a democratic country?

You see, 31 years ago, Jaswant Singh Khalra was abducted and killed by the Punjab Police. Back then, the Centre (CBI) had played a great role in delivering him justice. Today, after 31 years, Khalra is being abducted again... All I ask of the Centre is that please have a big heart, please be kind towards us, and let us tell his story to the world. Do not abduct Khalra



HONEY TREHAN
DIRECTOR OF SATLUJ

again. I want the Centre to have a larger heart and give him the freedom... Let his story be told...

The government panel says the film might be misused by hostile elements, Pakistan or separatists...

Are there any grounds for this statement? On the contrary, my film has actually united Punjab. You go to Punjab and see, people are watching the movie together. They say my film is polarising society and dividing Hindus and Sikhs, but on the ground, the Hindus and Sikhs of Punjab are watching the movie together. It was not meant to provoke anybody. My film is a balm on the wounds of the people who suffered so much...

I don’t think there was any reason to ban it. People were peacefully watching my movie for the first 48 hours. But the government banned the movie... It’s been 10 days; everyone’s watching the film... What is more harmful for the law and order of this country? My film that has united people, or hate speeches by the politicians aimed at dividing us? Propaganda movies are also released... And even if you say my movie is a propaganda, then let it be released like you released other propaganda films. Why differentiate? One film can’t destroy our nation.

Some people say the film is one-sided.

If you believe my film is one-sided, then you have clearly not watched it fully... Because if you

watch it, you will hear the exchange between the characters Sugga (Suvinder Vicky) and the CBI cop, played by Arjun Rampal, where Sugga tells him “*ha mari ek ek goli yaha hazaro goliyon ke badle chalti hai*” (Every single shot we fire is in response to a thousand gunshots here). Or the exchange between the characters of the Chief Minister and DGP Bitta, where Bitta tells him that without him, militancy wouldn’t have ended in Punjab. I am a filmmaker; I make my characters speak for themselves. If they can speak for the other side, “*mujhe dhol bajane ki kya zarurat hai?*” (Why do I need to blow their trumpet?) I also mention in the film that thousands of cops were killed in the proxy war. But nobody noticed. How can you say my movie is silent about the other side?

The number, 25,000 encounter deaths in Punjab, is exaggerated, some say.

My film is based on Khalra. He always said 25,000 encounters. His speeches are also available on the web. So I need to depict his truth. But for the sake of clarity and being a responsible citizen, I have still mentioned in the movie that it is an estimated figure. Wherever Diljit mentions it, he says “estimated 25,000 extra-judicial killings”.

Critics are also pointing out that you did not portray Khalra’s politics or his advocacy for the Khalistan movement. Why is that?

I read about him (Khalra) in great detail and I know of his politics too. But I was not making the film to scrutinise anyone’s personality... My focus was his human rights work. Does his politics negate that? No case was ever filed against Khalra. Even in the police testimonies, the cops say: “Khalra was such a nice man, why would we abduct him?” So the question is, if he was such a nice man and a law-abiding citizen, why was he abducted and killed by the police?

FULL INTERVIEW ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Akal Takht Jathedar announces memorial to Khalra on Sutlej

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Amritsar, July 14

THE AKAL Takht on Tuesday announced to set up ‘Shaheedi’ memorial at Harike Pattan, on the banks of Sutlej, dedicated to human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khalra and the people whose bodies were disposed of as unclaimed during the period when Punjab was in the grip of militancy.

Takht’s Jathedar Giani Kuldeep Singh Gargaj made the announcement after performing a special ‘ardas’ (prayer) for the eternal peace of Khalra and the Sikh youths who were declared missing or became vic-

tims of alleged extrajudicial killings and denied proper rites.

“We gather at this spot where countless sons and daughters of Punjab were murdered and their bodies disposed into rivers... From this day onward, this place... will be known as ‘Shaheedi Pattan,’” said Gargaj.

Khalra was abducted from outside his Amritsar home on September 6, 1995, and killed by Punjab Police personnel soon after he exposed the alleged illegal cremations of at least 2,097 “unclaimed” bodies in Amritsar following suspected fake encounters during the militancy era. The Akal

Takht had announced the Ardas at Harike Pattan, where Khalra’s body is believed to have been disposed of.

A large number of people had gathered at the site. Among them were family members of several such people who went missing during the militancy period.

The ceremony featured the installation of the Guru Granth Sahib in a special Palki Sahib, recitation of Sri Sukhmani Sahib, and a Gurbani kirtan by Hazoori Ragis led by Bhai Simarpreet Singh of Sachkhand Sri Harmandir Sahib. The concluding ardas was personally performed by Gargaj.

‘Haven’t had airport drop in 5 months’: Goa’s motorcycle taxis are dying slow death

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, July 14

“THE BUSINESS is slow and waning,” says Raju ‘Datta’ Naik (73), as he moves his black-and-yellow motorcycle taxi to the front of the queue at the taxi stand in Panaji on Saturday evening.

Naik, a native of North Goa’s Ribandar village, has been a “pilot” for more than four decades. Hailing from a farming family, he worked in canteens before learning to ride a motorcycle. In the early 1980s, when tourism began surging in Goa, he started offering rides to commuters on a Rajdoot motorcycle in Panaji.

“A bhatkar (landlord) rented me the Rajdoot. I would pay him Rs 10 as the day’s rent, get the tank filled with petrol and pocket earnings from the rides. Those were simpler times, and this job was respectable and paid well,” he recalls.

Naik is among the old guard of these riders, known in Goa as “pilots”. Now, making a living

with these iconic motorcycle taxis has become harder than ever. Naik waits for two hours on average between rides. “The last time I dropped someone off at the airport was five months ago. These buses and cabs did not exist earlier,” he said, pointing to the parking area of the bus stand in Panaji.

Last week, Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant launched an app, ‘Mhaje Driver App’, for motorcycle taxis, which allows commuters to book motorcycle taxis registered with the Motorcycle Taxi Riders Association. The app aims to strengthen last-mile connectivity and allows commuters to book a ride digitally from anywhere in the state.

At the launch event, Sawant said the number of traditional motorcycle taxi pilots has dwindled significantly due to the prevalence of rental bike services, adding that the government would stop issuing new licences for rental bike operations to protect the livelihoods of these “pilots”.

Motorcycle taxis have been

operating in Goa for decades, dating back to the period of Portuguese rule. The word ‘pilot’ comes from the Portuguese ‘piloto’, meaning driver, and it was colloquially used to refer to the motorcycle taxi drivers.

In 1981, the Motorcycle Taxi Riders Association was registered, and the state government amended the Motor Vehicles Act, paving the way for these pilots to get permits and operate under a legal framework.

As Goa started gaining popularity in the global tourist map and with limited options for public transport, especially in the rural talukas, the motorcycle taxis soon became a ubiquitous part of the daily commute for locals and tourists in the coastal state.

Avinash Naik (70), a motorcycle pilot, remembers ferrying tourists on the back of his Rajdoot and Yezdi motorcycles for sightseeing tours to the popular North Goa beaches. “Pilots had a lot of respect. People trusted us... and still do. We, along with the taxi drivers,



Avinash Naik (70), a motorcycle pilot. EXPRESS

were called the ambassadors of tourism. The tourists would give us generous tips, and we built friendships. It was a relationship of trust,” he says.

Avinash was four years old when his father, a farmer, died. In his teenage years, he worked in printing, which paid little. A neighbour taught him to drive a motorcycle, and he “became a pilot” to make ends meet. “*Tab fursat nhi hota tha season mein* (We were so busy dur-

ing the tourist season). Often, we skipped lunch. And now, we have to chase the commuters,” he says.

Improvements in the inter-city public bus service network, increasing vehicle ownership among locals, the steady proliferation of rental bikes, and the rise of illegally operated private taxis over the past couple of decades have led to a decline in pilots’ earnings, with many forced out of the profession.

A member of the Goa Motorcycle Taxi Riders Association said the number of pilots registered with the association is around 1,500, while at least 500 are privately operating and are not part of the association. This represents a major dip from the 8,000 bike pilots operating in the state in 1999.

Avinash Naik says he makes around Rs 400-500 per day on average, depending on the length of the trips. “Fuel costs are always increasing, and maintenance costs of the bike are also high. But government-notified fares have stayed constant for years. We are just surviving somehow. During the season from November to March, we get rides, but off-season, business is bleak,” he says.

“Earlier, people would land at the airport and hire a taxi or take our services to go around. Now, anyone can just rent a scooter for Rs 400 a day and drive around. This rental model has killed our business,” Avinash adds.

Several pilots say they were

not taken into confidence regarding the new app launched by the Chief Minister last week. “We do not want to get on the app. It is an aggregator, and it will drive us out of business in the long run. They will undercut us and charge commission. We have seen this happen in other states,” says Rajesh Tayad (32), who has been a motorcycle pilot for a decade.

“Ours is a self-sustaining business. We are not making a lot of money, and whatever we earn goes into sustenance. But there is freedom... *Kisi ka nok-jhok nhi hai* (There is no interference). Once bike aggregators come in, the Goan identity will also be lost, and drivers from other states will be employed,” he said.

The larger concern for the motorcycle pilots centres around one stark reality. “There is simply not enough demand. What will the app do?” asks Shabbir Shaikh (51) from Verem.

Shaikh has been driving a motorcycle taxi for 20 years.

“Why would someone pay Rs 100 when the bus is charging Rs 10 for the same route? And the bus leaves every 10 minutes from here. Unless it is an emergency, and one has to cover the distance in a short time. The buses are now covering internal lanes, in hinterland areas too,” he explains.

“The locals now rely on pilots largely for emergencies — a visit to the hospital, or late-night travelling... and for shorter rides to the offices during the peak hours. The rides are fewer and farther between,” Shaikh says.

Suresh Verekar (58), another motorcycle pilot, says the government’s subsidy to purchase new motorcycles helps, “but if the profession has to survive, the illegally-run bike services need to be shut down and the licences of rental bike services need to be revoked.”

Many said their children don’t want to join the traditional profession. “But I will do it till my body and spirit allow,” declares Avinash Naik.



बिहार सरकार
उच्च शिक्षा विभाग



विकसित भारत - समृद्ध बिहार

श्री सम्राट चौधरी

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

के कर-कमलों द्वारा

211 नये डिग्री कॉलेजों में पठन-पाठन कार्यों

का

शुभारम्भ

विशिष्ट अतिथि

श्री विजय कुमार चौधरी

माननीय उप मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

श्री बिजेन्द्र प्रसाद यादव

माननीय उप मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

अध्यक्षता

श्री संजय सिंह (टाइगर)

माननीय मंत्री

उच्च शिक्षा विभाग, बिहार सरकार



हर युवा का सपना, अब अपने प्रखंड में होगा पूरा

अब स्नातक की पढ़ाई के लिए छात्रों को दूर-दराज के शहरों का रुख नहीं करना पड़ेगा। प्रत्येक प्रखंड में उच्च शिक्षा उपलब्ध होने से समय और धन दोनों की बचत होगी तथा अधिक से अधिक युवा उच्च शिक्षा से जुड़ सकेंगे।



बेटियों की शिक्षा को नई उड़ान

अब समय की पुकार है कि प्रत्येक बेटी को उच्च शिक्षा का समान अवसर मिले। गुणवत्तापूर्ण शिक्षा एवं सशक्त शैक्षणिक वातावरण से बेटियाँ आत्मनिर्भर बनेंगी, अपने सपनों को साकार करेंगी तथा समाज और राष्ट्र के विकास में महत्वपूर्ण योगदान देंगी।

इस दिशा में सरकार के प्रमुख कदम

211 प्रखंडों में नए
डिग्री कॉलेज

योग्य शिक्षकों एवं
कर्मचारियों की तैनाती

बेहतर भवन, पुस्तकालय
एवं आधुनिक सुविधाएं

राष्ट्रीय स्तर की गुणवत्ता हेतु
प्रतिष्ठित संस्थानों से साझेदारी

भूमि दानकर्ताओं के
नाम पर महाविद्यालय



दिनांक:
15 जुलाई 2026



समय:
10:30 पूर्वाह्न



स्थान:
काशील, गोराडीह, भागलपुर



युवाओं को उच्च शिक्षा से जोड़ने की नयी पहल



‘TAKEN COURT FOR A RIDE’

SC fines comedian Samay Raina Rs 3L for defying court

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 14

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday imposed a fine of Rs 3 lakh each on comedian Samay Raina and fellow comedians, noting that they had “taken the court for a ride” by not following its directions in the case registered over alleged insensitive remarks on persons with disabilities in the show ‘India’s Got Latent’.

“We have no reason to doubt that Samay Raina has taken the Court for a ride. He is in brazen violation of statements/undertakings given before this Court,” a three-judge bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said, imposing the cost.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, questioned the delay in filing a compliance affidavit and termed it an attempt to justify the “misconduct”.

“The misconduct is sought to be compounded by stating that the compliance affidavit was filed yesterday, however, no affidavit has been filed,” the bench said.

Though the court initially ordered Rs 10 lakh in costs, it finally brought it down to Rs 3 lakh and asked Raina to deposit the same in two weeks.

The bench cautioned that it will add one more zero to the



Samay Raina

figure if the defiance continues. The bench was hearing a petition filed by Cure SMA India Foundation accusing Raina and others of cracking insensitive jokes on persons with disabilities (PwDs) on the show.

The plea flagged jokes made by ‘India’s Got Latent’ host Samay Raina and other social media influencers.

The SC while dealing with the matter earlier, had asked them to invite specially-abled persons on their shows and do the needful to generate funds for treatment of people suffering from rare diseases such as Spinal Muscular Atrophy (SMA).

On Tuesday, however, Senior Advocate Aparajita Singh, who appeared for the Foundation said Raina had not contacted them to join any of his shows. “I don’t know what kind

of an icon he is for the youth... I shudder to think if he is regarded as an icon by the youth,” she exclaimed.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta added, “our youth has better icons...” They are “self-proclaimed icons”, said the CJI.

“Recently, he started a new show. He said at the beginning, now I am doing something which I didn’t do in the last series. He hangs ‘nimbu and mirchi’. He did not name anyone, but it was quite clear,” Mehta added.

The CJI said that “in public life, the more you respect others, the more respect you earn. You don’t humiliate people”. The bench added that he will face consequences if he does not respect the sentiments of others. “Let them suffer now. If this is not arrogance, then we have to change the Oxford dictionary also,” the CJI observed.

Justice Bagchi said: “You should have invited the client of Ms Aparajita Singh and done the show. Now you are giving a sense that you are trying to buy them out. If you used their disability to showcase your fundamental rights to have commercial speech...”

Earlier, the Supreme Court had directed Raina and four of his co-comedians to display their unconditional apology on their show or podcast for ridiculing those with disabilities, and rare genetic disorders.

1 of 2 books barred by govt available in Jammu University since 2022

Arun Sharma
Jammu, July 14

ON SUNDAY, the Jammu and Kashmir Police arrested three publishers over two controversial books that had made their way into school libraries in the Union Territory. But one of these books, *Personalities and Legends of J&K*, has been available in Jammu University’s Central Library since 2022.

The police action against the book and its publisher followed allegations that it contained chapters glorifying separatist leaders and militants. Since then, *Personalities and Legends of J&K* has also been “sealed” and “removed” from the University’s library, a source said. When contacted, the officiating Head of the Political Science Department that procured the book, Professor Sunil Kumar, refused to comment on the matter.

The book, written by Hilal Ahmed and Santosh Meena, was first published by Delhi-based Paradise Press in 2017. It was this edition that was procured by the Political Science Department. In 2017, J&K had a coalition government led by the PDP and including the BJP.

When the University procured it in 2022, J&K was a UT and under the Central rule. The University officials said the book was procured after a request by several students and research scholars in the Political Science Department.

Sources said that there were, however, very few requisitions by students to borrow it. A senior functionary of the University’s Central Library said their

Published in 2017, varsity procured it on request of students & research scholars



The university is now checking its 5 lakh collection for any other ‘objectionable’ publications, say officials. JAMMU UNIVERSITY

duties include slotting the nearly 5 lakh books in its collection into sections, allocating them unique identification numbers, and maintaining data. The library has a separate Kashmir section.

After a circular withdrawing the controversial books — apart from *Personalities and Legends of J&K*, the government barred *Great Personalities of Jammu & Kashmir* — a “comprehensive academic and content audit” of academic material in colleges, universities and public libraries across the UT was ordered.

The audit is meant to check for “material that directly or indirectly promotes, glorifies, legitimises or justifies terrorism, violent extremism, secessionism, radicalisation or any activity prejudicial to the sovereignty, unity, integrity and security of the Nation”, and its scope includes journals, research publi-

cations, academic theses and dissertations, and digital repositories of academic institutions. At the University, officials said they have been going through the institute’s collection in response. They have not come across a single publication that can be held “objectionable” on the grounds listed. An official said, “We have a robust and transparent system to procure books from vendors empanelled by us, and as per the terms and conditions of the university.”

A teaching faculty member of the Political Science Department said their section has around 50,000 books. “Sometimes, research scholars demand a particular book, and there is little time to go through its contents before buying it,” he said, adding that they normally go through the catalogue containing lists of books provided by publishers and procure the

books on the basis of demands raised by students or research scholars. The book was the reprint by Jammu-based Oberoi Book Service that made its way to government school libraries last year. Oberoi’s Inderpaul Singh was among those arrested on Sunday.

Sushant Giri’s *Great Personalities of Jammu & Kashmir*, is accused of “highly inappropriate content” on separatism. Amardeep Singh and Girish Arora of the Noida-based Dominant Publishers were arrested on Sunday in relation to that.

While 123 copies of *Personalities and Legends of J&K* were supplied to school libraries in Jammu, Ramban and Udhampur, 128 copies of *Great Personalities of Jammu & Kashmir* were supplied in Jammu and Baramulla districts.

The J&K government, which set up an enquiry committee headed by an officer of the rank of Additional Chief Secretary, has suspended eight officials of the School Education Department, and terminated a contractual staffer.

The authors and publishing houses have been barred from publishing any other material in the UT.

On Monday, the Counter-Intelligence Unit of the J&K Police got 10-day custody of the three publications. Searches are on to track down the writers of the books as well. Among the separatists *Personalities and Legends of J&K* allegedly glorified are Maqbool Bhat, co-founder of the separatist Jammu Kashmir Liberation Front, and Hashim Qureshi.

Staines murder: As convict Dara Singh seeks release, Odisha court told to decide in 1 month

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, July 14

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday directed the Odisha government to decide within a month on the remission plea of Ravindra Pal alias Dara Singh, who is serving a life sentence for the 1999 murder of Australian missionary Graham Staines and his two minor sons.

A Bench of Justices Manoj Misra and Vijay Bishnoi adjourned the matter to August

19 after the Odisha government informed the court that the State Sentence Review Board, which is examining Singh’s plea, had sought certain records that were yet to be made available.

“In such circumstances, we deem it appropriate to adjourn this matter to 19.08.2026. In the meantime, we expect that the committee shall take its decision,” the Bench said.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Singh’s counsel A P Singh said the state informed

the court that the State Sentence Review Board had considered 56 remission cases, including Singh’s, at its July 6 meeting.

“The state sought more time to verify certain records as Singh belongs to Auraiya district in Uttar Pradesh. The court has asked it to take a decision by August 15,” he said.

A senior government official said the state was awaiting records from the Auraiya district authorities.

Singh has been lodged in

Keonjhar district jail for the past 26 years. He moved the Supreme Court in July 2024 seeking remission, stating that he had spent over 24 years in prison and had repented for his actions. He was 37 when he was arrested.

1999 attack

On the night of January 22, 1999, a mob of around 50 people led by Singh, attacked a camp at Manoharpur in Odisha’s Keonjhar district and burnt alive Staines and his two sons, Philip (10) and Timothy (6), while they were asleep inside a station wagon. According to the police, the attack was linked to tensions over alleged religious conversions.

An FIR was registered at Anandpur police station on January 23, 1999. While 49 people were arrested soon after the incident, Singh remained at large. The investigation was initially handled by the Odisha Crime Branch before being transferred to the

CBI. Singh was arrested on January 31, 2000, in a forest in Keonjhar, though sources had then maintained that he had surrendered. Of the 50 accused arrested between 1999 and 2000, 37 were acquitted within three years.

In September 2003, a CBI court in Bhubaneswar awarded the death penalty to Singh and sentenced 12 others to life imprisonment. The Orissa High Court later acquitted 11 of the co-convicts.

In May 2005, the High Court commuted Singh’s death sentence to life imprisonment, a decision upheld by the Supreme Court in January 2011. Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi, who represents the Keonjhar Assembly constituency, had earlier supported the demand for Singh’s release. In April 2025, Mahendra Hembram, another convict in the case, was released from Keonjhar jail after serving 25 years on the grounds of “good behaviour”.

Rs 500-cr ‘fake silver’ offerings at Vaishno Devi: Court summons probe officer

Arun Sharma
Jammu, July 14

A COURT in Jammu has asked an inquiry officer of the J&K Police’s Crime Branch to appear personally before it with records pertaining to alleged offerings of “fake silver” worth around Rs 500 crore at the Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine in the Trikuta Hills near Katra.

The directions from Chief Judicial Magistrate, Jammu, Munish Kumar Manhas, came on Monday in an application filed by Advocate Deepak Sharma. The CJM has listed the matter for July 29.

Sharma had earlier submitted a detailed complaint before the Inspector General of Police, Crime Branch, Jammu, and the Senior Superintendent of Police, Crime Branch, Economic Offences Wing, Jammu, seeking registration of an FIR and a comprehensive investigation into the alleged “adulteration, substitution and possible misappropriation” of silver offerings at Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Ji Shrine.

The complaint dated May 9 had alleged cognizable offences like criminal conspiracy, cheating, criminal breach of trust, misappropriation, manipulation of records and the possible procurement or use of cadmium-laden material.

‘No effective action’

The complainant said that he approached the court seeking an action-taken report and a direction for the registration of an FIR and investigation, claiming that no effective action was disclosed by the Crime Branch.

The Crime Branch had filed a status report pursuant to the court’s directions, stating that the complaint had initially been forwarded to Crime Headquarters, Srinagar, for approval and, after receipt of such approval, it was there after forwarded to the Zonal Police Headquarters, Jammu, for “appropriate action”.

Advocate Sharma, on Monday, argued that the mere administrative forwarding of the complaint does not amount to lawful action upon information disclosing cognizable offences.

He submitted that the Crime Branch, Economic Offences Wing, Jammu, is itself a notified police station, with its Superintendent of Police functioning as the Station House Officer. He also pointed out that the status report did not disclose any steps having been taken for the preservation of crucial evidence.

The controversy arose from reports that approximately 20 tonnes of accumulated silver offerings made at the Mata Vaishno Devi shrine, stated to be worth around Rs 550 crore, had been sent by the Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board for testing, melting and processing, and that only around 5-6% of the material was reportedly found to be actual silver.

Gyanvapi row: Hindu, Muslim sides skip SC-mandated talks

Express News Service
Lucknow, July 14

WITH BOTH the Hindu and Muslim litigants in the Gyanvapi mosque dispute case refusing to take part in the Supreme Court-mandated mediation talks on Tuesday, it is now certain that the two sides will fight it out in the courts, preferring judicial adjudication over an out-of-court settlement.

The Supreme Court’s similar effort during a special Lok Adalat, scheduled to be held between July 22 and 25, is unlikely to bring any breakthrough.

The Gyanvapi mosque abuts the Kashi Vishwanath temple.

The Hindu side claims that the mosque was built after the demolition of the Kashi Vishwanath temple during the Mughal period, while the Muslim side maintains that it is a legitimate Waqf property.

“The Gyanvapi matter is a hyper-sensitive one, and such disputes cannot be settled following mediation,” SM Yaseen, the joint secretary of Anjuman Intizamia Masajid, the caretaker of the 17th-century mosque in Varanasi, told *The Indian Express*.

The Muslim side sent their lawyer to the district court on Tuesday to inform the mediation committee that members of Anjuman Intizamia Masajid would not be taking part in the talks, mandated by the Supreme Court.

The Supreme Court had fixed July 14 to explore an amicable settlement in major religious site cases. The three-

member committee is headed by an Additional District and Sessions Judge.

“There are more than 35 litigants from the Hindu side, and practically, it is not possible to decide such a dispute with mediation,” Yaseen said.

Among the Hindu litigants, four women — Rekha Pathak, Sita Sahu, Lakshmi Devi, and Manju Vyas — accompanied their lawyer Madan Mohan Yadav to the court premises on Tuesday, saying they want complete possession of the disputed site.

“We informed the mediation committee that the Muslim side is an encroacher at Gyanvapi and should vacate the premises so that a grand Kashi Vishwanath temple can be built at the original Jyotirlinga site,” Yadav told mediapersons.

“The Muslim side said several similar matters are pending before the Supreme Court, and they would abide by the court’s verdict. They are not willing to accept mediation,” Yadav added.

Five years ago, a group of Hindu women, including Rakhi Singh, filed a petition in the Varanasi court seeking permission to worship goddess Shringar Gauri on the outer walls of the Gyanvapi mosque complex.

Following a court ordered survey of the mosque complex by the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI), the four Hindu women then moved the Supreme Court seeking the excavation and scientific survey of a sealed section of the mosque.

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, NOIDA-201301 (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes / amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Fresh-Tender Work :-

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1.	02/GM (NTC)/SM (E&M-3)/ 2025-26	Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) of Implementation of Integrated Security and Traffic Management System (ISTMS) 84 locations, Hot Spot & HTMS System Noida to Greater Noida Expressway, Noida.	48.24
2.	37/GM/ SM(WC-4)/ ET/2026-27	M/o Drain (Repair and raising of drain from Plot No. B-1 to Plot No. B-3 Sector-62), Noida.	46.12
3.	38/GM/ SM(WC-4)/ ET/2026-27	M/o Community Centre (R/o Community Centre in Village Chhajarsi), Noida.	43.43
4.	39/GM/ SM(WC-4)/ ET/2026-27	M/o Village (R/o 02 nos. Baratghar in Village Beholpur), Noida.	71.85
5.	43/GM/ SM(WC-4)/ ET/2026-27	M/o Building (R/o Baratghar in Sector-62), Noida.	98.12
6.	28/GM/ SM(WC-3)/ 2026-27	M/o Drain (Annual Maintenance, Main drain & Internal drain Sector-39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, 99, 100, Village Barola, Challeria, Sadarpur, Hoshiyarpur, Aghapur, MP-3 road, 50-51 road, Aghapur road and 75 mtr. wide road and Kaitan School road DSC road, Nithari road), Noida.	61.77
7.	58/GM (E&M)/S.M./ E/M-III/26-27	D/o Village (Internal Electrification work for panchayat Ghar in Village Nayabans), NOIDA.	37.76

The above Tenders can be uploaded from dated 15.07.2026 to 29.07.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 30.07.2026 at 11.00 AM.

B) Re-Tender Work :-

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
8.	56/DGM/SM (WC-3)/ 2026-27	D/o Village (Repairing Work of Wall, C/o footpath, Ramp work and C.C. Pavement work Outer Ring road at Pond in Village Sadarpur), Noida.	43.43
9.	70/GM/SM (WC-5)/ 2026-2027	M/o Building (R/o Community Centre Building, repair of drain, P/F SFRG Cover, P/L Water Proofing, Kitchen Shed and etc. work in Community Centre in EWS Sector-71), Noida.	53.03
10.	58/GM/SM (WC-5)/ 2026-2027	D/o Village (P/L C.C. Pavement, M.S. Jaal and Maintenance of drain in Village-Bishanpura), Noida.	68.16
11.	01/GM/SM (WC-3)/ 2026-27	M/o Road (M/o Drain, Culvert and Other Repair Work on Aghapur Road from DSC Road to Underpass B/w Sector-50 & 41), Noida.	84.05

The above Tenders can be uploaded from dated 15.07.2026 to 21.07.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 22.07.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Civil)
Office : Sector-96, Noida

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संस्कृति निदेशालय, उत्तर प्रदेश
उ०प्र० गौरव सम्मान-2026-27
आवेदन पत्र का आमंत्रण

उत्तर प्रदेश के ऐसे ख्यातिलब्ध महानुभावों जिन्होंने विभिन्न विधाओं एवं कार्यक्षेत्रों यथा-कला एवं संस्कृति, कृषि, उद्यमिता, कौशल विकास, विज्ञान व प्रौद्योगिकी, साहित्य, शिक्षा, खेल, समाजसेवा, पर्यावरण, महिला सशक्तिकरण, ग्राम विकास आदि में अपने व्यक्तिगत प्रयासों से उत्कृष्टता के आयाम स्थापित करते हुए राष्ट्रीय एवं अन्तर्राष्ट्रीय स्तर पर गौरव हासिल किया हो. को उ०प्र० सरकार द्वारा उ०प्र० गौरव सम्मान से सम्मानित किया जाना है।

सम्मान हेतु अर्हताएं

- 1- उत्तर प्रदेश का मूल निवासी होना चाहिए।
- 2- विभिन्न विधाओं/कार्य क्षेत्रों के ऐसे राष्ट्रीय एवं अन्तर्राष्ट्रीय स्तर के ख्याति प्राप्त महानुभाव, जिन्होंने अपनी प्रतिभा, दीर्घ साधना के आधार पर श्रेष्ठ उपलब्धि प्राप्त की हो।
- 3- जिन्होंने देश एवं विदेश में उत्तर प्रदेश का नाम रोशन किया हो।
- 4- राज्य सरकार अथवा भारत सरकार से पूर्व में किसी अन्य राष्ट्रीय/राज्य पुरस्कार अथवा सम्मान प्राप्त महानुभाव को सामान्यतया इस पुरस्कार की पात्रता परिधि में नहीं रखा जायेगा।

उपरोक्त आवेदन पत्र निर्धारित प्रारूप पर भरकर संबंधित जनपद के जिलाधिकारी से अग्रेसित करकर दिनांक 20.07.2026 से दिनांक 30.09.2026 के सांय 05:00 बजे तक निदेशक, संस्कृति निदेशालय, उ०प्र०, जवाहर भवन, नवम तल, लखनऊ- 226001 के कार्यालय में ऑनलाइन/ऑफलाइन दोनों माध्यमों से प्राप्त किये जायेंगे। ऑनलाइन आवेदन ई-मेल gaurvassamman2027@gmail.com के माध्यम से प्राप्त किये जायेंगे।

नोट: पुरस्कार सम्बन्धी नियमावली एवं ऑनलाइन/ऑफलाइन आवेदन पत्र हेतु निर्धारित प्रारूप संस्कृति विभाग, उ०प्र० की वेबसाइट <http://upculture.up.nic.in> से प्राप्त किये जा सकते हैं।

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EXPRESS special

‘Counsel, you are on mute’

THE WORLD OF VIRTUAL COURTS

The pandemic derailed the best of plans. But this was also the time India’s courtrooms got on to a new track, starting virtual hearings. Despite the chaotic start — patchy networks, and frozen screens and mute buttons — e-courts are now a key part of India’s justice delivery system, write

AMAAL SHEIKH & SOHINI GHOSH

● A YouTube video of the Supreme Court’s *suo motu* hearing into the R G Kar rape-murder case has been viewed 3.64 lakh times since it was uploaded in August 2024 — a number far beyond what could ever have been accommodated inside a single courtroom.

● Last year, a senior advocate logged into a virtual hearing of the Gujarat High Court, beer mug in hand, phone to his ear. The video went viral within hours, and the bench called the conduct “outrageous”.

● In 2022, then Gujarat High Court Chief Justice Aravind Kumar saw Inspector AM Rathod sipping from a cola can during a virtual hearing and directed him to distribute 100 such cans among bar association members or face disciplinary proceedings.

FOR DECADES, India’s judicial system was built around physical files, crowded courtrooms and colonial-era systems. That began changing around six years ago as courtrooms adopted virtual hearings, turning what was a pandemic necessity into a key part of India’s justice delivery system.

Virtual hearings have not only made it easier for litigants to follow their cases but also for lawyers to practise across cities and for citizens to access court proceedings. In the process, they have opened courtrooms to unprecedented scrutiny and transparency, changing how justice is observed and understood.

In February 2026, Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal told Lok Sabha that as of December 31, 2025, High Courts and district courts across the country had conducted 3.93 crore cases via video conferencing. E-filing (cases filed digitally) crossed 1.03 crore and 29 virtual courts processed over 94.5 lakh challans, collecting more than Rs 973 crore — figures the minister cited as evidence to say that digitisation of courts has kept the system moving even as courts struggle with case pendency (five crore and counting).

‘People like to come to court’

Fifteen years before courtrooms moved online, the judiciary had begun an overhaul. In 2005, the Supreme Court’s e-committee proposed a blueprint for digitising court administration.

When the project was rolled out in 2007, the focus was on basic digital infrastructure. District and taluka courts were equipped with computers, server rooms and local area networks. Courts adopted Case Information Software, a national case management platform that digitised filing, case records and court administration. Millions of pending cases were entered into electronic databases.

Then, in 2010, came a turning point. India’s first district-level paperless e-court was inaugurated at Karkardooma in Delhi. It was an ambitious shift: touchscreens on the judge’s dais, LCD monitors for viewing digitised records, e-filing to reduce paperwork and facilities for video-linked testimony from jails, forensic laboratories and government hospitals.

Retired Justice Talwant Singh, then the nodal officer overseeing the initiative, recalls, “People were laughing at us... They said, nobody will go for it. Why has so much money been spent? People like to come to court.”

Till 2020, virtual hearings remained an exception. Then, Covid hit, followed by the lockdown. Courts shut almost overnight. And all of a sudden, the question was not whether to go online, but how fast.

The Delhi High Court made the move first. Within 10 days, Justice Talwant Singh conducted what became the country’s first Covid-era virtual hearing on WhatsApp.

The case was a high-stakes anti-suit injunction action against an emergency arbitration in Singapore. A senior counsel appeared from London, and others from across India. “Within two or three weeks, it became normal to hold hearings through VC (video calling),” says Justice Talwant.

Eventually, the Delhi HC moved to Cisco Webex under a proper licensing arrangement and extended it to the district courts.

‘The camera catches all of it’

Confined to a coffee plantation in Coorg during the lockdown, Senior Advocate Sajjan Poovayya appeared before courts across the country. “There would be eight or ten screens,” he recalls. Each screen connected him to a different courtroom.

In the initial days, Poovayya remembers how accidental muting or unmuting, frozen screens and lawyers unfamiliar with virtual appearances became a running joke. “Counsel, you are on mute” became the era’s most repeated phrase.

Senior Advocate Menaka Guruswamy recalls that at first, some senior lawyers underestimated how much a webcam can reveal. “Some didn’t realise that you could be seen very clearly,” she laughs. “If you are a little dishevelled, it captures all of it.”

There were other hurdles. In September 2021, advocate Pratul Pratap Singh, who practises in the Supreme Court, was to speak before a bench, but realised that he could not intervene even after correctly logging in. His senior eventually had to physically go to the court. “I could not unmute,” he recalls.

A person appearing without a lawyer before an SC bench was muted by a moderator just as the bench began dictating the order. For at least eight minutes, the man kept speaking, unheard

Under the virtual system, those whose names do not appear with a designated item number are treated as viewers and cannot unmute and make interventions.

Years later, the system continues to be hobbled by some of these technical challenges.

Often, the virtual system does not keep pace with what’s happening. “It has happened quite a number of times that the judge has gone from case number 10 to 15, and the number on the display board has not been updated by the court staff, and it is still at 7,” says advocate Advait Tamhankar, a criminal lawyer practising in the Bombay High court.

“When we go to the court and say we missed the hearing, they say that there’s no proof that we were online,” Tamhankar says.

In a more sobering episode, a person appearing without a lawyer before a Supreme Court bench was muted by a moderator unfamiliar with the proceedings, just as the bench began dictating a 10-minute order. For at least eight minutes, the man kept speaking, unheard, “even pleading with folded hands,” unaware he’d been cut off, remembers Pratul Pratap Singh.

Delhi ahead of the rest

Advocate Abhinav Sekhri, a criminal lawyer who practises primarily in the Capital, says that during Covid, “in most other states, at best you could have this facility at the High Court level, whereas in Delhi, the focus was on onboarding the trial courts”.

By the end of 2021, he says, virtual hearings had become routine in most of Delhi’s courts. The contrast was stark with Mumbai, where, well into the pandemic, many trial courts remained largely offline and where, advocate Tamhankar says, lawyers still find themselves moving between video conferencing platforms.

Gujarat had been experimenting with live streaming of court proceedings on and off since 2020, when Covid struck. The Gujarat High Court formally went live on YouTube in July 2021 — a first across the country. By February 2023, Gujarat district courts were also live on YouTube.

Since 2022, the Supreme Court has been live-streaming key Constitutional bench hearings on YouTube. Gauhati, Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand and Orissa High Courts are also live on YouTube.

However, vast differences remain in the adoption of digital infrastructure. In Karnataka, district courts have followed the High Court and embraced technology with surprising flexibility, says Poovayya.

Telangana falls on the other side of the spectrum. “District courts in our state... not much,” says advocate Asad Hussain, a Hyderabad-based advocate.

Data submitted by the Ministry of Law and Justice to the Rajya Sabha in February 2026 underscores that while district courts under the Allahabad High Court had digitised nearly 169 crore pages of records by December 2025, Madhya Pradesh had digitised 66 crore pages, and Punjab & Haryana 62 crore pages. In contrast, Calcutta’s district courts and Nagaland reported no digitised district court records.



ILLUSTRATION: SUVANJIT DEY

● VIRTUAL COURTS: KEY NUMBERS

3,240	~3.93 crore	11	~35 lakh	~1.03 crore
court complexes, 1,272 jails have video conferencing facilities	cases conducted via video conferencing across HCs and district courts	High Courts have live streaming of court proceedings	daily hits on e-courts portal (covers HCs and lower courts)	cases have been filed electronically through e-filing platform

*Data as of December 31, 2025, as provided in Parliament in Feb 2026

‘I speak freely online’

Guruswamy says live streaming and virtual access have fundamentally altered the relationship between courts and the public, “democratising the practice of law”. Technically, courts have been open to everyone for decades, but most litigants had never heard their lawyers argue, and students outside major cities had rarely witnessed constitutional litigation. “Now, students come up and say they watched the arguments on YouTube before they joined law school,” says Guruswamy.

For lawyers, virtual hearings have cleared logistical obstacles.

Hussain says that earlier, lawyers appearing outside their home jurisdictions often depended on local counsel, clerks and other arrangements, but now, “with a Microsoft Word document, a PDF viewer and a laptop, you are good to go,” he says.

For litigants and clients, the information gap has narrowed. “Clients can see exactly what happened,” Hussain says, explaining that they do not have to rely on the lawyer’s version of events.

That visibility has changed behaviour on all sides. Poovayya credits “a greater number of eyes” with bringing “a level of maturity” to court hearings.

For decades, Pratul says, “what happened inside stayed inside.” Today, a stray observation travels far beyond the courtroom, he says, pointing to CJI Surya Kant’s widely discussed “cockroach” remark.

A clip from the Gujarat HC went viral when, mid-argument, a lawyer was heard saying on the phone, “Tell them my father has had a heart attack... his surgery is going on. I can’t be present”

Poovayya says his work now comes with a different tool kit. He began practising decades ago, when lawyers worked with typewriters, carbon copies and stacks of papers that had to be physically transported between courts. “As the most junior lawyer, you got the last carbon copy, and it was barely legible,” he says.

Today, his chambers have moved almost entirely to digital files, following what he calls a “zero paper policy”. “Now, I have multiple copies of these files on my handheld device that moves with me,” he says.

Also, research on a case happens amid arguments now. Juniors search for points and upload material directly into shared digital files. “Sometimes, in the middle of an argument, my files are getting updated as I speak,” Poovayya says.

Younger lawyers have adapted to the changes more easily. “Six briefs of a thousand pages you can’t carry to court. iPads and laptops have taken care of that,” advocate Tamhankar says.

For Delhi-based Maryam Junaid, who graduated from law school in 2024, virtual appearances are less intimidating. “Because I know nobody is watching me, I can just speak freely.”

For litigants, virtual courts have eliminated the costs of going to courts. Pratul, who is from Badaun in Uttar Pradesh, says this has encouraged more litigants to pursue remedies before higher forums.

Yet, many still believe that something is lost when advocacy moves entirely online. As Guruswamy wonders, “What happens to the introspective quality of a courtroom when everything is being broadcast? There is that element of persuasion in a physical courtroom — nothing can substitute it,” Guruswamy adds.

Pratul says that in a physical courtroom, “if judges are talking among themselves while you are arguing, even hearing one word can tell you what concerns them.”

Some judges say that in a physical court, it is easier for them to understand the issue, ask back-and-forth questions, and understand body language.

“Hearings are especially difficult when government lawyers appear virtually... They have to submit status reports or records, and often, this is done across the bench. For judges, tallying the online documents becomes difficult,” says a Delhi HC judge.

Individual judges can also lay out the manner and mode of conducting proceedings. For example, in Delhi HC, Justice C Hari Shankar has specified, “Presence of Advocates/ parties who appear virtually would not be marked if their camera is switched off.” Justice Girish Kathpalia has requested all those appearing virtually to “maintain proper decorum”. The Chief Justice’s court, too, has similar standing instructions.

What often tests the patience of judges are unmuted conversations seeping in mid-hearing, cross-communication, lawyers appearing from vehicles or without neck bands, and patchy Internet.

Earlier this year, a court clip from the Gujarat High Court went viral when, mid-argument, a lawyer was heard instructing, presumably his colleague, on the phone, “Tell them my father has had a heart attack and his surgery is going on — I can’t be present.” A brief pause later, he adds, “Let the court order whatever it wants, I will get it changed from the Supreme Court.”

For Poovayya, though, provided the technology works well, virtual hearings can sometimes offer lawyers a clearer view of a judge’s reactions. “Body language, mannerisms and thought process of a judge are often visualised in closer quarters,” he says.

Hussain recalls deliberately joining a hearing in a politically sensitive matter virtually, as the lawyers and counsel frequently spoke over one another. “If the bench wanted to hear our submissions, everyone else had to be quiet because we were the ones appearing online,” he says.

A reality check

The virtual infrastructure has worked with relatively little friction inside jails. The e-Mulakat system allows lawyers and family members to schedule video meetings with undertrial prisoners without physically queuing at a gate.

“No hassles,” Tamhankar says. “You don’t have to physically go to the jail, stand in line, fill out the form, and argue with the jail staff who are absolutely uncooperative. All this is avoided. You sit in your office and, before court hours, talk to the prisoner.”

The next frontier that lawyers are approaching is evidence recording. Sekri describes a recent case where his client in Chennai travelled to a court facility to give a statement to a judge in Madhya Pradesh via a video link. “It was fascinating,” says Sekri. “But these are few and far.”

But for every digital stride, there is a reality check.

India’s first district-level paperless e-court, in Delhi’s Karkardooma Court Complex, is a case in point, offering a glimpse into both the promise and fragility of judicial digitisation. Of the two LCD screens installed in 2010 to view digitised records, neither functions. The server crashed in 2016 and has not been restored since. The system, even today, continues to run on a 2G connection.

The Indian EXPRESS

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RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Between Iran blackmail and Trump bullying

WEST ASIA has once again descended into open conflict. For a third consecutive day, the United States launched strikes on Iran, and Tehran targeted US allies and commercial tankers, even as oil prices climbed to their highest level in a month. The June 14 Memorandum of Understanding, which established a ceasefire while allowing 60 days for negotiations on a broader settlement — almost half of which have gone by — has effectively collapsed. Days after Ali Khamenei's funeral, Iran has once again closed the Strait of Hormuz, while President Donald Trump has reinstated the US blockade. The rest of the world finds itself caught between Iran's dangerous blackmail and the Trump administration's perilous unilateralism.

President Trump's now-revoked plan of a 20 per cent fee on cargo transiting the Strait of Hormuz flagrantly contradicts repeated assurances of senior members of his own administration, including Vice President J D Vance and Secretary of State Marco Rubio, that no country can levy tolls or fees on an international waterway under international law. Such a charge would more than double the cost of shipping oil through the Strait. Arguably, Trump's threat also underscores the paucity of Washington's options in dealing with an Iranian regime unwilling to relinquish its chokehold over Hormuz. In retrospect, the US-Iran MoU's ambiguity over control of the Strait was far from being an oversight — it reflected irreconcilable positions that have set off the second major burst of violence since it was sealed. Tehran appears convinced that control over the Strait is the last and most potent card it has left to play, and is therefore determined to prevent the emergence of alternative routes that could erode that leverage. Its strategy of deterring ships from using US-coordinated alternatives will only sabotage the trust that is needed for a durable end to the hostilities.

Iran and the US do not need to become friends. They do, however, need to establish a minimum framework for engagement that does not crumble with every tug or pull. The consequences of failing to create such a baseline are regional and global: Civilians and seafarers continue to pay with their lives — one Indian crew member has been killed and one is missing after Iranian cruise missiles struck their tankers — while repeated disruptions to the Strait threaten energy supplies and global economic stability. No ceasefire can survive if the players slide back into belligerence and brinkmanship quite so easily.

Rising inflation complicates RBI's choice

RETAIL INFLATION has continued to edge upwards, according to the latest data, driven, in part, by the food, transportation and restaurant segments. CPI inflation stood at 4.38 per cent in June, up from 3.93 per cent the month before. This brings inflation in the quarter to 3.9 per cent. While this is marginally lower than the central bank's most recent projection of 4.2 per cent — this is also the last inflation reading before the August meeting of the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee — the MPC's decision isn't likely to be as straightforward as it may seem.

Disaggregated data shows that food inflation rose to 5.32 per cent, up from 4.78 per cent the month before, with ginger, tomato and raisin witnessing high inflation. But the outlook for food prices remains unclear. The cumulative rainfall in the current monsoon season from June 1 has been 19.3 per cent below normal. This has had an impact on kharif sowing, with overall acreage down 16 per cent from last year. The sowing window is closing. And as El Niño strengthens, the situation is uncertain, complicating matters for the MPC. Alongside the rise in food prices, the sharp increase in inflation in the transport segment reflects the petrol and diesel price hikes — June witnessed the full impact of the mid-May price hikes — while the increase in food and energy prices is finding its way to the restaurant category. Some analysts expect the pass through of higher input and fuel prices into prices of other non-food items to exert further upward pressure, even if gradually.

In its last meeting, the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee had maintained status quo on both rates and stance. While crude oil prices have fallen off the highs thereafter, renewed hostilities in West Asia have complicated matters — over the last five days, Brent crude oil has edged up 7.5 per cent. Much will depend on how MPC members view the external and internal risks to growth and inflation. Global central banks have already begun to react. In its June meeting, the European Central Bank had raised interest rates. Its next decision will be announced next week. The US Fed is also scheduled to hold its meeting later this month. Their decisions will indicate the direction of monetary policy in developed economies.

The mystery of life on Earth is sweet

SUGAR, IT has become a cliché to say, is the new tobacco. There are certainly parallels between the two products — both were linchpins of colonial expansion, are addictive health hazards and their harms were long hidden by big business. But sugar isn't just a delicious villain, a dietary decadence, or an indulgence. Before it became the chief cause of obesity, it was a building block of life. Sugars are essential components of DNA and RNA, building blocks of cells and the primary source of energy, even in the simplest and earliest life forms. Till recently, though, their origins on Earth were a mystery.

A research paper published in *Nature Astronomy* earlier this week strengthens the case that life on Earth was made possible by travellers from space. Researchers used two powerful radio telescopes to study the Milky Way's Interstellar Medium — all the dust and molecules outside of solar systems — and detected four-carbon sugars. The saccharine deep-space travellers likely hitched a ride to this planet on asteroids that crashed onto the surface, and became the fuel for the spark of life.

In some ways, there is a delightful irony to the interstellar origins of sugar. Too many people, too often, are weighed down — sometimes literally — by the calories in their sweet treats, by the creeping numbers on an annual blood test. To know, in some small way, that the dietary villain of the 21st century is an unsung alien hero at the root of all life, floating through space, without weight, is comforting. And, perhaps, the odd dessert can now be seen not just as indulgence but homage to all that sugar has given this planet.



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

BARELY A week after Ayatollah Ali Khamenei was laid to rest in Mashhad, Iran and the United States are trading blows again. The collapse of the ceasefire and the intensification of military hostilities in the Gulf is a reminder that the “third republic” now emerging in Tehran is being forged in the crucible of war and peace with America.

Iran's internal rearrangement after Khamenei cannot be separated from its prolonged conflict with the US. The nature and terms of engagement with Washington have become the principal fault lines in the struggle to shape the new political order in Iran. The Indian foreign policy community must come to terms with post-Khamenei Iran entering a period of internal restructuring and external reorientation, with important consequences for India's interests in the Middle East and beyond. It must also pay more attention to the internal debates in Iran on the nation's future.

For nearly four decades, Khamenei stood at the apex of a state that combined clerical authority with the expanding power of the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps. The transition to a new order was bound to be contested. The American-Israeli military campaigns of 2025 and 2026, culminating in

Khamenei's assassination earlier this year, compressed what might have been a gradual political transition into an abrupt one.

The swift elevation of Mojtaba Khamenei as Supreme Leader has not resolved the deeper questions surrounding the succession. There is intense jockeying among the different factions constituting the Iranian establishment. As the anti-government demonstrations at the turn of this year have shown, there is also a serious questioning of the political legitimacy of the Islamic Republic.

What distinguishes Iran's transition is that it is unfolding in a state of conflict and engagement with the US. The nuclear question, sanctions relief, Gulf security, navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, and Iran's regional role are all now in play. Every choice the new Iranian leadership makes about escalation or restraint is also a choice about the internal balance of power — and every internal realignment reshapes Iran's capacity to make war or peace with Washington.

To see where post-Khamenei Iran might be heading, it is useful to view the Islamic Republic's evolution in two distinct phases. The first republic emerged from the 1979 revolution under Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini. It was defined by revolutionary mobilisation, the Iran-Iraq War, and the transformation of a broad anti-monarchical movement into a state dominated by the clergy. Institutions were built around the doctrine of *velayat-e-faqih* that places ultimate authority in the hands of the religious figure.

The second republic belonged to Khamenei. He inherited a country devastated by the eight-

For realists, the question is about the nature and degree of change in Iran. Iran's relationship with America sits at the heart of the unfinished debate on the organising principles of the third republic

One deletion and cascading civil disabilities



JOHN BRITTAS

WHEN A nation turns alien to one of its own, it does so not with conquest but with the quiet stroke of a pen. R Rajagopal, former editor of *The Telegraph*, watched his name vanish from West Bengal's electoral rolls in a routine revision, stripping him of his vote and stalling his passport.

The furore over the denial of his passport (which he eventually received), and the remarks by Bombay High Court judge Madhav Jamdar affirming the fundamental right to protest, have brought in some fresh air. Yet the warning remains. The state that begins by forgetting its people on paper can end by making them strangers in their own land.

Every constitutional democracy must revise its electoral rolls. Every sovereign nation must verify the credentials of those to whom it issues passports. Every statute has its own purpose, every authority its own jurisdiction and every administrative process its own legal consequences. What should concern us is when the consequence of one statutory process begins to migrate into different legal domains, producing disabilities that Parliament never contemplated and the governing statute never authorised.

The Constitution deliberately fragments public power. That is one of liberty's most effective safeguards. The Passport Authority administers the Passports Act. The Election Commission administers the Representation of the People Act. Citizenship is governed by the Citizenship Act. Income tax authorities administer fiscal legislation. Each functions within defined legislative boundaries. The rule of law depends as much upon this institutional separation as upon judicial review itself. The concern arises when the boundaries begin to dissolve.

The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) was conceived as an electoral exercise to improve the accuracy of electoral rolls. It was never intended to become a parallel mechanism for regulating passports, licences, welfare benefits or other civil rights. Whether the SIR has been properly conducted or whether individual deletions are justified are questions that belong to electoral law and, where necessary, to constitutional adjudication. The constitutional concern here arises when

SIR was conceived as an electoral exercise to improve the accuracy of electoral rolls. It was never intended to become a parallel mechanism for regulating passports, licences, welfare benefits or other civil rights

the consequences of an electoral exercise begin to migrate into statutory fields for which Parliament has prescribed entirely different legal frameworks. Suppose electoral exclusion starts affecting passport renewal. Tomorrow it may influence professional licences, public employment, banking, taxation, education, welfare entitlements or even the right to file a writ petition before the Supreme Court (SC) — not because Parliament has legislated such consequences, but because one administrative authority begins relying upon another's conclusions without independently applying the statute it administers.

Administrative law has long resisted this. SC's decision in *Maneka Gandhi* transformed passport administration by insisting that restrictions on personal liberty must satisfy standards of fairness, reasonableness and due process. The judgment constitutionalised administrative discretion itself. Public authorities may no longer act mechanically. They must independently apply the law governing them. If deletion from the electoral roll becomes sufficient to deny passport renewal, an electoral exercise acquires consequences never contemplated by the Passports Act. The issue then becomes a question of constitutional method.

The danger, therefore, is not that one journalist may temporarily remain without a passport. The greater danger is the emergence of what may be called a “cascade of civil disabilities” where the consequence of one administrative process travels across multiple statutory regimes until a single determination begins to shape rights.

That is why the present controversy deserves attention far beyond the immediate facts. It is not fundamentally about passports. It is about preserving the constitutional discipline that every public authority must remain faithful to the statute it administers, every restriction upon liberty must have legislative authority, and every citizen is entitled to have his rights determined by law, not by the unintended spillover of administrative decisions.

(with inputs from Aneesh Babu)

Brittas is a CPI(M) Rajya Sabha MP



GOWD KIRAN KUMAR

RECENT NEWS reports indicate that the rehearsal for the second phase of Census 2027 includes an “open column” for recording caste. While the government has clarified that the final methodology will be decided after evaluating feedback from the test exercise, experience from previous surveys suggests that relying solely on an open-text response without a standardised coding framework can undermine the objective of caste enumeration.

The experience of the Socio-Economic and Caste Census (SECC), 2011 is a cautionary example. The use of an open column resulted in over 46 lakh different caste entries, largely due to spelling variations, regional names, sub-castes, synonyms, and inconsistent reporting. As a result, the data could not be effectively classified or officially released for policy purposes. This stands in contrast to earlier and more structured exercises. The 1931 Census recorded approximately 4,147 castes, while the Anthropological Survey of India identified around 6,325 castes in 1951. More recently, states that adopted a standardised coding methodology have shown that accurate enumeration is feasible and reliable.

The Bihar Caste Survey (2023) identified 209 castes, including 112 in the recognised state list of Extremely Backward Classes, 30 under OBCs, 22 SCs, 32 STs, seven Upper Castes, and two Other Related Castes. The Telangana Socio-Economic, Educational, Employment, Political and Caste Survey, 2024 identified 242 castes: 133 Backward Classes, 59 Scheduled Castes, 32 Scheduled Tribes, and 18 Other Castes. Both relied on officially recognised caste lists and assigned standardised codes to each caste, ensuring consistency and minimising duplication.

As the Union government finalises the methodology for Census 2027, it must constitute an expert committee to determine the authoritative source for caste coding. The committee should examine what the framework should be based on: State-wise lists of SCs, STs, and OBCs; the central list of OBCs maintained by the National Commission for Backward Classes; the caste database maintained by the Anthropological Survey of India; or a harmonised national master list integrating these while accommodating state-specific variations. The identification of Upper Castes also requires a clear framework. Since EWS certificates are issued to persons belonging to communities not included in the SC, ST, or OBC categories, the government already has an administrative basis for identifying such communities. This can be refined and incorporated into the Census coding methodology. An open column should remain available only to capture genuine omissions, new caste names, or regional variations.

A well-designed caste census is not merely about counting communities; it is about generating accurate data to identify deprivation, measure inequality, and formulate targeted policies for communities that remain socially and educationally backward. The success of Census 2027 will depend on the government's ability to classify every recorded caste through a transparent, standardised, and nationally accepted coding system.

The experience of the Socio-Economic and Caste Census, 2011 is a cautionary example. The use of an open column resulted in over 46 lakh different caste entries, largely due to spelling variations, sub-castes and inconsistent reporting

The writer is national president, All India OBC Students Association

40 YEARS AGO

July 15, 1986



Apparent truce in Punjab

TERRORISTS ARE understood to have decided to observe a month-long “truce” in Punjab. The decision is believed to have been conveyed by the terrorist groups to the ruling as well as breakaway Akali leaderships through intermediaries. During June alone, terrorists had killed 117 persons in the troubled state. At present, three of four major terrorist groups are operating in Punjab, apparently without a unified command.

Total bandh immobilises Goa

A WATER pipeline was dynamited, markets and educational institutions remained closed and traffic came to a standstill as the one-day

Goa Bandh called by Marathi-language propagandists ended peacefully. Even as former CM Shashikala Kakodkar was arrested along with her supporters outside the Assembly, Chief Minister Pratapsingh Rane warned that miscreants indulging in arson would be shot

India, Bangladesh to talk it out

INDIA AND Bangladesh took note of mutual differences and resolved to sort out the outstanding issues by approaching them in a spirit of mutual understanding. The resolve was expressed in the speeches of President Zail Singh and the visiting Bangladesh President, Lt-Gen H M Ershad, at a banquet in New Delhi. Earlier, the Bangladesh leader had an hour-long meeting with Prime Minister, Rajiv

Gandhi during which various outstanding bilateral issues were discussed. The progress achieved in SAARC since the last summit was reviewed by the leaders. They also discussed measures for effecting a consensus on the location of the proposed SAARC secretariat.

Five killed in Ahmedabad

FIVE PERSONS were stabbed to death in Ahmedabad city, raising the toll in the current violence in the state to 58 in the last six days. Unconfirmed reports said at least 13 persons were killed in stabbings during the day. Two persons were stabbed to death in the Ambawadi locality and two on Satellite Road in Jodhpur Tekra. One person was knifed to death in the Bhudarpura area.



Ram Temple was built on faith. It can only be honoured through accountability



YASHOVARDHAN JHA AZAD

THE GREATEST theft at Ayodhya was not of money. It was a matter of trust. The Ram Mandir Trust is called a “trust” for a reason. The first duty of the trustees was not to manage property but to protect the faith reposed in them by millions. That is why the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya is unlike any other financial scam. Millions of Indians donated voluntarily. Some offered a day’s wages, others jewellery, pension savings or family heirlooms. They donated because they believed they were participating in a historic civilisational moment. They believed every rupee would be used in the service of Maryada Purushottam Ram, who symbolises truth, justice and integrity.

The handling of the affair, therefore, raises more disturbing questions than the alleged theft itself. Ironically, the first question concerns the very institution entrusted with safeguarding the devotees’ offerings. When serious allegations of large-scale financial irregularities emerge and preliminary inquiries point to systemic failures, the obvious question is whether the governing body itself should remain unchanged while investigations are underway. The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust was constituted with the approval of the Union government. Its general secretary and trustee have resigned. But if its systems failed comprehensively, then why was the trust itself not suspended or dismissed, once investigations began? This is not about presuming guilt but preserving institutional credibility.

The second question relates to the role of the senior bureaucrats associated with the trust. Civil servants are trained to associate accountability with responsibility. If senior officers had positions in an institution handling enormous public donations, what precisely was their oversight role? Were they only there to exude power, or also to ensure financial discipline?



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

Public institutions cannot operate on the principle that authority resides at the top, but accountability stops at the bottom. Two trust members have resigned. What about the bureaucrats on the trust?

The third concern is the investigative approach adopted from the beginning. Every investigator knows that time is the greatest enemy in financial crime. Electronic records can be altered, CCTV images overwritten, digital trails erased, assets transferred, and witnesses influenced. Yet, the initial response was shockingly unprofessional. Instead of immediately lodging an FIR and preserving every possible piece of evidence, the process began with administrative mechanisms.

Hence, many questions remain unanswered. Could evidence have been better preserved? Were banking records, digital devices and financial transactions secured immediately?

The fourth issue concerns the nature of the investigation itself. An SIT can be an effective mechanism, but only if it is equipped with the expertise the case demands. Allegations involving substantial public donations, complex financial transactions and extensive documentary evidence require far more than an administrative inquiry. They call for specialists in financial

The money belonged to the devotees, hence they have a legitimate moral claim to know how the investigation is progressing. What safeguards have already been introduced? What systemic failures have been identified?

forensics, cyber investigations, accounting, procurement, banking records and digital evidence, working alongside experienced investigators and legal experts. The objective must be not merely to establish the facts but to build a case that can withstand judicial scrutiny. When public faith and large sums of money are at stake, the investigation should be entrusted to the most competent multidisciplinary team available.

The fifth concern is institutional independence. The SIT’s findings reportedly moved through senior administrative channels, including functionaries associated with the trust. That inevitably creates a public perception of an inquiry moving within the same administrative loop whose functioning itself is under scrutiny. Justice must not merely be done; it must also be seen to be done. In matters involving public faith, visible independence becomes as important as legal correctness.

The sixth issue is the astonishing proposal floated by a retired bureaucrat that the solution lies in appointing yet another bureaucrat as chief executive officer. This reflects the thinking that has weakened governance across many public institutions. The question is not whether the CEO should be a bureaucrat or someone from the private sector. The question is

whether the appointment process identifies the best professional available through an open, transparent and merit-based search. Managing one of the world’s most important religious institutions demands expertise in finance, audit, procurement, compliance, technology, risk management and institutional governance. Replacing one bureaucratic layer with another without first fixing accountability merely treats the symptom while ignoring the disease.

The seventh issue is transparency. The money belonged to the devotees, hence they have a legitimate moral claim to know how the investigation is progressing. What safeguards have already been introduced? What systemic failures have been identified? Without compromising the probe, periodic public briefings will strengthen people’s confidence.

Finally, this episode compels the government and opposition parties to revisit the larger question of the relationship between governments and religious institutions.

The state has a legitimate interest in ensuring that institutions receiving enormous public donations function honestly and lawfully. But bureaucratic supervision must never become a substitute for professional governance of temples, mosques, churches, or gurdwaras, which handle hundreds or thousands of crores. That requires professionally selected executives, independent boards, mandatory forensic audits, transparent procurement, digital accounting, conflict-of-interest declarations, whistleblower protection and periodic public disclosure of audited accounts.

The Ram Temple was never intended to be merely a magnificent structure of stone. It was meant to represent the ideals of the man whose name it bears — truth, duty, sacrifice, integrity and justice. That faith of millions now must be honoured, not with new promises, committees or with cosmetic administrative rearrangements, but with the full force of an independent, professional and transparent investigation. Because this was never about stolen money only, but also about stolen faith.

The writer is a retired IPS officer who has served as central information commissioner; secretary, security, GOI; and special director, Intelligence Bureau

Tourism can unlock India’s journey to a new milestone



PUNEET CHHATWAL

INDIA’S TOURISM and hospitality sector is emerging as one of the key contributors to the nation’s economic growth story with a GDP share of about 7 per cent. It is a catalyst for employment generation with every direct job creating multiple indirect jobs, accounting for over 9 per cent of total jobs in India. In addition, it drives entrepreneurship, infrastructure development and foreign exchange earnings, and positions India’s soft power on the global stage.

As India aspires to become one of the world’s leading tourism economies, the opportunity lies beyond attracting visitors to unlocking the economic value of its natural, cultural and spiritual assets. India’s tourism wealth is a strategic asset capable of generating broad-based economic growth.

India’s hospitality sector has moved decisively beyond post-pandemic recovery. Occupancy levels across major markets have consistently remained strong, average room rates have surpassed pre-pandemic levels and demand continues to be buoyant. This has enhanced investor confidence and strengthened the industry’s ability to invest in capacity-building, innovation and guest experiences. The sector’s growing attractiveness is reflected in rising participation from institutional funds, family offices, listed hotel companies and developers. While institutional investment has grown, it remains below the levels seen in more mature hospitality markets. This presents a significant opportunity.

A defining characteristic of India’s current tourism growth cycle is the emergence of a more distributed demand landscape. For decades, much of the hospitality industry’s performance was concentrated in a handful of metropolitan cities and established destinations. Today, growth is increasingly driven by Tier-II and Tier-III cities, creating a more diversified and resilient ecosystem.

Infrastructure development is reinforcing this transformation. The expansion of regional airports, improvements in road networks and the development of economic and industrial corridors are fundamentally reshaping tourism flows. Every new airport, highway, convention facility or transport link has the potential to unlock new destinations, stimulate local investment,

and create hospitality demand. Airport-centric development is emerging as a significant driver of hotel growth, supported by business travel, transit stays, meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions. Tourism and infrastructure are becoming increasingly interdependent, each amplifying the impact of the other.

Realising the potential of tourism requires greater alignment between infrastructure, investment, policy and destination development. Hospitality development should therefore be integrated into broader economic planning, ensuring that investments in airports, highways and urban infrastructure are complemented by destination readiness, accommodation capacity and visitor experiences. Policy support will play a critical role in unlocking the \$3-trillion travel and tourism opportunity.



ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

The Federation of Associations in Indian Tourism & Hospitality (FAITH), the apex body representing India’s tourism and hospitality sector, has called for a time-bound action agenda to position India as a global tourism powerhouse. Key priorities include granting industry status to tourism across all states, which will improve access to capital and reduce financing costs. The government should fast-track the development of 50 tourism destinations on mission mode, supported by clear implementation timelines. Simultaneously, India needs a dedicated global tourism promotion campaign under a strong Brand Bharat initiative with sustained funding. A more liberal visa regime, including expanded e-visa access and simplified entry procedures, can significantly boost inbound tourism. Investment in tourism infrastructure ranging from last-mile connectivity to wayside amenities and digital infrastructure will further elevate visitor experience. Rationalising taxation to align with global benchmarks and creating a single-window clearance will encourage greater private sector participation.

As India charts its path toward becoming a leading tourism destination, the challenge is no longer proving the sector’s potential, it is harnessing it at scale. The multiplier effect of tourism ensures that economic benefits extend well beyond hotels and travel companies, reaching communities across urban and rural India. Few sectors have the ability to create such broad-based prosperity while simultaneously showcasing a nation’s heritage, diversity and identity. That is the true essence of “Incredible India, Invaluable Economics” — recognising tourism as a powerful pathway to national growth, prosperity and global influence.

The writer is chairman, Federation of Associations in Indian Tourism and Hospitality

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

SIR grievances

ONE WISHES that Ram Sewak Sharma’s perspective on the ECI’s highly flawed SIR had come earlier (‘On SIR, listen to digital governance pioneer’, *IE*, July 14), as it may have strengthened the voices critical of the exercise and given ammunition to the petitioners’ case before the Supreme Court. Millions have been disproportionately burdened by a document-heavy process, with many losing their right to vote.

Kamal Laddha, Bengaluru

Legendary chapter

S JANAKI’S death closes a chapter that began in 1957 with her debut Tamil song for *Vidhiyin Vilayattu* and stretched across six decades of shifting musical tastes (‘Night-ingle falls silent, her song lives’, *IE*, July 14). Songs such as ‘Singara Velane Deva’ and ‘Senthooora Poove’ still capture what made her early career soar: A natural soprano, untouched by formal training and sharpened instead by hours spent mimicking Lata Mangeshkar on the radio and performing at her uncle’s theatre shows. Institutions preserving film music history should now digitise and catalogue her vast repertoire before it fades from public access.

A. Myilsami, Coimbatore

Statehood question

IF RESTORING statehood to Jammu and Kashmir is essential for democratic representation (‘Omar is spot on, doesn’t need Trump clickbait’, *IE*, July 14), the same constitutional principle should extend to Ladakh. Its people have consistently sought stronger constitutional safeguards, and Sonam Wangchuk’s hunger strike has once again drawn national attention to their aspirations. A democracy should not wait for prolonged protests or fasts to respond to legitimate demands. Equal constitutional dignity, meaningful representation, and responsive governance for both Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh must remain the Centre’s priority.

Harsh Pawaria, Rohtak



E P UNNY

WHEN DAVID Low died in 1963 in England, obituary writers lamented that the world had lost its best cartoonist, some wondering whether there would be anyone remotely like him anytime soon. Low was arguably cartooning’s first global star. His fame went beyond the UK, the US and Europe to British colonies, across the English-reading Commonwealth nations. There was a vast cartoon readership that missed Low. They didn’t have to wait for long for a worthy successor. In just about a year after Low’s death, Patrick Oliphant emerged in the US.

Like Low, a New Zealander who stormed Fleet Street, Oliphant was a migrant from neighbouring Australia. The 29-year-old left home on a Friday in 1964 and arrived in the US to start work at *The Denver Post* the next Monday. He was picked from a long list of 50 American applicants. American newspaper editors were looking beyond the national borders for the best in the business. This is what the British editors did when the art practice peaked there. At least two young Indian cartoonists found work in London in the 1950s, Abu Abraham and Rajinder Puri.

Post World War II, the global capital of cartooning shifted across the Atlantic from London to Washington, even as the media space was being increas-

Oliphant got the perfect presidential target to unleash his savage cartooning. Richard Nixon came to power and the rest was cartooning history, not just in the US, but the world over

ingly invaded by television. From 1 per cent in the late 1940s, 90 per cent of American homes had a TV set by 1960. Newsrooms knew the best way to compete with the moving image was visually, and a stinging visual was even better. Oliphant fit the bill.

Oliphant cartooned the Cold War as mercilessly as Low did the World War. The task was tougher because unlike Low’s targets — foreign leaders like Adolf Hitler, Benito Mussolini, Joseph Stalin and Francisco Franco — Oliphant had to pick on duly elected American presidents, from Lyndon Johnson and Richard Nixon to the two Bushes and Barack Obama. Looking back, one shudders to think that he was a fault-finding migrant in the host country — he became a naturalised American citizen only in 1979. This is unthinkable in these Trumpian times. If you are a cartoon watcher, you won’t rate the world’s most seasoned democracy at 250 kindly.

The Washington Post lost its Pulitzer-winning cartoonist Ann Telnaes last year. Back then, in the last century, even the wildest of US presidents would grin and bear a widely syndicated celebrity cartoonist with a Pulitzer under his belt. Oliphant had won his in 1967 for the iconic Vietnam War cartoon depicting Ho Chi Minh carrying a dead Viet Cong

soldier wondering, “They won’t get us to the Conference table... will they?”

In another three years, Oliphant got the perfect presidential target to unleash his savage cartooning. Richard Nixon came to power and the rest was cartooning history, not just in the US, but the world over. Nixon won worldwide attention as the most notorious American president with the Watergate scandal of 1973 and 1974. Enough for Abu Abraham to honour his exit in this paper with a stunningly deadpan drawing of the White House with a plaque that read: “Richard Milhous Nixon (1969-1974) lied here.”

It was a perfect minimalist foil to a richly detailed Oliphant cartoon done a year back when Pablo Picasso died. At the breakfast table with the first lady, the president glances at the artist’s obit in the morning paper and is visibly relieved, “Thank God he wasn’t a cartoonist.” The entire frame was a cubist rendering that pushed every element in it, including the human forms, to extreme distortion. The caricatured couple was readily recognisable, flat and fractured, as Picasso would have drawn them at his cubist best.

A lesser cartoonist couldn’t have conceived it and a lesser artist couldn’t have executed it.

The writer is chief political cartoonist, The Indian Express. ep.unny@expressindia.com

Adieu, Pat Oliphant, who skewered presidents

India’s biggest parking problem is that it’s free

of a visitor. These stories of violent disputes force us to stop and wonder: How is the challenge to be handled? What if cities legalised parking on public land for a price? Would it reduce conflicts?

The underlying cause is the growth in car ownership in India’s urban areas, particularly in the metropolises, and shrinking of free parking spaces. It also comes from a strong sense of entitlement to the public space in front of one’s house.

A few states and cities have adopted policy frameworks that specifically address residential parking. For instance, Comprehensive Policy on Traffic, Road Safety, Encroachment and Cattle Menace for Ahmedabad City (2026) stipulates that no development permission shall be granted without a pre-building use parking compliance. The Odisha Comprehensive State

Parking Policy (2026) includes provisions for residential parking permits. Maharashtra’s “No Parking, No Car” policy (2025) requires residents of large urban centres to present proof of an authorised parking space for registration of new vehicles. Bengaluru’s Management and Maintenance of Parking Rules, 2018, later integrated into Parking Policy 2.0 (2021), mandates paid on-street parking across the city, including in front of your house, and proof of parking for new vehicle registrations. The Delhi Maintenance and

Paid parking systems can help reclaim footpaths, reduce congestion, improve emergency access, and create disincentives for families to own multiple cars

Management of Parking Rules, 2017 proposed a system for on-street paid parking in residential areas that included double the normal parking charge for spillover from stilt parking. It was supported by the Supreme Court but full citywide enforcement is far from being achieved. However, the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 and the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989 do not require proof of an ensured parking space as a precondition for registering a new car anywhere in India.

Expert opinion is clearly against free parking on public land. Proponents of David Harvey’s “Right to the City” approach argue that free or subsidised parking on roads represents elite capture of valuable public land by a car-owning minority and that it creates severe inequality. Donald Shoup, urban planning professor at UCLA, in his book *Parking and the City*, argues that free over-

supply of parking increases excessive car use, congestion and housing costs, and that appropriately priced parking can lead to more efficient, equitable, and sustainable cities.

Indian cities facing rapid motorisation and limited street space have no option but to move toward regulated, priced, and permit-based residential parking. Paid parking systems can help reclaim footpaths, reduce congestion, improve emergency access, and create disincentives for families to own multiple cars. Additionally, parking fees can provide a stable source of revenue for urban local bodies, which can be reinvested in improving public goods such as transport, pedestrian infrastructure, green areas and neighbourhood amenities.

The writer is a senior fellow at the Centre for Policy Research, New Delhi. Views are personal



TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking
& An ISO 27001-2022 Certified Company)

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The APTRANSCO invites bids online for the following work with Spec. No: PMMTC2-e-34/2026. Name of the Work: Supply, Erection / Stringing and Commissioning of OPGW cable and associated equipment under PSD funding for providing reliable communication system upto 132 kV substations in Six Lots. Date & Time of availability of Tender on e-procurement platform i.e., www.tender.approcurement.gov.in on 15.07.2026 @ 17:00Hrs. Contact No. Dy.Eng: 8352949383. R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/101/26-27 **Sd/- CHIEF ENGINEER/TELECOM&IT**



BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(Wholly owned by Government of Karnataka undertaking)
(CIN-U04010KA20025GCO30438)

TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through KPP Portal)

BESCOM invites tenders vide Enquiry No.: BESCOM/2026-27/ SE0468 through KPP portal platform from eligible Bidders for "GIS Based Asset Mapping Survey and Digitization of Electrical Assets In Peri Urban Area of BESCOM For Implementation of Distribution Automation System (DAS) and 20 IPDS Town of BESCOM for Incremental Asset Data updation".
Bid Documents available: 22.07.2026, 04:00 P.M. onwards. The Tenders can be obtained through KPP portal web-site <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. Aspiring Bidders need to register on KPP portal. Further Bidders can take assistance with KPP help desk contact numbers (080-46010000, 080-68948777) or email at support@eprocelpdesk.com. **Sd/-**
For Electricity related complaints call: 1912 **The General Manager**
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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Devender @ Tanu S/o Hardeep Singh R/o H.No. D-414, Gali No. 4, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 613/2022 u/s 25 Arms Act at P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Devender @ Tanu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Devender @ Tanu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Devender @ Tanu** accused of **FIR No. 613/2022 u/s 25 Arms Act at P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **13.10.2026**.
By Order: Ms. Jyoti Nain,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North,
Court No. 06, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.



VARTHANA FINANCE PRIVATE LIMITED

Registered Office at: No. 5 B-110, Varasdhidi, 3rd Floor, Outer Ring Road, Service Road, 3rd Block, HSRBT Layout, Kalyan Nagar, Bangalore-560043.
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Branch Office :Unit no.36, Second Floor, Pearls Omaxe Tower, Plot B-1, Netaji Subash Palace, Pitampura, Delhi-110034.

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR AUCTION FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Asset under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, read with Rule 8(6) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Mortgagor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of M/s. Varthana Finance Private Ltd, Delhi, (Formerly known as Thirumani Finance Private Ltd) will be sold on 14-08-2026 (Friday) at 1 p.m., "As is where is", "As is what is", and "What-ever there is" basis, for recovery of below mentioned loan account. The details of the Borrower(s)/ Mortgagor(s) Secured Assets/ Dues/ Reserve Price/ Auction date & time, EMD & Bid increase amount are mentioned below :-
Name of The Borrowers/Mortgagors :- 1. M/s. Sarvodaya Public School, Represented by its Authorized Signatory, 2. M/s. Sarvodaya Welfare & Education Society, Represented by its Authorized Signatory, 3. Mr. Shabbir Ahmed S/o Mohamed Ilyas, 4. Mr. Mubin Khan S/o Insaad Ali, Loan Account No.324DE.028935.
Details of Total Outstanding Amount in Rupees :- Rs. 24,90,081/- (Rupees Twenty Four Lakh Ninety Thousand and Eighty one only) as on 01-07-2026, together with further agreed contractual rate of interest plus legal costs/charges, full realization of the entire amount.
Details of Immovable Property: All that the Part and Parcel of the Land area measuring Property and area measuring 3811.55 Sq. Yards (6 Kanal and 6 Marla), comprised in the Khaska No.110/2 (7-16), 99/21/2 (1-7) and 22 (6-3) Situated in the Layout Plan of Village Sakras Tehsil Firpozpur Jirkhka, District Mewat (Nuh) Haryana and Bounded by :- East : House of Mamraj, West : 16 ft wide Street, North : Agricultural Land, South : Land of Others/Road 20ft wide .
The Reserve Price of the above Properties will be Rs. 75,25,560/- and the Earnest Money Deposit will be (EMD 10% of Reserve Price) Rs. 7,52,556/-.
Known Encumbrances, if any :- Nil.
Intending bidders should submit their EMD amount and Bid amount along with KYC documents (PAN Card and Aadhaar/Voters ID/Driving Licenses) and Rs. 1,00,00/- being Non-refundable Tender fee by way of Demand Draft/ Pay Order drawn on a Scheduled Bank, favoring "M/s. Varthana Finance Private Limited", payable at Delhi before 3 p.m. on or before 13-08-2026 (Thursday).
The Auction will be held at : Unit no.36, Second Floor, Pearls Omaxe Tower, Plot B-1, Netaji Subash Palace, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, on 14-08-2026 (Friday) at 1.00 p.m.
For detailed terms and conditions of the Sale, please refer to the link provided in Company's website i.e. : www.varthana.com.
The prospective bidders may contact the Authorized Officer Mr. Adithya - Phone No.9778820906, Ms. Deepa Jaya Suvarna - Phone No. 9702355034.
Date :- 11-07-2026
Place :- Bangalore
Authorized Officer
Varthana Finance Pvt. Ltd.



UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR

OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD
R and B DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR JAMMU
Short e-NIT No.35of 2026-2027 Dated:-11-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No.	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advised Cost Rs. (in Lacs)	Cost of document (in Rs)	Earnest Money (in Rs)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	Expansion of joints Strengthening of roofs for water seepage in all blocks of IGGDH Jammu.	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	17.10	600	2% of Advertised Cost	90 Days	23-07-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A,B,&C"
2	Up gradation of drainage system in and around boys, girls hostel and academic block at IGGDH Jammu	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	19.42	600	2% of Advertised Cost	90 Days	23-07-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A, B,&C"
3	Up gradation of Machinery room at IGGDC Jammu.	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	14.45	600	2% of Advertised Cost	90 Days	23-07-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A,B,C&D"
4	Providing and laying of interlocking Paver tiles in front of emergency block of IGGDH Jammu	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	4.84	600	2% of Advertised Cost	30 Days	23-07-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A, B ,C,&D"
5	Providing and fixing of Fabricated structural shed at the entrance of additional block of IGGDCJ Jammu.	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	18.66	600	2% of Advertised Cost	90 Days	23-07-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A, B,&C"
6	Remodelling of water system of block D emergency ward of IGGDCJ Jammu.	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	9.67	600	2% of Advertised Cost	90 Days	23-07-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A, B ,C,&D"

Position of AAA/TS:
The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website <http://jtenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	11-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 11-07-2026 to 22-07-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	-
4	Bid submission Start Date	11-07-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	22-07-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	23-07-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender documents in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to MH 0059 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu and upload the same in e-treasury challan / receipt, Earnest Money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/IG pledged to Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu The CDR/FDR/IG shall be valid for 45 days before the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 to be submitted to the Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu at the time of allotment.
2. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidder needs not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential-submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.
3. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site [www.jtenders.gov.in](http://jtenders.gov.in) and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu The date for same shall be intimated separately.
4. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical Bids.
5. The earnest money shall be forfeited, if:-
a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issue of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJG/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.
6. Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process.
6.1 Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the "Downloads" option as well as from "Bidders Manual Kit" on website www.jtenders.gov.in to acquire bid submission process.
6.2 To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get "Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)" as per Information Technology Act-2008. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors.
6.3 The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic format with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.
6.4 Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.
6.5 Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid online.

Sd/-
(ER. SANDEEP GUPTA)
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division
Bakshi Nagar

Position of AAA/TS:
The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website <http://jtenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	11-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 11-07-2026 to 22-07-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	-
4	Bid submission Start Date	11-07-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	22-07-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	23-07-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender documents in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to MH 0059 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu and upload the same in e-treasury challan / receipt, Earnest Money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/IG pledged to Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu The CDR/FDR/IG shall be valid for 45 days before the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 to be submitted to the Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu at the time of allotment.
2. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidder needs not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential-submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.
3. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site [www.jtenders.gov.in](http://jtenders.gov.in) and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu The date for same shall be intimated separately.
4. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical Bids.
5. The earnest money shall be forfeited, if:-
a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issue of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJG/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.
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6.3 The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic format with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.
6.4 Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.
6.5 Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid online.

Sd/-
(ER. SANDEEP GUPTA)
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division
Bakshi Nagar



ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Rayapudi, Amaravati-522237, Andhra Pradesh.

PROUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

Name of Work: APCRDA - Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Consultant to Provide Comprehensive Multi-layered Third-Party Quality Assurance & Quality Control Services for infrastructure and construction works of development in Amaravati Capital City, Andhra Pradesh, India". The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 15.07.2026 to 05.08.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs., Due date for submission of Bid is 05.08.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs., Technical bid opening 05.08.2026 @16.00 Hrs. For further details Please refer to www.approcurement.gov.in and www.crda.ap.gov.in.
Sd/- Commissioner, APCRDA, Amaravati

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Shrif S/o Khan Mohamad, R/o Village Dhera Banjara, PO-Moja, Kuchaila, PS-Dhanhar, Distt.-Mainpuri (U.P.)**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT No. 3977/2020, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Mukherji Nagar, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shrif** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shrif** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Shrif** the said accused of **CT No. 3977/2020, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Mukherji Nagar, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Amardeep Kaur
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
(North), Room No. -117,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE
LOSS OF SHARE CERTIFICATE

Notice is hereby given that the following original Share Certificate(s) of Hindustan Unilever Ltd. standing in the name of Mrs. Bhagwati Devi Pareek have been lost/misplaced and are not traceable.

FOLIO	Face vale	CERT NO	DIST FROM	DIST TO	SHARES
HLL2936355	Rs10/-	220218	18906576	18906600	25
HLL2936355	Rs10/-	381962	23434709	23434716	8
HLL2936355	Rs10/-	488993	4966411	4966420	10
HLL2936355	Rs10/-	644979	29845721	29845745	25
HLL2936355	Rs10/-	2250114	184269475	184269494	20

The undersigned has applied to the Company/Registrar & Share Transfer Agent for issuance of Duplicate Share Certificate(s)/Letter of Confirmation in accordance with SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD_RTAMB/P/CIR/2022/70 dated May 25, 2022. Any person having any claim, objection or right in respect of the above-mentioned Share Certificate(s) is requested to send the same in writing, along with supporting documentary evidence, to the Registrar & Share Transfer Agent within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. In the absence of any valid objection within the stipulated period, the Company/RTA shall proceed with the issuance of Duplicate Share Certificate(s)/Letter of Confirmation. Registrar & Share Transfer Agent:- KFin Technologies Limited, Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad, Rangareddy, Telangana - 500032 Email: einward.ris@kfintech.com Date: 15/07/2026 Place: Jodhpur Sd/- (Bhagwati Devi Pareek)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Noor Mohammad, S/o: Ali Hasan, R/o: H.No-4929, C-3, Gali No-3, Sartaj Mohalla, Kanti Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 527/2023, Dated: 11/08/2023 & U/s: 323/341/506 IPC, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Noor Mohammad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Noor Mohammad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Noor Mohammad of P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Ld. JMFC-05, Room No-7,
2nd Floor Shahdara Distt.,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi



KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No : KWA/HO/SP-04/2026-27/EoI-4(Pumps)

INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST FOR THE EMPANELMENT OF MANUFACTURERS OF PUMPS (EOI-4), INWATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE PROJECTS OF KERALA WATER AUTHORITY EMD : Rs. 5000 Tender fee : Rs. 2500 Last Date for submitting Tender : 03-08-2026 03:00:pm Phone : 8547638078 Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in www.etenders.kerala.gov.in
Chief Engineer (HRD&G.I)
KWA-JB-GL-6-165-2026-27
Jalabhavan Thiruvananthapuram

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manish, S/o Subodh, R/o D-1739, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 112/2018, U/s 393/34 IPC, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Manish** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manish** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Manish** accused of **FIR No. 112/2018, U/s 393/34 IPC, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.09.2026**.
By Order - Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, North
Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Neeraj @ Gajender, S/o Shyam Sunder R/o H.No.9728/8, Multani Dhandha, Pahar Ganj, Central, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.78/2021 u/s 392/397/411 IPC, P.S. Kamla Market, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Neeraj @ Gajender** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Neeraj @ Gajender** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Neeraj @ Gajender of FIR No.78/2021 u/s 392/397/411 IPC, P.S. Kamla Market, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.09.2026**.
By Order,
Sh. Bhupinder Singh
Additional Sessions Judge-05, Central District
Room No.154, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER



Gujarat Energy Limited (Erstwhile Gujarat Gas Limited), desires to invite bids against Tender(s) under two bid system through e-tendering portal from eligible and interested parties for the following categories:

Tender ID	Tender Description	Link for accessing the Tender Documents
321143	Rate Contract For Supply of Various Sizes of Globe Type DRS With Comprehensive AMC across GEL	getender.nprocure.com • https://www.gujarat-energy.com/ggl-current-tender/
321931	Services For Defensive Driving Training, Practical Assessment & Certification across GEL	
322736	Rate Contract For Supply of Various Types of Blind Adaptors across GEL	
322619	Rate Contract for Supply of ½ Inch Brass Appliance Valve across GEL	
322822	Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of LNG Storage, Regasification & Dispensing facility including Comprehensive O&M at Dholera, Gujarat	

Any revision, clarifications, corrigenda, addenda, notifications etc. related to this notice will be updated on the above referred websites only. Interested parties should regularly visit websites to keep themselves updated.

OFFICE OF THE SECTARY KRISHI
UPAJ MANDI SAMITI KATNI DIST. KATNI

Notice Inviting Tender
N.I.T. No/Mandi/ Nirman 26/7/635
Katni dated 14/7/26

Online Percentage Rate E-Tenders are invited from contractors registered with the Office of the Engineer in Chief, M.P. Public Works Department, Government of Madhya Pradesh (Centralized Registration Cell) for C.C. Road renewal work in Fruit and Vegetable Yard and Grain Yard in Mandi Yard katni dist. katni Tender Number: **2026. MPSAM. 521344. 1** (PAC 546.77 lakhs), Installation of 02 nos high mast and flood light in old high mast in Mandi Yard Katni Dist katni Tender Number: **2026. MPSAM. 521330. 1** (PAC 34.86 lakhs) and Renovation of existing toilet complex i/c construction of urinals with electrification i/c Repair maintenance and white washing work of canteen building, farmers rest house, prangan office, cap no 3 and boundary wall i/c rain water harvesting in mandi yard katni and Construction of sitting bench in 4 shed of size 80*30 meter in mandi yard katni Tender Number: **2026. MPSAM. 521308. 1** (PAC 119.50 lakhs). The following works Tender to be received online up to 3:30 PM on 04.08.2026. Technical bid documents with EMD & Financial Offer to be received online only as per Detailed NIT. The tender documents can be obtained online on the <https://mptenders.gov.in> as per the Notice Published on the above Portal and detailed information can also be seen on website www.mpmmandi.org.
Note:- Any corrigendum in this NIT, if published, shall be displayed only in our above portal regarding any matter included in this NIT or otherwise. Other details of Construction/Development works and locations & key dates can also be seen on our website www.mpmmandi.org.
Sd/-
Secretary,
Krishi Uj Mandi Samiti
Katni Distt. Katni

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunita W/o Tejbir Singh, R/o A-179, Old Kondli, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 948/2014 U/S 323/341/506/34 IPC at P.S. Ghazipur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sunita** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sunita** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.PC.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunita** accused of **FIR No. 948/2014 U/S 323/341/506/34 IPC at P.S. Ghazipur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **14.09.2026**.
By Order: Shri Sachin,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
East Distt., Court No. 16,
DP/9625/ED/2026
Karkardooma Courts, East Delhi.

Rajasthan Water Grid Corporation Limited
(Formerly known as "Eastern Rajasthan Canal Project Corporation Limited")
Sinchai Bhawan, JLN Marg, Jaipur 302017, Tel: 0141-2700669 Email: ceerpc@gmail.com

No. :- 3903 **NIB No RWGCL/09/2026-27** **Corrigendum - 02**

Name of Work :- Procurement of Oracle Data Base, Oracle PRIMAVERA P6 EPPM Licenses, Technical Support (TS) of new PRIMAVERA Licenses, maintenance & Support services for software and PRIMAVERA software Training

Sr. No.	Reference /Clause No. Page Number Of Bid Document	As Read	Amended
1	Document Download End Date	16.07.2026 at 6:00 PM	23.07.2026 at 6:00 PM
2	Tender Submission End Date	16.07.2026 at 6:00 PM	23.07.2026 at 6:00 PM
3	Physical submission of Tender fee, Processing fee, and Bid Security in the Office of the MD RWGCL, Sinchai Bhawan Jaipur	17.07.2026 at 2:00 PM	24.07.2026 at 2:00 PM
4	Date of opening of Technical bid	17.07.2026 at 03:00 PM	24.07.2026 at 03:00 PM

Note:- All other terms and condition remain same.
NIB Code: ERP2627A0017
UBN No : ERP2627SLO800017
Raj.Samwad/C/26/6869
Managing Director
RWGCL Jaipur

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

e-Tender Notice No. 03-TENDER-ELCON-CKP-26-27. For and on behalf of President of India, Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Con), S.E. Railway, Tatanagar invites e-tender for the following : **Brief Description of Works :-** "Power supply arrangement for Station, Service building, QRS & PF, ORH and Modification of power line Crossing between Dangaooposi-Jaruli against 3rd&4th line work between Dangaooposi-Jaruli in Chakradharpur Division" Cost: Rs. 6,67,34,163/- **Bid Security :-** Rs. 13,34,700/-, **Due Date:** 10.08.2026. **Completion period:** 24(Twenty Four) months. Interested tenderers may visit website www.irops.gov.in for full details/description/ specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **NB:** "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit www.irops.gov.in to participate in all other tenders".
(PR-477)

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. 102-26-27.
Divl. Rly. Manager, N.W.Rly. Bikaner for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works up to 15.00 hours on 03.08.2026 as below: **Tender No.: 102; Name of Work with its Location:** Balance work for soft upgradation of Sadulpur station under ADEN/ Sadulpur. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 26353380.76; **Earnest Money:** Rs.

@ieExplained

#ExpressExplained

If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

POLICY

In Ravidassias’ Census demand, the role of history, poll arithmetic

Anju Agnihotri Chaba

Jalandhar, July 14

THOUSANDS OF members of the Ravidassia community gathered in Punjab’s Phagwara on Sunday for a religious programme and to renew calls for a longstanding demand: the creation of a separate “Ravidassia religion” category in the Census.

The Akhil Bharatiya Ravidassia Dharam Sangathan organised the programme that was attended by Sant Niranjan Das, who heads the Dera Sachkhand Ballan — the largest religious institution of the Ravidassia community.

The gathering resulted in a letter addressed to the President, the Prime Minister and the Union Home Minister. It reopens a debate that has existed since 2010, when members of the community declared themselves as practising a separate faith. The demand also holds political significance, with Punjab set to go to the polls next year.

Who are the Ravidassias?

Guru Ravidas, a mystic poet-saint of the Bhakti Movement from the 15th and 16th centuries, created the concept of *Begampura* — an egalitarian society and a spiritual vision of a city without sorrow, fear or discrimination. His followers, the Ravidassias, are a Dalit community of whom the bulk — nearly 12 lakh — live in the Doaba region of Punjab. Perhaps the most influential organisation within the community, the Dera Sachkhand Ballan was founded in the early 20th century by Baba Sant Pipal Das. Once closely connected with Sikhism, the dera severed these decades-old ties in 2010 and formally declared a Ravidassia religion.

STRENGTH IN NUMBERS

- Punjab has India’s largest concentration of Ravidassias and around 32% of the state’s population comprises Dalits.
- In 2022, state election polling was rescheduled in view of it coinciding with a pilgrimage of the Ravidassias.

An incident in May 2009 was one of the triggers behind this assertion. Attackers stormed a Ravidassia congregation in Vienna, Austria, leading to the killing of Sant Ramanand, a senior spiritual leader of Dera Sachkhand Ballan. Several devotees were injured. The incident triggered protests across Punjab and became a watershed moment for the community to rally around a shared identity. Beginning 2010, the dera started replacing the Guru Granth Sahib with its own Granth, Amritbani, carrying 200 hymns of Guru Ravidas and Ravidassia temples and gurdwaras.

What is the demand and its place in Punjab politics?

The community argues that while Ravidassia has evolved into a distinct religious identity with its own places of worship, scripture, symbols and religious practices, there is no dedicated option for followers to record this identity during the Census. The demand letter cited fundamental rights guaranteeing freedom of religion to support their arguments.

Community leaders say an official Census category would also provide an accurate picture of the size and geographical spread of the faith. Punjab has India’s largest concentration of Ravidassias in India and around 32% of the state’s population comprises Dalits. Dr Kamal Sampla, Akhil Bharatiya Ravidassia Dharam Sangathan, said: “According to the 2011 Census, the combined Ravidassia and Ad Dharmi (another Dalit-led movement seeking separate recognition) in Punjab stood at around 30.95 lakh, accounting for over 11% of the state’s population then.”

The community’s numerical and political strength has even influenced election scheduling. The Election Commission postponed the 2022 Punjab polls after several parties pointed out that lakhs of devotees travel to Varanasi for an annual dera-organised pilgrimage during the period mentioned in the original schedule.

Earlier this year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited a dera in Punjab on the birth anniversary of Guru Ravidas and renamed the airport in Adampur after him.

SPORT

Lord’s Test was historic, but the format is not a level playing field for women

Shankar Narayan

Mumbai, July 14

INDIA’S HISTORIC 270-run victory over England in the first-ever women’s Test at Lord’s came as a relief after the team’s exit in the group stage of the T20 World Cup. But the win also highlighted a bigger problem. Unlike the men’s game, which has the World Test Championship, women’s Tests are still few and far between. Most are one-off matches played as part of bilateral tours. There is no regular competition, no points table and no long-term calendar to give women’s Tests context.

How rare is women’s Test cricket?

Exceptionally rare. Since the first women’s Test in December 1934, only 154 Tests have been played over 92 years. Men’s cricket has staged more than 2,600 Tests. The format is largely restricted to occasional one-off matches rather than multi-Test series. The scarcity means entire generations miss out. New Zealand great Suzie Bates retired in 2026 after a 20-year international career without playing a single Test.

“A whole generation from countries like New Zealand and South Africa might go their entire careers without ever playing a Test... there’s a piece of cricket history we

are completely locked out of,” Bates said.

Which countries actually play women’s Tests?

Only 10 nations have played a women’s Test. England have played 104 women’s Tests, Australia 81 and India 43. New Zealand and have played 45 Tests but none since 2004. The West Indies have played 12, also without a Test since 2004. South Africa have played 16 Tests, most recently in 2024. Pakistan have played three Tests, while Sri Lanka and Ireland have played one each. The Netherlands are the only Associate nation to play a women’s Test, doing so in 2007.

Why don’t more Tests happen?

Financial losses and scheduling dictate the calendar. Women’s cricket built its commercial footprint on white-ball formats, while boards and broadcasters have largely prioritised white-ball cricket because it is easier to schedule and generates greater commercial returns. Each match stands on its own instead of being part of a bigger story.

Former ICC chair Greg Barclay noted: “There is no doubt that white ball is the way of the future... I don’t really see women’s Test... evolving at any speed.”

New Zealand’s Sophie Devine, who retired in 2026, acknowledged the commer-

Indian players after the win over England in the first women’s Test match at Lord’s. AP

cial reality: “As a purist, I would love to see Test cricket back... But we have to earn that right through performing in white-ball formats first to generate that revenue.”

Is there enough domestic Test cricket?

Very little. India is one of the few countries with a regular women’s multi-day domestic competition, through the Senior Women’s Multi-Day Trophy that was added to the calendar from the 2023-24 season. England has begun introducing more multi-day cricket within its domestic structure,

while South Africa has staged occasional three-day provincial competitions. Australia, however, still has no regular multi-day women’s domestic competition, relying on the Women’s National Cricket League (50 overs) and Women’s Big Bash League (T20).

After England’s defeat at Lord’s, head coach Charlotte Edwards admitted the lack of exposure had made a difference. “This is a format I don’t think our players are exposed to... They (India) play a lot of domestic three or four-day cricket, and that absolutely has an impact.”

GLOBAL

Why Trump backtracked on 20% Hormuz fee plan



SUKALP SHARMA

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump has reversed course on his plan to charge a 20% fee to facilitate the safe passage of commercial vessels through the Strait of Hormuz.

“Based on highly productive conversations with Middle East leadership, I have decided to replace the 20% United States Reimbursement Fee with Trade and Investment Deals that the various Gulf States will be making into the United States...” he posted on Truth Social, his social media platform, on Tuesday. This came just a day after Trump had announced the 20% fee, sparking scepticism among experts and analysts, given the lack of clarity on how the proposed fee would be implemented — or even calculated.

It is not clear yet why Trump backtracked, and that too this fast. Going by his own statement, the other Gulf states, who are major energy exporters and depend heavily on the strait, might have played a role. Also, the move’s potential impact on global energy and shipping sectors, and Washington’s traditional stance on navigational freedom could have weighed on the US.

The questions over the plan

There were questions about the viability of implementation as well as the legality of any such move under international law and conventions. There was also a big question mark over whether the US would indeed be able to guarantee the safety and security of commercial vessels in the region. So far, its response to Iranian strikes on vessels has been retaliatory, with an evident lack of pre-emptive measures.

The International Maritime Organization (IMO) said that it opposes fees on ships passing through international waterways. “We have always been consistent on our stance on fees – IMO stands firmly against charging fees for passage through straits

Contested routes through Strait of Hormuz

After the interim US-Iran pact, some vessels have been transiting through two routes: one near the Omani coast and another ‘authorised’ by Iran in its waters. Iran, however, has attacked vessels not using the route authorised by it.



used for international navigation. There is no legal basis through which to introduce mandatory tolls simply to transit through a strait,” an IMO spokesperson was quoted as saying.

The initial announcement was also surprising because the US has traditionally called for freedom of navigation in international waterways and has strongly opposed Iran’s moves to charge tolls from vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz, which usually accounted for a fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG) flows before the war broke out. By calling for a fee, Trump potentially handed Iran an opportunity to argue for its own tolls.

“The U.S.A. will be, from this point forward, known as ‘THE GUARDIAN OF THE HORMUZ STRAIT,’ but as such, and as a matter of FAIRNESS, will be reimbursed, at the rate of 20% on all cargo shipped, for any and all costs necessary to do the job of providing safety and security to this very volatile section of the World,” Trump posted on his Truth Social platform on Monday.

In his social media post, Trump did not

The U-turn

Going by Trump’s own statement, the Gulf states, who are major energy exporters and depend heavily on the strait, might have played a role in the U-turn.

● The move’s potential impact on global energy and shipping sectors could also have been a factor.

LEGAL

Challenges to HC’s Bhojshala order: Scope of powers, ASI survey

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, July 14

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday declined to pass any order for restoring the status quo at the disputed Bhojshala-Kamal Maula mosque complex in Dhar, Madhya Pradesh. It directed that Muslim worshippers be provided an adjacent alternative space for Friday prayers until the court examines the dispute in detail.

The Madhya Pradesh High Court’s judgment in May held that the site’s religious character is that of a temple dedicated to Goddess Vagdevi (Saraswati). It is now being challenged on several grounds.

On site’s character and title

The principal challenge is that the HC “impermissibly delved into highly contentious and complex questions of fact, historical evidence, and archaeological interpretations to determine the ‘original’ character of the monument,” and that such “detailed examination... is beyond the scope of summary proceedings in writ jurisdiction and should have been relegated to a civil court.”

The petitioners argue that although the court repeatedly stated it was not deciding

title, it declared the site’s religious character in terms that had direct consequences for worship rights “under the guise of Article 226”. The law accords High Courts the power to issue writs for enforcing fundamental rights, as well as for any other legal right against the State or authorities discharging public duties.

This challenge goes to the heart of what the High Court did. The dispute arose from a 2003 Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) order that allowed Hindu worship on Tuesdays and during Basant Panchami, and Muslim prayers on Fridays. Hearing connected proceedings filed by Hindu, Muslim and Jain parties, the HC ordered the ASI to conduct a fresh scientific survey.

It examined Section 16 of the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958, which bars the use of a protected monument in a manner inconsistent with its character. The HC held that before deciding whether the 2003 arrangement complied with Section 16, it first had to ascertain the monument’s true character. It found the 2003 arrangement defective for having been issued without prior inquiry.

Relying on the ASI report, which recorded Paramara-period foundations from

Origins of legal dispute

● The dispute arose from a 2003 Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) order that allowed Hindu worship on Tuesdays and during Basant Panchami, and Muslim prayers on Fridays.

● Hearing connected proceedings filed by Hindu, Muslim and Jain parties, the MP High Court ordered the ASI to conduct a fresh scientific survey of the complex.

the 9th or 10th century, temple-style pillars and inscriptions referring to “Sharada Sadan”, the HC held that the disputed area of the Bhojshala Complex and Kamal Maula Mosque was that of a temple.

The petitioners do not dispute the survey’s findings, but argue that the report was treated as conclusive without being tested via cross-examination and that it was read selectively. The plea says the report recorded Arabic and Persian inscriptions, material associated with Islamic use of the structure and the continued official nomenclature “Bhojshala and Kamal Maula Mosque”.

On interpretation of law

The petitioners also challenge the HC’s interpretation of the Places of Worship (Special Provisions) Act, 1991, which preserves the religious character of places of worship as they existed in August 1947.

The HC held that Bhojshala fell within the exemption contained in Section 4(3)(a) because it is a protected monument governed by the 1958 Act. It further held that an official 1935 notification issued by the princely state of Dhar, recognising the structure as a mosque, could not prevail.

However, the petitioners argue that the

exemption merely allows preservation and management of protected monuments and does not authorise the courts to revisit the site’s historical-religious character. They say preventing Muslims from offering prayers at the site is a “violation of their fundamental rights to freedom of religion and to manage their own religious affairs”.

On HC’s powers

The petition questions the standing of some of the original petitioners, noting that the organisation Hindu Front for Justice was registered shortly before litigation began and had declared objectives relating to the restoration of places of worship. Such “pleadings themselves disclosed a pre-determined denominational and restorationist agenda directly...” it said.

The challenge also extends to the HC’s directions regarding future administration of the site. The court directed the Union government and the ASI to decide on the administration of Bhojshala while retaining ASI’s supervisory control over the monument. It further stated that if Muslim parties sought alternative land for a mosque, the state government could consider allotting suitable land elsewhere in Dhar district.

Is India driving the revival?

Yes. Since December 2023, India have played five Women’s Tests, winning four and losing one. They have beaten Australia by eight wickets at home, South Africa by 10 wickets and England again by 270 runs at Lord’s to maintain their unbeaten run in the longest format in the country. Those results have coincided with the BCCI’s expansion of domestic multi-day cricket, giving Indian players far greater exposure to the red-ball game than those in most other countries.

Before retiring after the Lord’s Test, former England captain Heather Knight stressed the need for more Tests. “I’d love to see some domestic red-ball cricket. It doesn’t necessarily have to be a full part of the calendar, but I do think it would help us develop as better white-ball cricketers as well.”

Is there actually public demand?

For the biggest occasions, yes. The Lord’s Test attracted an aggregate attendance of 37,846, the highest ever for a women’s Test. The challenge is financial rather than emotional.

Boards in New Zealand and South Africa operate on far smaller budgets than the BCCI. Without dedicated broadcast deals or commercial partners, staging home Tests often results in losses, making white-ball

cricket a more practical investment.

Former India batsman and coach W V Raman felt that while players deserved to be given more chances to play Tests, one also needed to consider the expenses that comes with staging the matches. “The big question will be whether it is commercially viable, because these days you cannot really separate the two, sport and commerce. So that being the case, you’ll have to see if it’s possibly something that all the other boards will be keen to take part in,” he told *The Indian Express*. “By that I mean whether all the other boards will be keen to play Test cricket, as it does involve quite a lot of scheduling, quite a lot of logistics and also, quite obviously, all these things come at a cost.”

What would make women’s Tests sustainable?

Three major changes could transform the format. First, the ICC could introduce a Women’s World Test Championship or a points-based competition for all series to provide context. Second, expanding matches from four to five days would reduce the likelihood of draws and allow contests to develop naturally. Third, the ICC and wealthier boards could create funding pools to subsidise hosting costs, ensuring smaller nations are not discouraged from staging Tests.

U.S. PRESIDENT SAYS HE TOOK DECISION BASED ON CONVERSATIONS WITH WEST ASIA LEADERS

Trump steps back from Hormuz fee plan in favour of Gulf investment deals

No details given of what Gulf states have committed to

Reuters
Cairo, Dubai, Washington, July 14

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump stepped back from a proposal to charge a 20% transit fee to guard the vital Strait of Hormuz waterway as part of the conflict with Iran, saying on Tuesday he would instead seek investment deals with Gulf states.

US forces had carried out waves of attacks for the third night in a row after Tehran said it had closed the strait, prompting Trump on Monday to reinstate a blockade of Iranian shipping and propose the fee.

But just a little under five hours before the fee had been due to come into effect at 2000 GMT, Trump said the strait was open to all shipping traffic except that of Iran.

"Based on highly productive conversations with Middle East leadership, I have decided to replace the 20% United States Reimbursement Fee with Trade and Investment Deals that the various Gulf States will be making into the United States," he said in a post on Truth Social.

On Monday, Trump told the "Hugh Hewitt Show" that Iran would be hit "very hard tonight, and we're going to hit them hard



Pro-government demonstrators wave Iranian and religious flags in a gathering commemorating the late Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei at a square in Tehran. FILE

tomorrow. And there's not a damn thing they can do about it". The governor's office of Iran's Qeshm Island, on Strait of Hormuz, said it was hit by a US projectile around 7 pm n Tuesday, Iranian state media reported.

Meanwhile, a US projectile exploded near a water and electricity facility on Iran's Kish Island, the country's semi-official Tasnim news agency said. State media also reported an explosion heard in Andimeshk in southern Khuzestan province.

Iran had earlier hit back by attacking a US Army base in Jordan with ballistic missiles while Bahrain, which hosts a US naval base, said it had fended off an

Iranian aerial attack.

Jordan said it had shot down four ballistic missiles and explosions were heard in Manama, Bahrain's capital.

In the early evening, Kuwait said its armed forces were engaging with "hostile" aerial targets, and the state news agency said sirens had sounded in the country. The worsening attacks had increased doubts that a memorandum of understanding signed last month would lead to a permanent halt in war.

The UN shipping agency said it opposed any fees for straits used in international navigation and that there was no legal basis for introducing man-

datory tolls on strait transits.

Germany's Hapag-Lloyd, the world's fifth-largest container shipping company, said it would be "fundamentally wrong".

Trump said later on Tuesday that he did not like the concept of a fee for using the strait and said countries had called him to say they wanted to invest in the US instead of being charged a fee. It was not immediately clear what Gulf states had agreed to, if anything.

Trump did not mention any commitments by them, saying only in his post: "Investments will be MASSIVE but, at the same time, extraordinarily good for them, and their future."

Israel's secret bid to turn Ahmadinejad into Iran's next leader

Mark Mazzetti, Julian E Barnes, Farnaz Fassihi & Ronen Bergman
July 14

IN EARLY 2024, the rector of a university in Budapest, Hungary, received a startling request from a senior Hungarian government official.

The official told rector Gergely Deli that Ludovika University of Public Service should hold a climate change conference and invite an unlikely guest: Mahmoud Ahmadinejad, the widely reviled former president of Iran.

Even more surprising was the reason. The official said the conference would serve as a front for Ahmadinejad to hold secret discussions in Budapest with Israeli intelligence operatives, despite his long-standing hostility toward Israel.

Deli knew the invitation could tarnish both his reputation and that of the university. But, he said, he believed he might be helping save lives.

"You have two enemies, and if these enemies want to talk with each other, then it's best to do what you can to make them

talk," he said. Ahmadinejad's 2024 visit to the university and another the following year were part of a yearslong Israeli effort to groom him as an intelligence asset who, when the time came, could be installed as Iran's new leader, according to US

and Iranian officials familiar with the operation. Recruiting Ahmadinejad became such a priority that Israel's then-spy chief, David Barnea, travelled to Budapest in 2024 to meet him personally, according to former US officials. Soon after-



ward, they said, Mossad notified the CIA it had established contact with him.

In recent years, according to US officials, Israel secretly paid Ahmadinejad for housing and

Israel, Lebanon hold talks to implement framework peace deal

Reuters
Beirut, Rome, July 14

LEBANON AND Israel resumed talks on Tuesday in the Italian capital, with Beirut hoping for progress towards securing an Israeli withdrawal from south Lebanon under a US-brokered deal, although expectations for swift progress were low.

US-led diplomacy has emerged since Hezbollah and Israel returned to war on March 2 amid the wider regional conflict, moving forward despite strong objections from the Iran-backed group, which believes only Iranian pressure on Washington can secure an end to the war and Israeli withdrawal.

Iran had demanded an end to the war in Lebanon as part of its interim deal with Washington signed last month, but the agreement has been shaken over the last week by renewed US-Iranian hostilities in the Gulf region.

Israel's military is occupying what it describes as a "buffer zone" about 10 km (6 miles) into Lebanon along the entire length of the Israeli border. Israeli officials say the zone is necessary to protect northern Israeli com-

munities from attacks launched by Hezbollah.

A meeting in Washington on June 26 produced an agreement that called for an end to the Lebanon conflict, the disarmament of militant groups - an apparent reference to Hezbollah - as well as the deployment of Lebanese troops to the south and the progressive withdrawal of Israeli forces.

Lebanese and Israeli officials will meet at the US embassy in Rome on Tuesday and Wednesday to set out how to implement the framework deal, Lebanese officials told Reuters. One of the officials said moving the talks to Rome would make it easier for both countries' delegations to consult their governments for guidance as they negotiated.

Italian Foreign Minister Antonio Tajani said on Monday that Italy had offered to host the talks to continue work towards a genuine ceasefire in Lebanon.

"We are also very pleased that Rome can serve as the venue for these meetings. In this way, our capital becomes a capital of peace," Tajani said ahead of a European Union meeting in Brussels on Monday.

Congo launches trial of experimental drug for rare Ebola strain

Reuters
July 14

RESEARCHERS IN the Democratic Republic of Congo said on Tuesday they have started enrolling participants in a trial testing Gilead Sciences' experimental antiviral obeldesivir as a post-exposure treatment for the ongoing Bundibugyo Ebola outbreak in Congo and Uganda.

Congo's National Institute for Biomedical Research and France's ANRS Emerging Infectious Diseases, with support from humanitarian aid groups, Alliance for International Medical Action (ALIMA) and Medecins Sans Frontieres, are leading the trial in Ituri province, the epicentre of the outbreak, the agencies said in a statement.

The trial is designed to assess whether post-exposure treatment can reduce the risk of developing Ebola infection after contact with the virus.

The study aims to enroll about 1,000 people aged 12 years and older, who had high-risk exposure to a confirmed Ebola case within the previous five days but have not developed symptoms.

Participants will be monitored daily for 21 days, with a final follow-up at 42 days.

Obeldesivir has shown activity against filoviruses, including the Bundibugyo Ebola virus, in pre-clinical studies.

Gilead said it has donated 2,400 bottles of obeldesivir and 2,000 vials of remdesivir to support the trial.

Meloni suffers setback as Italy rejects reform of election law

Rome: Italy's parliament on Tuesday rejected a key aspect of voting rules reforms proposed by Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni's party, dealing her a significant setback ahead of general elections due next year.

The lower house is debating an electoral reform that would introduce a fully proportional voting system with a seat bonus for the winning coalition.

In a secret ballot, lawmakers rejected a proposal by Meloni's Brothers of Italy party to reintroduce preference voting for candidates on party lists.

Meloni's main coalition partners, the League and Forza Italia, had said they would support the measure, but was defeated 188-187, indicating part of majority defected. REUTERS

Ukraine downs 5 Russian ballistic missiles, eyes stronger air defence

Associated Press
Kyiv, July 14

UKRAINE'S AIR force said Tuesday it intercepted five ballistic missiles launched by Russia in a raft of overnight attacks, although other missiles and drones got through and hit warehouses and a school in the capital of Kyiv.

It was the first time in almost two weeks that Ukraine said it had downed Russian ballistic missiles, which are harder to stop than drones or cruise missiles and have pummeled the country in Moscow's 4-year-old full-scale invasion.

Ukrainian air defenses likely used the US-made Patriot surface-to-air guided missile system that is the most effective way of countering ballistic missiles, but ammunition for it



French President Emmanuel Macron with Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy after the Bastille Day military parade in Paris, on Tuesday. AP

has been in short supply amid the Iran war.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy is in Paris this week to change that, announcing his country is joining

with nine other nations to form a coalition that will build a shared ballistic missile shield for Europe. On Monday, he said Ukraine and its partners could jointly develop a mass-produced, low-cost system in the next 12 months.

Zelenskyy on Tuesday attended France's annual Bastille Day celebrations, receiving an ovation from European leaders. His country's troops got the loudest cheers of the day from crowds watching along the Champs Elysees.

Tuesday's attack in Kyiv caused fires at two warehouses and also damaged a school, Mayor Vitali Klitschko said.

The Russian Defence Ministry said in a statement it targeted military manufacturing facilities that produce long-range missiles and drones.

BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

Buffett cuts Gates Foundation donations over ties with Epstein



Warren Buffett, chairman and CEO of Berkshire Hathaway. FILE

WARREN BUFFETT confirmed he has stopped donating money to the Gates Foundation, following revelations about interactions between the Microsoft co-founder and philanthropist Bill Gates and the late sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. Buffett said on Tuesday he is donating about \$6 billion of Berkshire Hathaway stock to four family foundations overseen by his daughter Susie and sons Howard and Peter. He also said he will donate his remaining Berkshire shares "one way or the other" to the four foundations. REUTERS

BELGIUM

Construction site fire in Brussels leaves many dead

SEVERAL PEOPLE have died in a fire at a construction site in Brussels on Tuesday, with a search for six missing persons ongoing, local authorities said. An unspecified number of bodies had been found in one of two elevators at the large renovation project on the central Place de Brouckere where a fire broke out early Tuesday, a spokesman for local labour inspection service said. REUTERS

MEXICO

US faces criminal complaints over migrant deaths

MEXICO HAS begun filing criminal complaints with state prosecutors in the United States over deaths of its citizens in US immigration custody and during enforcement operations, the foreign ministry said on Tuesday. Mexico's government has sent cease-and-desist letters to US detention centres where Mexican nationals have died, the ministry added. REUTERS

NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

PAKISTAN

Heavy rain triggers roof collapse, kills 11

ELEVEN PEOPLE were killed overnight when heavy rain caused the roof of a mud-brick house to collapse in northwest Pakistan, police and rescue officials said Tuesday. The accident occurred in Kohat district in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, according to Bilal Faizi of the provincial emergency service. Rescuers recovered 11 bodies, mostly women and children, and handed them over to relatives for burial, Faizi said. AP

SRI LANKA

Prison clash toll rises to 32 as two jail officials die

TWO MORE officials from the riot-hit Negombo jail in Sri Lanka have succumbed to their injuries, bringing the overall death toll to 32, prison spokesman CI Gajanayake said Tuesday. The number of prison officials killed has now gone up to 10, while at least 22 inmates died and another 20 remain hospitalised. On July 5 and 6, violent clashes erupted in the Negombo jail following a narcotics dispute among rival groups of inmates. PTI

Trump hosts Iraq's new PM Ali al-Zaidi at White House

Associated Press
Washington, July 14

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump welcomed Iraq's new prime minister to the White House on Tuesday after strongly backing the political neophyte in his bid for office.

Ali al-Zaidi, a businessman with no political background, emerged as a consensus candidate in Iraq after months of deadlock over the premiership following last year's parliamentary elections.

When al-Zaidi was formally installed as prime minister-designate in April, Trump said in a social media post that it was the "beginning of a tremendous new chapter between our Nations - Prosperity, Stability, and Success like never seen before."

But Trump's interest and involvement in the next leadership in Iraq began long before that statement.

Iraq's dominant parliamentary bloc, the Coordination



President Donald Trump with Iraqi Prime Minister Ali al-Zaidi in the Oval Office on Tuesday. AP

Framework, a coalition of Shiite parties allied with Iran, initially said it would back former Prime Minister Nouri al-Maliki, whom the Trump administration views as too close to Tehran.

The Republican president publicly announced his opposition to al-Maliki and threatened to cut off aid to Iraq if he was appointed, adding that "if we are not there to help, Iraq has ZERO chance of Success, Prosperity, or Freedom."

• MENON WILL 'CONDUCT SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH AND TECHNOLOGY DEMONSTRATIONS AIMED AT ADVANCING HUMAN SPACE EXPLORATION AND BENEFITING LIFE ON EARTH', ACCORDING TO NASA

NASA astronaut Anil Menon embarks on 8-month International Space Station mission

Sagar Kulkarni
Washington, July 14

NASA ASTRONAUT Anil Menon and two Russian cosmonauts on Tuesday lifted off on board a Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft from Kazakhstan on an eight-month mission to the International Space Station.

The Roscosmos spacecraft carrying Menon and Russian cosmonauts Pyotr Dubrov and Anna Kikina lifted off from the Baikonur cosmodrome at 8:17 pm IST. After a two-orbit, three-hour trip to the station, the spacecraft will automatically dock at 11:56 pm IST to the Prichal module.

spaceflight and the second flight for the Russian cosmonauts, according to NASA. Menon's family members, including astronaut wife Anna Wilhelm, and NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman, were at the Baikonur cosmodrome for the spaceflight.

Once aboard, the trio will join NASA astronauts Jessica Meir, Jack Hathaway, and Chris Williams, European Space Agency astronaut Sophie Adenot, and Roscosmos cosmonauts Sergey Kud-Sverchkov, Sergei Mikaev, and Andrey Fedyaev.

Menon, Dubrov and Kikina's mission will last about eight months, and they are scheduled to return to Earth in April 2027. Menon will "conduct scien-

tific research and technology demonstrations aimed at advancing human space exploration and benefiting life on Earth," according to NASA.

Yelena Remizova, head of Russia's agency for international humanitarian cooperation Rosstrudnichestvo, earlier told state-run TASS news agency the rocket will carry with it drawings made by Indian schoolchildren.

"These are the works of the winners of the 'First Forever' competition, dedicated to the 65th anniversary of flight of the first Earth astronaut, Yuri Gagarin, and cooperation between Russia and India in the field of space exploration," she said.



(L-R) NASA astronaut Anil Menon and Roscosmos cosmonauts Pyotr Dubrov and Anna Kikina during a send-off ceremony at the Baikonur Cosmodrome in Kazakhstan, on Tuesday. REUTERS

Born in Minneapolis to Ukrainian and Indian immigrants, Menon is an emergency

medicine physician and a US Space Force colonel. Menon's father, K P Shanka-

ran Menon, hails from Ottapalam in Kerala's Palakkad district. His mother, Elizabeth, is an immigrant from Ukraine to America. Menon, 49, has also spent a year in India as a Rotary Ambassadorial Scholar to study and support Polio vaccination initiatives.

During his stint with the US Air Force, he served on the frontlines in Afghanistan during Operation Enduring Freedom and also worked for the Himalayan Rescue Association, caring for climbers on Mount Everest.

He began his career at NASA as a flight surgeon in 2014 and worked with astronauts living and working on the International Space Station.



भारत सरकार / GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, / अंतरिक्ष विभाग / DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
विक्रम साराभाई अंतरिक्ष केंद्र / VIKRAM SARABHAI SPACE CENTRE
निर्माण एवं अंतरिक्ष ग्रुप / CONSTRUCTION AND MAINTENANCE GROUP
तिरुवनंतपुरम / THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 22 / (फोन नं. / Ph. No. 0471 - 2564568 / 5669 / 4537 / 4545)

ई-निविदा की अवधि बढ़ाना / EXTENSION OF E-TENDER

दिनांक / Date : 14.07.2026

70 एकड़, वीरसएससी, तुंग भू में एग्रीकल्चरल कार्यालय के लिए एस्टीमेट प्रभन (चौदी मंजिल) का उद्देश्य विस्तार (सिविल तथा विद्युत कार्य) / Vertical Extension of STS Building (Fourth Floor) for NGLV Office at 70 Acres. VSSC, Thumba (Civil & Electrical works) NIT No. VSSC/CMG/CO1/07/2026-27 Dt. 18.05.2026. (बी.ए.सी./PAC: ₹./Rs. 543.06 लाख / Lakhs)
इंटरनेट पर करने की अवधि/ Period for downloading: दिनांक 18.07.2026 को 23:00 बजे तक बढ़ाए गए / Extended upto 23:00 hrs. on 18.07.2026

इच्छुक निविदाकार व्यौरों के लिए www.tenderwizard.in/isro या www.isro.gov.in देखें / Interested tenderers may visit www.tenderwizard.in/isro or www.isro.gov.in for details.

प्रधान, सीएसजी, वीरसएससी
Head, CMG, VSSC



AXIS FINANCE LIMITED
(CIN U05921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Vashi International Centre, Parsipada Buidhar
Mang. Work, Mumbai - 400 025

Under Section 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules"). Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Finance Limited (AFL) under the Act and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Rules already issued detailed Demand Notice dated below under Section 13(2) of the Act, calling upon the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) (all singularly or together referred to "Obligors")/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) listed hereunder, to pay the amount mentioned in the respective Demand Notice, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice, as per details given below. Copies of the said Notices are served by Registered Post A.D. and are available with the undersigned, and the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s), may, if they so desire, collect the respective copy from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours.

In connection with the above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) to pay to AFL, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice(s), the amount indicated herein below against their respective names, together with further interest as detailed below from the respective dates mentioned below in column (d) till the date of payment and / or realization, read with the loan agreement and other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Obligor(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset(s) have been mortgaged to AFL by the said Obligor(s) respectively.

Sr. No	Loan Account No.	Name of Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s)	DETAILS OF SECURED ASSET	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.) as on below date	Date of Demand Notice	Date of NPA
1.	0456AFHA00002747	SANJAY SHUKLA & SHASHI KALA SHUKLA	ALL THE PIECE AND PARCEL OF LIG FLAT NO. 166, HOUSING ESTATE, SECTOR - 14, DWARKA, PHASE - II, SOUTH WEST DELHI, DELHI - 110078 ADMEASURING 40 SQ. MTS.	INR 58,11,825/- (Rupees Fifty Eight Lakhs Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred and Twenty Five Only) due as on 18 June, 2026	30.06.2026	18.06.2026
2	0456AFHA00000832	HIMANSHU SHARMA, SANJAY KUMAR, SHARMA & JATIN SANJAY	ALL THE PIECE AND PARCEL OF LIG FLAT NO- 335, 1ST FLOOR, SECTOR-14, PHASE-II, POCKET-B, DWARKA, WEST DELHI, DELHI - 110078 ADMEASURING 40 SQ. MTS.	I N R 49,28,180/- (Rupees Forty Nine Lakhs Twenty Eight Thousand and One Hundred and Eighty Only) due as on 18 June, 202	30.06.2026	18.06.2026

"with further interest, additional Interest at the rate as more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices dated mentioned above, incidental expenses, costs, charges etc incurred till the date of payment and/or realization. If the said Obligor(s) shall fail to make payment to AFL as aforesaid, then AFL shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 13(4) of the said Act and the applicable Rules entirely at the risk of the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) as to the costs and consequences. The said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) are prohibited under the said Act to transfer the aforesaid Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property(ies), whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of AFL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules made thereunder shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: 30.06.2026
Place: DELHI

For Axis Finance Limited
Authorised Officer

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

E-Procurement Notice

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer HPPWD Dodra Kwar Distt Shimla H.P. on behalf of Governor of H.P invites item rate bids, in electronic tendering system, in 2 cover system for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/firms registered with H.P.PWD Department.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Starting date for downloading Bid	Earnest Money	Deadline for submission
1	R/R Damages to Rohru Chirgaon Dodra Kwar Road km 0/00 to 92/695(SH:- C/o B/Wall in R/R 1:6 at Rd 33/045to 33/085, 33/405 to 33/420)	927447/-	21-7-26	18549/-	29-7-26
2	R/R damages to Link Road Village Larot km 0/00 to 92/695(SH:- C/o B/Wall in R/R 1:6 at Rd 0/540 to 0/565)	899494/-	21-7-26	17990/-	29-7-26
3	R/R damages to Link Road Village Larot km 0/00 to 0/840(SH:- C/o B/Wall in R/R 1:6 at Rd 0/660 to 0/685, 0/800 to 0/815)	1010145/-	21-7-26	30202/-	29-7-26
4	C/o Link Road village Kharshali to telga km 0/00 to 3/00(SH:- P/L Essential Kharanja stone soling between Rd 0/00 to 1/00 & CD at Rd 0/380)	884120/-	21-7-26	17682/-	29-7-26
5	R/R damages to Rohru Chirgaon Dodra Kwar Road km 0/00to 92/695(SH:-C/o R/Wall in R/R 1:6 at Rd 32/420 to 32/435, 34/055 to 34/085)	1213894/-	21-7-26	24277/-	29-7-26
6	R/R damages to RCD Road km 0/00 to 92/695(SH:- C/o B/Wall in PCC 1:3:6 at Rd 21/450 to 21/468, B/Wall in PCC 1:3:6 & Wire crates at Rd 21/450 to 21/487 & B/Wall in RR 1:6 at Rd 24/295 to 24/320)	2303443/-	21-7-26	46668/-	29-7-26
7	R/R Damages to RCD Road km 0/00 to 92/695 (SH:- C/o R/Wall in PCC 1:3:6 at Rd 25/435 to 25/467)	1378101/-	21-7-26	27562/-	29-7-26
8	R/R damages to Link Road Village Larot km 0/00 to 0/840(SH:- P/L Essential Kharanja stone soling at between Rd 0/00 to 0/840)	312011/-	21-7-26	6253/-	29-7-26
9	Name of Work :- R/R Damages to RCD road km 0/00 to 92/695 (Sh:- C/o B/Wall at Rd 23/810 to 23/840, R/wall in PCC 1:3:6 at Rd 23/460 to 23/505 and wing wall at Rd 22/940)	1993013/-	21-7-26	39860/-	29-7-26
10	Name of Work :- R/R Damages to RCD road km 0/00 to 92/695 (Sh:- C/o B/Wall in R/R 1:6 at Rd 31/600 to 31/615 ,31/625 to 31/645)	704883 /-	21-7-26	14098 /-	29-7-26
11	Name of work :- C/o link road to kimiti Nalvi km 0/00 to 3/00 (Sh:- P/L Essential Kharanja stone soling between km 0/00 to 3/00)	1421002 /-	21-7-26	28420 /-	29-7-26
12	Name of Work :- R/R Damages to RCD road km 0/00 to 92/695 (SH:-C/o B/Wall in cm 1:6 at Rd 29/750 to 29/810)	1227562 /-	21-7-26	24551 /-	29-7-26
13	Name of work :- R/R Damage to Various road under Larot Sect./Division Larot. (Sh:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips maintenance of road surface etc.)	262500 /-	21-7-26	5250 /-	29-7-26
14	Name of work :-R/R Damage to Various road under Larot Section. Sub -Division Larot. (Sh:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips maintenance of road surface etc.)	525000 /-	21-7-26	10500 /-	29-7-26
15	Name of work :-R/R Damage to Various road under Larot Section. Sub -Division Larot. (Sh:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips maintenance of road surface etc.)	512500 /-	21-7-26	10250 /-	29-7-26
16	Name of Work :- R/R Damages to RCD road km 0/00 to 92/695 (SH:-C/o R/Wall in wire crate at RD 22/095 to 22/180, 22/135 to 22/165)	912407 /-	21-7-26	18248 /-	29-7-26
17	Name of Work :- R/R Damages to Gadsari Kharshali Road km 0/00 to 4/500 (SH:-C/o R/Wall in cm 1:6 at Rd 4/070 to 4/085)	426902 /-	21-7-26	8538 /-	29-7-26
18	R/R Damages to RCD Road km 0/00 to 92/695(SH:- C/o B/Wall in PCC 1:3:6 at Rd 27/210 to 27/705 to 27/720, 29/670 to 29/690 & B/Wall at Rd 33/210 to 33/225)	2288291/-	21-7-26	45766/-	29-7-26
19	R/R Damages to RCD Road km 0/00 to 92/695 (SH:- C/o R/wall in r/R Stone Masonry cm (1:6) at Rd 31/750 to 31/780)	1253407/-	21-7-26	25068/-	29-7-26
20	R/R damages to Gadsari to Kharshali km 0/00 to 4/500(SH:- C/o B/Wall in Wire crates at Rd 6/230 to 0/263 & R/Wall in wire crates at Rd 0/275 to 0/305)	1408918/-	21-7-26	28178/-	29-7-26
21	R/R damages to RCD Road km 00/195 to 92/695(SH:- C/o B/Wall in Wire crate at Rd 28/225 to 28/240, 28/790 to 28/820 & R/Wall at Rd 32/125 to 32/140, 31/570 to 31/600 & R/Wall in PCC 1:3:6 & Wire crates at Rd 32/535 to 32/550)	1421614/-	21-7-26	28432/-	29-7-26
22	R/R Damages to Jiladi dangri Gad km 0/00 to 3/500(SH:- C/o R/Wall in R/R Masonry at Rd 1/00 to 1/035)	1192445/-	21-7-26	23849/-	29-7-26
23	R/R mages on RCD Road km 0/00 to 92/695(SH:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips & maintenance of drain under Larot sub-Division at various Rds)	495000/-	21-7-26	9900/-	29-7-26
24	R/R damages RCD Road km 0/00 to 92/695(SH:- Hiring of Tipper for carriage of muck/stone under Larot sub Division at various Rds)	485000/-	21-7-26	9700/-	29-7-26
25	C/o Link Road from Thalthar to Jakhli Km 0/00 & 2/300 (SH:- P/C mtr. Wide Road at Rd 0/00 to 0/180 & Rd 0/180 to 0/300)	1689049/-	21-7-26	33781/-	29-7-26
26	R/R damages to Various road under Larot section Sub-Division Larot (SH:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips maintenance of road surface etc.)	475000/-	21-7-26	9500/-	29-7-26
27	R/R damages to Various road under Larot section Sub-Division Larot (SH:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips maintenance of road surface etc.)	487500/-	21-7-26	9750/-	29-7-26
28	R/R damages to Various road under Larot section Sub-Division Larot (SH:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips maintenance of road surface etc.)	481250/-	21-7-26	9625/-	29-7-26
29	Restoration of rain Damages on various road under Dodra Kwar Division/ Larot Sub Division (SH:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips/Land Slide and maintenance of road etc)	960000/-	21-7-26	19200/-	29-7-26
30	R/R damages on RCD Road Larot Sub Division (SH:- Hiring of JCB for removal of slips/drain & dressing of road surface between Chanshal to Dodra under Larot Sub-Division)	475000/-	21-7-26	9500/-	29-7-26
31	R/R damages on RCD Road Larot Sub Division (SH:- Hiring of Tipper for carriage of muck/stone on RCD Road & various link Road in between Larot to Chanshal)	497000/-	21-7-26	9940/-	29-7-26
32	R/R damages to RCD Road km 21/195 to 92/695(SH:- C/o R/wall in PCC 1:3:6 & Stone Masonry CM 1:6 at Rd 21/345 to 21/375 L= 35 mtr, H=7.00 mtr & 22/390 to 22/408 L=18 mtr H=5.60 mtr)	3882577/-	21-7-26	77652/-	29-7-26
33	R/R mages on RCD Road km 0/00 to 92/695(SH:- Hiring of Tipper for carriage of muck/stone under Larot sub Division at various Rds)	324000/-	21-7-26	6480/-	29-7-26

Notes:- The Bidders are advised to note other details for tenders and letter No. PWD (B) A (3) 1/2020 dated 29.07.2025 issued by Secretary PW) to the Govt. of Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in and any corrigendum will be uploaded on the site.

Executive Engineer
B&R Division, HPPWD Dodra Kwar.

No. 1880/H/P



BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Deputy Chief Engineer,
2nd Floor, 9th Main Road, Jayanagara South
2nd block, Bengaluru-560 111

No: DCE/BSCC/TEND/02/2026-27/Corr-2

Date: 14-07-2026

CORRIGENDUM-2

Name of the Work: 1) Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Jayanagara Assembly Constituency for one year. 2) Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Padmanabhanagara Sub Division Assembly Constituency for one year. 3) Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Banashankari Sub Division Assembly Constituency for one year. 4) Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in BTM Layout Assembly Constituency for one year. 5) Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Kasavanahalli ward of Mahadevapura Assembly Constituency for one year.

Ref: Tender Notification No: DCE/BSCC/TEND/02/2026-27, Date: 03-07-2026. Adverting to the above, following Corrigendum to the above tender work is issued.

Calendar of Events to be Read as: 1) Last Date & Time for receipt of Tenders : **20.07.2026 upto 4:00 p.m.** 2) Opening of Technical bid: **22.07.2026 upto 4:30 p.m.** 3) Opening of Financial bid : After the approval of Technical Evaluation. All the other terms & conditions are remaining unchanged.

Sd/- Deputy Chief Engineer, BSCC.



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

Sl. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE PALWAL COOP. SUGAR HELLS LTD., PALWAL	JOB WORK FOR INVOLVING COVACCOLOUR COATED SHEET ROOFING AND VERTICAL WORK ETC. (SCHEDULE RATE FOR ONE YEAR) + 10 OTHER WORKS	10/07/2026 18/07/2026	80,000/-	https://tenders.hry.nic.in	883043970 pshahgupta@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 47149/18RY

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
(वि०/ यॉ०) वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०,
आगरा ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट निविदा सूचना (अल्पकालीन)

दिनांक:- 09.07.2026

पत्रांक: 676/6WE (Agra)-E/M Circle Agra

1. महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा द्वारा निम्न तालिका में अंकित विवरण के अनुसार प्रस्तात दर के आधार पर दो बिड सिस्टम (तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय बिड) पर ऑनलाइन निविदाये आमंत्रित की जाती है-
2. कार्य का विवरण:-

क्र. सं.	विवरण	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत (लाख रु० में)	संयोजक कार्यालय (लाख रु० में)	निविदा प्रथम मूल्य (लाख रु० में)	कार्य शुरू करने की तिथि	कार्य समाप्त करने की तिथि	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता का नाम	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता का पता	वृत्त	लोकेशन का नाम	डिपेंडर की संख्या
1	आगरा	जनपद न्यायालय आगरा के जजरीज कीमिती कोर्ट, कोमितीज कोर्ट व अपर जनपद न्यायाधीश के न्यायालय कार्यालय, विधान कार्यालय व वास्तुमूल्य संयंत्रों की स्थापना का कार्य।	78.03	5.90	रु० 300.00 + जी. एर.टी. रु०18% रु० 414.00=2714.00	03 माह	अधीक्षित अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	विद्युत कार्यालय हेतु विभाग में पंजीकृत 'ए' श्रेणी के ठेकेदार	
2	मिर्जापुर	जनपद न्यायालय मैसूरु के अपर जनपद न्यायाधीश के अपर न्यायालय कार्यालय, विधान कार्यालय व वास्तुमूल्य संयंत्रों की स्थापना का कार्य।	27.14	2.71	रु० 300.00 + जी. एर.टी. रु०18% रु० 144.00=944.00	03 माह	अधीक्षित अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	विद्युत कार्यालय हेतु विभाग में पंजीकृत 'ए' श्रेणी के ठेकेदार	
3	मुंगेर	जनपद न्यायालय मुंगेर के मप विभाग न्यायाधीश के अपर जिला न्यायाधीश के न्यायालय कार्यालय, विधान कार्यालय व वास्तुमूल्य संयंत्रों की स्थापना का कार्य।	130.51	8.53	रु० 300.00 + जी. एर.टी. रु०18% रु० 414.00=2714.00	03 माह	अधीक्षित अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	विद्युत कार्यालय हेतु विभाग में पंजीकृत 'ए' श्रेणी के ठेकेदार	
4	मिर्जापुर	जनपद न्यायालय मिर्जापुर के जजरीज कीमिती कोर्ट, कोमितीज कोर्ट व अपर जनपद न्यायाधीश के न्यायालय कार्यालय, विधान कार्यालय व वास्तुमूल्य संयंत्रों की स्थापना का कार्य।	80.97	6.05	रु० 300.00 + जी. एर.टी. रु०18% रु० 414.00=2714.00	03 माह	अधीक्षित अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुक्त अधिनियम, वि०/ यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	विद्युत कार्यालय हेतु विभाग में पंजीकृत 'ए' श्रेणी के ठेकेदार	

3. इच्छुक निविदादाता अधिक जानकारी कालम संख्या 8, 9 एवं 10 में अंकित कार्यालय से किसी भी कार्य दिवस में प्रातः 11:00 बजे से सांय 4:00 बजे तक प्राप्त कर सकते हैं। निविदा प्रपत्र विभागीय वेबसाइट <http://etender.nic.in> से दिनांक 21.07.2026 प्रातः 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 28.07.2026 दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक डाउनलोड व अपलोड की जा सकती है। उक्त कार्य को तकनीकी निविदायें दिनांक 28.07.2026 को अपराह्न 01:00 बजे खोली जायेंगी।

शान्नादेश संख्या 1/2018/3070/78-2-2018/42 आईटीओ/2017 (22) दिनांक 03/01/2018 में निहित व्यवस्थानुसार निविदा को तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय बिड खोले जाने के उपरान्त निविदादाता द्वारा मूल अभिलेख व्यक्तित रूप से विभाग/कार्यालय में प्रस्तुत किये जाने हैं। निविदादाता द्वारा मूल अभिलेख प्रस्तुत न किये जाने की दशा में शान्नादेश में निहित प्रावधानों के अनुरूप कार्यवाही की जायेगी।

निविदाओं का तकनीकी मूल्यांकन प्रहरी साफ्टवेयर के माध्यम से किया जाना है जिसकी विस्तृत जानकारी बिड डाक्यूमेंट के साथ संलग्न निविदा सूचना में उपलब्ध है।

निविदाओं से सम्बन्धित नियम/शर्तें तथा विवरण वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है।

(आर० पी० गिरि)
अधीक्षारी अभियन्ता
वि०/यॉ० खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा

(सुराद अहसन)
अधीक्षारी अभियन्ता
वि०/यॉ० वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा।

UPID-253667 Date 13/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

PR-007710 (B & C) 2026-27



South Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited
(Regd. Office: Vidyt Bhawan, Bailey Road, Patna)
A Govt. Of Bihar Undertaking
(Department of Operation & Maintenance)
CIN No. U40109BR2012SGC018890
Website: www.sbpdc.co.in E-mail- ceomsbpdc122@gmail.com Contact No.: - 9262390710

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(Through e-procurement mode only - www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

NIT NO: 63/PR/SBPDC/2026

South Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited (SBPDCL), a Government of Bihar Undertaking, invites Request for Proposals (RFP) for Repairing of burnt/defective Power Transformer (PT) 33/11 KV 3 Phase

5 MVA and up to 10 MVA capacity at Transformer Repairing Workshop, Patna, Gaya, Barun under South Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited (SBPDCL) in two-tier (Techno-commercial and Financial) online bid from eligible and experienced Agencies / Firms / Companies / State or Central Govt. undertaking who have necessary experience:

Sl. No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost (₹)	E.M.D. (₹)	Cost of Tender Document (₹)
I.	NIT for Repairing of burnt/defective Power Transformer (PT) 33/11 KV 3 Phase 5 MVA & up to 10 MVA capacity at Transformer Repairing Workshop, Patna, Gaya and Barun under SBPDCL	7,19,38,095.00	14,38,762.00	10000.00 + Applicable GST @18% extra

The Time line for the above tender is as follows:

Sale of BOQ from	23.07.2026 at 10:00 Hrs.
Last Date of Online Submission of bid along with Tender Cost & processing fees:	10.08.2026 (up to 15:00 Hrs.)
Last Date of Submission of copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee & tender cost & EMD, etc	10.08.2026 (up to 17:00Hrs.)
Date of Pre-Bid Meeting	29.07.2026 at 11:30 Hrs, Venue: Conference Hall, Vidyt Bhawan -3
Date of opening of Technical & Commercial Part:	11.08.2026 after 11:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of Price Part:	To be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Validity of BID	180 days

The NIT documents can be downloaded from website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in, BSEDCL (BELTRON) Processing fee & tender cost are mandatory to be paid through online mode i.e. Internet Payment gateway (credit / debit card), net banking, NEFT/RTGS. Bids along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-payment portal www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the NIT. EMD in shape of Bank Guarantee/Demand draft in favour of Accounts Officer, Technical Services, SBPDCL payable at Patna and to be submitted to Project Manager, Technical Services, SBPDCL. "EMD & Hard copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee & tender cost must be submitted to the Office of The CE(O&M), SBPDCL, Vidyt Bhawan-3, Patna, Bihar on or before specified time failing which bid of the agency shall be summarily rejected. The department does not take any responsibility for the delay / Non submission of Tender / Non Rectification of online Payment caused due to Non-availability of Internet Connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reasons.

Chief Engineer (O&M)
SBPDCL

PR- 007710 (B & C) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdibihar

नरो से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

E- TENDER NOTICE No. TRS-GT-OPN-01-RSP-26-27 DDU dt. 11-07-2026

For and on behalf of the President of India, E-tender (Open) is invited from capable and established contractors/ establishments for the following work.

(1) Name of the work with its location : Routine overhauling of complete Hitachi Tractor Motor (Type HS 15250A) of Conventional Electric Locomotives. At Firm's Premises. 2. **Approx. cost of the work :** Rs. 3,62,13,090.00, 3. **Bid Security to be deposited :** Rs. 7,24,300.00, 4. **Last date and time of submission of e-tender and opening date of the e-tender :** 05-08-2026 Up to 13:00 hrs. Hrs. Date: 05-08-2026 at 15:00 Hrs. 5. **Website particulars and notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen :** Tender shall be made available on website <http://www.irops.gov.in> and detail of tender shall be available in the office of Sr. DEE/TRS/ E.C. Railway at Electric Loco shed/DDU.

Divnl. Railway Manager/ TRS, E.C. Rly. - Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya

PR/0544/DDU/DRM/TRS/26-27/36

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

No. W/118/NIT/RS.DEN/Co.JP/ENGG Date: 10.07.2026

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Divl.Rly. Manager, N.W.Railway, Jaipur for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works upto 15:00 hours on the date shown as below:
Sr. No. 1, Name of work with location: ENGG-JP-2026-27-60 - ADEN Line Sub Division:- SWM-JP(Single line) TBR-88.674 TKM and other miscellaneous work. **Approx Cost of work:** 133250640.08, **Earnest money Rs.:** 2665000.00, **Sr. No. 2, Name of work with location:** ENGG-JP-2026-27-79 - ADEN/FL Sub Division:- AEN colony, Guard colony road repair and maintenance work. **Approx cost of work:** 48392982.56, **Earnest money Rs.:** 967900.00, **Sr. No. 3, Name of work with location:** ENGG-JP-2026-27-83 - ADEN-FL Sub Division: Provision

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Gopal Lal Meena, S/o Sh. Chanda Lal Meena, R/o Plot No.411, Village Khaira Prem Nagar, Z-Block, Kashmiri Colony, Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043, do hereby solemnly declare that Gopal Meena (school records name) and Gopal Lal Meena (Aadhar Card, Pan Card, Driving Licence name) are one and the same person. Henceforth, I have changed my name from Gopal Meena to Gopal Lal Meena for all purposes. 0040865899-1

I, Kavita Kumari W/o Saumyadipta Chaudhry R/o F-1200 Chittaranjan Park Delhi-110019, Have Changed My Name To Kavita Chaudhry For Future. 0040865924-8

I, hitherto known as Sadhik Gutt, S/O- Rajender Kumar F-4/160, 1st-floor, Sector-16, Rohini, New-Delhi Delhi-110089, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Sadhik Choudhary 0040865925-8

I, Meenakshi Shamra D/o Dinesh Kumar W/o Yogendra Kumar Sharma R/o Sharda Kunj, Gali No.3, Sant Dev Nagar, Yusufpur Chak Saberi, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh 201009 have changed my name to Meenakshi Sharma for all future intents and purposes. 0040865657-2

I, Rohit Kumar, S/o- Braj Kant Mishra, R/o- 27/A-1, Street no-12, Bharat vihar, Begumpur Extension, North West-Delhi Pin-110086, have change my minor Daughter name Raghavi Kumari to Raghavi Mishra 0040865928-8

I Lakshay Pahwa S/o Anil Kumar Pahwa, R/o 315, Dr. Mukherjee Nagar, North West Delhi, Delhi-110009 have changed the name of my minor son from Yuvansh Pahwa to Dhruv Dev Pahwa for all purposes. 0040865810-1

I, SURINDER DIXIT S/o Hari Chand, 476/5A, SF, Gali No-5, Govind Puri, Delhi-19 have changed my name to SURINDER KUMAR DIXIT. 0071047579-1

I, Saleem Ahmed S/O Israr Ahmed, R/o H.NO.A-124, Gali No-02, Moonga-Nagar, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To SALEEM AHMAD. Permanently. 0040865924-1

I, Asha Joshi (before marriage), W/o Hari Om Sharma, R/o-24D Khukhrain Apartment Rohini Sector-13, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Asha Amoli after marriage. Henceforth, I shall be known as Asha Amoli for all purposes. 0040865932-7

I, Aryan Singh S/o Sh. Ajay Singh, R/o Omaxe the Forest, Flat No- 102, Corbett Tower, Plot No. A-214, Sector 92, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh - 201301, have changed my name to Aryan Singh Parmar. 0071047561-1

I, Neelam Ghosh W/o Dibyendu Ghosh, R/o C-20/SF, FS-8 KH No. 105/14/2, Block-C, Raja Puri, Uttam Nagar West, Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Neelam Shalini Ghosh for all purposes. 0040865841-1

I, MANMEET SINGH, S/O-LATE SH. HARMEET SINGH BANSAL, R/O D-1944, 3rd-Floor, Palam Vihar, Gurgaon, Haryana-122017, have changed my name from MANMEET SINGH BANSAL to MANMEET SINGH, for all future purposes. 0040865924-10

I Daizy Jain alias Dazy Rani alias Rachna W/o Shri Sunil Kumar Jain, R/o D-319, 3rd Floor, West Vinod Nagar, Gali No-20, Shakar Pur Baramand, Shakarpur, Delhi-110092 have changed my name to Daizy Jain for all purposes. 0040865810-3

I, Sooraj Bhan S/o Chheluram R/o Sector-115, Noida, Sorkha Jahidabad, G.B.Nagar U.P.-201304 have changed my name to Pappu Yadav for all future purposes. 0071047522-1

I, GHAZALA W/o MR.PARVEZ AKHTAR, R/O. 53/14, SECOND FLOOR, GALLI NO.14, ZAKIR NAGAR, OKHLA, NEW DELHI-110025, have changed my name from GHAZALA PARVEZ to GHAZALA, for all future purposes. 0040865928-10

I, Birja Devi W/o Niranjan Singh R/o-41/B, Kh.No-437, Bhagat Singh Park, Siraspur, Delhi-42 have changed my name to Billa Devi. 0071047604-1

I, Aamna W/o Mohd Idrees R/o C-219, Street No-15, Near- Navjeevan Public School, Old Mustafabad, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To AAMNA BEGAM Permanently. 0040865924-3

I, Ashwika D/o Sundep Kumar, R/O A-39, Sector-39, Noida, UP-201301, have changed my name to ASHWIKA CHOUDHARY for all future purposes. 0071047506-1

I, Naresh Kumar s/o-Khilanda Ram r/o-1991 Sector-12 sonipat, have changed my name to Naresh Kumar Nasa for all purposes. 0040865925-2

I, Anusha Balyan D/o Ajai Kumar Balyan, F-49, Jal Vayu Vihar, Sector-21, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301 have changed my name to Anusha for all future purposes. 0071047578-1

I, NABILA W/O ARBAZ ALI R/O 9996 TIRAHA BEHRAM KHAN DARYA GANI DELHI-2 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NABILA KHAN 0040865928-1

I, RAJ MOHAN ANEJA, S/O- GURCHARAN SINGH, R/O H.NO- IV/71-A F/F, GALI, NO-5 IDGAH-ROAD BHOLA NATH-NAGAR SHAHDARA DELHI-110032, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAJ MOHAN. 0040865928-3

I, Sushil Kumar Karma S/o Basant Lal Shaw, R/o H.No. 756, Sector 28, Faridabad , Haryana -121008 have changed the name of my minor daughter aged 14 Yrs from Ananya to Ananya Karma 0071047569-1

I, Renu W/O, Pankaj Kumar R/O H.No.144, Sector 2c, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, U.P. have changed my name to Renu Karna for all purposes. 0040865916-1

I, SUMANA GHOSH, w/o sumit basu , residing at 13, Prince Anwar Shah Lane, Charumarket, Tollygunge, Kolkata, West Bengal - 700033, have changed my name to SUMANA BASU 0071047533-1

I, Jennifor David William D/o David William R/O B-454, F/F, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi-110070, have change my name from Jennifor David William to Jennifer William for all future purpose 0040865932-1

I, IBLAY HASSAN, S/O- SHARIF, R/O-D-6, MASJID WALI-ROAD NEAR-PARE WALI MASJID AMBEDKAR-COLONY, CHATTARPUR SOUTH DELHI-110074, CHANGED MY NAME TO IVLE HASSAN, for all future purposes. 0040865924-5

I, Waikhom Ashokchandra Singh, S/o Waikhom Babuyaima, resident of Koireng Bazar, P.O. Mantripukhri, P.S. Heingang, District- Imphal East, Manipur, have changed my name to Waikhom Ashokchandra for all future purposes. 0040865797-2

I, Surender Kumar, S/o-Mohan Lal Aggarwal, R/O-B-63, Vishwas Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, have changed my name to Surender Aggarwal, for all purposes. 0040865925-4

I, Anil, son of Shri Jabar Singh, resident of Village Jiyalgarh, Post Office Maletsha, Tehsil Kirtinagar, District Tehri Garhwal, Uttarakhand - 249161, hereby declare that I am changing the name of my 9-year-old son, Shivansh Panwar (Date of Birth : 17 March 2017). Henceforth, he shall be known and identified by the name "Shivansh Singh" for all purposes. 0040865856-1

I, NEHA MALHOTRA, D/O SURENDER KUMAR MALHOTRA, R/O-H??-4, BLOCK-5, GALI, NO.-6, GEETA COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, S/O, EAST DELHI, DELHI-110031, have change my name from NEHA to NEHA MALHOTRA, for all future purposes. 0040865924-9

I, Salman Hashmi S/o Riaz Mehmood Hashmi R/o D-144, Third Floor, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-1, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name to Eshaan Hashmi for all purposes. 0040865810-2

I, Sameer Husain S/o Syed Isyal Hussain, R/o T-21/1003, Tower-21, Paras Tierrea, Sector-137, Noida, UP-201305, have changed my name to SAMEER HUSSAIN for all future purposes. 0071047511-1

I, Vipin Kumar S/o Virendra Singh R/o-Flat.No-115 Pocket-13, Sector-22 Rohini Delhi-110085, Have Changed My Name To Vipin Kumar Gaur. 0040865924-6

I, hitherto known as ABDULLAH SHAIKH, S/o-Ejajul Shaikh, R/O C-11/21, First-Floor, Yamuna Vihar, Garhi Mendu, PO- Bhajanpura, North-East Delhi-110053, have changed my name not my religion and shall hereafter be known as PANKAJ SHAIKH. 0040865928-9

I, BEENA SHAW ALIAS BEENA GUPTA D/O HANUMAN SHAW W/O UMESH KUMAR GUPTA R/O HOUSE NO. 572, 3RD FLOOR, NEAR SHIV MANDIR, CHIRAG DELHI, MALVIYA NAGAR, SOUTH DELHI, DELHI-110017 have changed my name to BEENA GUPTA for all purposes. 0071047598-1

I, Idrees S/O Pir Baks, R/O C-219, Street No-15, Near Navjeevan Public School, Old Mustafabad, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To MOHD EDREES Permanently. 0040865924-2

I, Mohammad Irshad Alam, S/o-Mohammad Arif Hussain, R/O-FB-1, 4th-Floor, Flat No-403, Ummat Apartment, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia Nagar, Abul Fazal Enclave-II, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Md Irshad Alam. 0040865925-1

I, MOHAMMAD HAFIZ, S/O- MOHAMMAD SATTAR, R/O H.NO.882 MAHAVIR COLONY PANIPAT HARYANA-132103, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO HAFIZ. 0040865924-4

I, Vishal, S/o Barfi Ram, R/o D-28, Sanjay Colony, Bhatti Mines, New Delhi -110074, hereby declare that my father's name appearing as Vicky in my educational certificates is incorrect. His correct name is Barfi Ram Both names refer to one and the same person 0040865819-1

I, YASHVI AKSHAY MALIK, D/O- AKSHAY ANIL MALIK, HOUSE.No-B-5/905 SAHARA GRACE, MG-ROAD BEHIND SAHARA MALL, CHAKARPUR (74), SECTOR-28, GURGAON HARYANA-122002, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO YASHVI MALIK, FOR ALL FUTURE, PURPOSE 0040865925-6

I, Manisha V/V Manisha, R/o S Balaji, R/o Flat No-875, LIG Flats, Hastals, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, have changed my name to B Manisha, for all purposes. 0040865928-6

I, RITESH AGGARWAL alias RITESH KUMAR S/o Pawan Kumar Aggarwal R/o F-86, Rohini Sector-14, Prashant Vihar Delhi-110085 have changed my name to RITESH AGGARWAL. 0040865932-5

I, SEEMA RANI KHANNA, W/O SH.VIKAS KHANNA and, D/O SH.OM PARKASH, R/O 109, FF, PRIYA DARSHNI-VIHAR PART-1, MODEL TOWN, DELHI-110009, have changed my name to SEEMA KHANNA. 0040865924-11

I, JC 595492P , Ex/ Subedar Honorary Lieutenant, Abdul Rahman Lone, S/O- Abdul Wahab Lone, R/O- Chorwal, Tehsil- Gurez, District- Bandipora. In my Service records name of my son has been wrongly mentioned as Sahil Rehman instead of Sahil Rehman Lone. It needs correction. Objections be filled to concerned authorities, Vide Affidavit No:IN- JK36609750664150Y, dated:13- July-2026. 0020516499-1

I, Kuldeep S/o Balvir Ram, holder of Indian Passport No. C7415052, R/o B-XI/288, Mohalla Pahar Singh, Rahon, Sbs Nagar, Pin: 144517, Punjab, India have changed my name Kuldeep and surname Kuldeep. All concerned please note. 0040865919-1

I, RITESH AGARWAL S/o Pawan Kumar Aggarwal R/O F-86 Rohini Sector-14, Prashant Vihar Delhi-110085 have changed my minor daughter KASHVI AGGARWAL to KASHVI AGARWAL. 0040865932-6

I, Kamal Kumar Sukheja S/o. Shri Amarlal R/o H.No.-63, Second Floor, PKT-1, Sector-24, Rohini Delhi -110085 declare that Mr Kamal & Kamal Kumar Sukheja both names are same & one person 0040865817-1

I, Nirbhay Kumar Puri, S/o-Om Prakash Puri, R/O-678/12, Ashok Vatika, Lal Dora, Devli Extn., Devli, Khanpur, New Delhi, hereby declare to change, my minor son's name, from Akshit, to Akshit Kumar Puri, for all future, purposes. 0040865925-9

I, Sudesh Kumar S/o Chittar Mal R/O-D71, 2nd Floor, Ramprastha, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Sudesh Kumar Gautam. 0071047556-1

I, Anil, son of Shri Jabar Singh, resident of Village Jiyalgarh, Post Office Maletsha, Tehsil Kirtinagar, District Tehri Garhwal, Uttarakhand - 249161, hereby declare that I am changing the name of my 9-year-old son, Shivansh Panwar (Date of Birth : 17 March 2017). Henceforth, he shall be known and identified by the name "Shivansh Singh" for all purposes. 0040865856-1

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I, Salman Hashmi S/o Riaz Mehmood Hashmi R/o D-144, Third Floor, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-1, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name to Eshaan Hashmi for all purposes. 0040865810-2

I, Sameer Husain S/o Syed Isyal Hussain, R/o T-21/1003, Tower-21, Paras Tierrea, Sector-137, Noida, UP-201305, have changed my name to SAMEER HUSSAIN for all future purposes. 0071047511-1

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I, BEENA SHAW ALIAS BEENA GUPTA D/O HANUMAN SHAW W/O UMESH KUMAR GUPTA R/O HOUSE NO. 572, 3RD FLOOR, NEAR SHIV MANDIR, CHIRAG DELHI, MALVIYA NAGAR, SOUTH DELHI, DELHI-110017 have changed my name to BEENA GUPTA for all purposes. 0071047598-1

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I, MOHAMMAD HAFIZ, S/O- MOHAMMAD SATTAR, R/O H.NO.882 MAHAVIR COLONY PANIPAT HARYANA-132103, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO HAFIZ. 0040865924-4

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I, YASHVI AKSHAY MALIK, D/O- AKSHAY ANIL MALIK, HOUSE.No-B-5/905 SAHARA GRACE, MG-ROAD BEHIND SAHARA MALL, CHAKARPUR (74), SECTOR-28, GURGAON HARYANA-122002, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO YASHVI MALIK, FOR ALL FUTURE, PURPOSE 0040865925-6

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I, Ashok Pandey S/o Sudeshwar Pandey, R/o H.No.403, Sector -18, Ranga Mohalla, Sarhau, Gurugram(Haryana)-122015, have changed my name to Ashok Kumar Pandey. 0040865924-11

I Gurpreet Singh S/o Sh. Man Mohan Singh, R/O B-6/53, Substation Flats, Safdarjung Enclave, South West Delhi-110029 have changed my name to Gurpreet Singh Gujral for all purposes. 0040865810-4

I, Richa Madaan, D/O Vijay Singhal, residing at S-76 Vijay Vihar, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, do hereby change my name and address to Richa Singhal R/O S-76 Vijay Vihar, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059 for all future purposes. 0071047525-1

I, hitherto known as KM.MUMTAZ alias MUMTAZ JAHAN, W/o-Zahid Khan, R/O-F-82/5, Mangla Puri, Terminal, Palam-Colony, Sadhik-Nagar, Part-2, Palam-Village, South-West, Delhi-110045, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MUMTAZ JAHAN. 0040865928-12

I, Salam Kennedy Singh; S. Kennedy and Salam Kennedy S/o Salam Ibohanbi, resident of Singamei Chingamakhia Liwa Road, Ningthoujam Leikai, P.O. & P.S. Singamei, District-Imphal West, Manipur, have changed my name to Salam Kennedy Singh for all purposes. 0040865797-1

I, Neha and Neha Nasa w/o-Naresh Kumar Nasa R/o-1991 sector-12 sonipat, have changed my name to Neha Rani, for all purposes. 0040865925-3

I, SUDHEER SINGH, S/O-DEVENDRA SINGH, residing at B-504 TOWER-B, RAHEJA-ATHARVA, PAWALA KHUSRUPUR, SECTOR-109, CHOMA(62), GURGAON, HARYANA-122017, have changed my name to SUDHIR SINGH for all future purposes. 0040865928-4

I, Sonam Choudhary, daughter of, No-JC- 677970A, Naib Subedar, Parveen Kumar, Presently address-Unit 35 RR BN Assam Naugam, R/O- 20 Khushrupur Bulandshahr Chehla (UP)-202392. I have changed my name to Sonam Kumari to Sonam Choudhary vide affidavit, dated -11th July 2026, before public notary, Govt of Jammu and Kashmir. 0020516498-1

I, Roshni D/o No 04058109K Rank Ex HAV Balam Singh Rawat R/O B30, Sangamvihar Phase1, Najafgarh, Delhi-110043 have changed my name to Roshni Rawat vide affidavit date 11-7-26 before Delhi. 0071047565-1

I Parul Govil Gupta or Parul Gupta W/o Pranjal Gupta R/O F-902, Golf Avenue 1, Sector-75, Noida, Gautam budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301 have Changed my name from Parul Govil Gupta or Parul Gupta to Parul Govil, Henceforth I would be known by the name of Parul Govil for all future Purposes. 0071047538-1

I, RAMNEESH KUMAR GUPTA S/o Lt Shri Joginder Nath Gupta R/O House No. B-206 Saraswati Vihar Pitampura Delhi-110034 have changed my name to RAMNEESH GUPTA. 0040865932-2

I, SATENDER KUMAR S/O- Ravinder Pratap, R/O A-32B, Vishwakarma Colony, Lal Kuan, Pul Pehlادpur, New Delhi-44, have changed the name of my minor daughter FUNNY KARAN, aged 05yrs and she shall hereafter be known as KARAN KUMAR. 0071047538-1

I, GULAM MOINUDDIN S/O KHAIRUDDIN NAWAB R/O D-4/11, DDA FLATS, SARAI KHALIL SADAR BAZAR, DELHI-110006, THAT GULAM MOINUDDIN AND MOHD MOINUDDIN IS SAME PERSON, AND MY CORRECT NAME IS GULAM MOINUDDIN AS PER AFFIDAVIT ATTESTED BY NOTARY PUBLIC/ AADHAAR CARD/ PAN CARD/ PASSPORT. I MAY BE KNOWN AS GULAM MOINUDDIN IN THE FUTURE FOR ALL PURPOSE. 0040865816-1

I, Jyoti W/o Surrender Aggarwal R/O-B-63, Vishwas Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi have changed my name to Jyoti Aggarwal for all purposes. 0040865925-5

FURNITURE

Army officer's furniture for urgent sale. Beds, dining table, chairs, shoe rack & tea tables. Sector 37 Noida 9814712146 0130066788-1

OTHERS

URGENT HIRING

North Indian/Fine Dining
Curry Chef - Graduate, 5+ years' experience in North Indian cuisine, curries, tandoor & fine dining. Experience with reputed hotels/restaurants essential. Age below 32.
Restaurant Manager - Graduate, 5+ years' experience in beverages, bar operations & restaurant management. Experience with reputed hotels/restaurants essential. Age below 32.
CV & photo: WhatsApp +917891086969
thankyougnd2013@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed on behalf of my client Smt. Rinku Devi, wife of Shri Ram Kishore Singh, resident of Khana No.362, Ground Floor, Gali No.26, Kaushik Enclave, Barasti, Delhi-110 084, that my client has disinherited and debarred her niece i.e. the daughter of her sister, namely Ms. Deepak, daughter of Shri Shambhu Thakur, resident of House NO.15, Gali No.37, B Block, Kaushik Enclave, Barasti, Delhi-110 084, from the inheritance of all her movable and immovable properties and on account of her acts and conducts, have severed up all her relations and connections with her. In fact, any one deal with the said niece of my aforesaid client in future, he or she shall be doing so at his/her own risk and responsibility and my client shall not be held liable and responsible for the same in any manner whatsoever.

Sd/-
(Mr. Jaumeet Kaur)
Advocate
Chamber No.126, Civil Wing,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

BE IT KNOWN TO PUBLIC THAT MY CLIENTS SH. ASHOK, S/O LATE SH. PARKASH, AGE-68 YEARS, R/O H.NO- EE-265, BLOCK-EE, JAHANGIR PURI BLOCK, DELHI-11003 HAVE SERVED ALL THEIR RELATION WITH THEIR YOUNGER SON AJAY. MY ABOVE NAMED CLIENTS HAVE SEVERED ALL RELATIONSHIPS AND DEBARRED HIS SON FROM ALL THEIR MOVABLE AND IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES DUE TO HIS ALCOHOLISM, HIS ALCOHOL, FUELED ABUSE TOWARD ME AND FAMILY, HIS DISRUPTION OF THE HOME PEACEFUL ENVIRONMENT AND HIS TOXIC HABITS AND DISGRACEFUL MISCONDUCT AND HOSTILE BEHAVIOUR. MY CLIENT SHALL NOT BE LIABLE RESPONSIBLE FROM THEIR ANY ACTS AND DEEDS ANY MANNER WHATSOEVER.

Sd/-
RAHUL
ADVOCATE
CHAMBER NO-78, 1ST FLOOR,
TIS HAZARI COURTS,
DELHI-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

This information is for general public and Rahul Sharma S/o Late Sh. Premraj Sharma & Aka Wife Rahul Sharma in particular. My client Smt. Manita Sharma W/o Late Sh. Premraj, R/o H. No-132/D Surya Colony, Sahatpur Faridabad Haryana-121003. Hereto down and detail their son Rahul Sharma and his wife Alka from all their movable and immovable property, due to their misbehavior, as they are out of their control, heretofore, any person dealing with them can do so on his own risk and consequences and my client shall not be held responsible for the same. My client has severed all their relation with them.

Saleship Gupta & Associates (Advocates)
Ch. No. 163 Saket Court New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all public that my clients Mr. Ajit Singh Chalia S/O Late Sh. Pyare Lal Chalia and Mrs. Sneh Lata Chalia, wife of Mr. Ajit Chalia, permanent Resident of Flat No. 260, Nagin Lake Apartments, Paschim Vihar, Delhi-110087, has disowned / debarred his own son namely "Varun Singh" and his wife namely "Sonali" from all movable and immovable properties/assets and severed all relations due to their disobedience and bad behavior. My Clients shall not be responsible for any acts and deeds in any manner whatsoever.

Sd/-
Hunny Singh (Advocate)
Chamber No. 344, Lawyers
Block-I Delhi-110041

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my client Mr. Manoj Kumar Goyal, S/o Mr. Ramesh Chand Goyal, R/o 1332/90, Shanti Nagar, Tri Nagar, Okla, Delhi-110035, hereby declares that he has no concern, connection or relationship whatsoever, whether social or financial, with his brother Mr. Parveen Goel, R/o House No. 4, Road No. 71, 2nd Floor, West Punjabi Bagh, Delhi-110026. My Client's has severed all personal, social, financial and other ties with him long ago. My client shall not be responsible for any of his brother's acts, deeds, transactions, borrowings, commitments, liabilities or obligations, nor shall Mr. Parveen Goel have any authority to represent my client, and any person who has dealt or shall hereafter deal with him shall do so entirely at his/her own risk and responsibility without any claim whatsoever against my client.

Dr. Chait Singh (Advocate)
D/1889/2005, (Mob.: 9818613613)

PUBLIC NOTICE

Informed public at large that my clients RAM KISHAN S/O LATE DHUR VYUJ SINGH AND SMT. MUNNI DEVI W/O RAM KISHAN BOTH R/O A-443, SHIVAM COLONY, BUDHI VIHAR PHASE-II, DELHI-110086, have debarred our son MR. SUMIT AND GAJENDER SINGH SONS OF RAM KISHAN AND MUNNI SINGH AND MRS. NISSIA W/O MR. SUMIT, From our Movable and Immovable properties in all India and severed their all relations from them. If in future any body deals with them to do so far his/her own risk, costs, risks and responsibilities, my client will not be responsible for the same in any manner whatsoever.

SAMUNDRA SINGH (Advocate)
ENRL. No. D-199908

PUBLIC NOTICE

General public is hereby informed that my client Sh. Mange Ram S/O Chander Singh and his wife Poonam both R/o House No. 383, Aachandri Village, Barwana, North West Delhi, Delhi, Disowned/debarred their son Paras and his wife and his children from all of their movable and immovable properties. If anybody, dealing/making any business or family term of relation with Paras and his wife and children in future, will be at their own risk and my client will not be held responsible for the same. Dimple (Advocate) Ch. No.208 Rohini Court Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

General public is hereby informed that my clients Mr. Manoj Kumar Goyal, S/o Mr. Ramesh Chand Goyal, R/o 1332/90, Shanti Nagar, Tri Nagar, Okla, Delhi-110035, hereby declares that he has no concern, connection or relationship whatsoever, whether social or financial, with his brother Mr. Parveen Goel, R/o House No. 4, Road No. 71, 2nd Floor, West Punjabi Bagh, Delhi-110026. My Client's has severed all personal, social, financial and other ties with him long ago. My client shall not be responsible for any of his brother's acts, deeds, transactions, borrowings, commitments, liabilities or obligations, nor shall Mr. Parveen Goel have any authority to represent my client, and any person who has dealt or shall hereafter deal with him shall do so entirely at his/her own risk and responsibility without any claim whatsoever against my client.

Dr. Chait Singh (Advocate)
D/1889/2005, (Mob.: 9818613613)

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my clients Gurmurt Singh S/O S. Jivan Singh and Smt. Randhir Singh W/o Gurdas Singh both R/O D/15, Vishnu Garden Extn-5, Khayla, West Delhi-110018 hereby sever all their relations with their son namely Farayad Singh. Due to his misbehavior and disobedience with my clients, hereby disowned and debarred him from all their movable and immovable properties forever. Any person dealing with him shall be doing so at his/her own risk and responsibility. My clients will not be responsible for his any act and deeds.

PRADHEEP KUMAR (ADVOCATE)
Off. SR-162, Distt. Court, Janki Park, N.D-58

COURT NOTICE

In The Court of Dr. Rakshak Kumar, Ld District Judge (Commercial)-04, Court Room No. 21, New Block-1, South-east District, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi Proclamation Requiring Attendance Of Defendant (Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure) Smt. Nisha Indira Private Limited vs. V/SPlaintiff K.K. Overseas Private LimitedDefendant K.K. Overseas Private Limited Through Its Director Plt. No. 1322, Ansal Towers-38, Nehru Place, South Delhi, New Delhi-110019 E-rqiv@kkothersprivate.com M.3871058032 E-rqiv@kforeshgroup.com, Also at: Kh. No. 361, Ground Floor, Lal Dora Village Hamidpur, Delhi-110036 Whereas you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the 30.07.2026 the day fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex-parte Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, this 10.06.2026. District Judge (Commercial Court)-04 South-East District Saket Court Complex, New Delhi Seal

"IMPORTANT"

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The Indian EXPRESS JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

सर्वजनिक सूचना

एवढ द्रास सूचित किया जाता है। कि श्री अर, के ओहरी पुत्र स्व. विरान द्रास ओहरी निवासी आंज जी पी नरमदन गै-61138 विसर विहार दिल्ली नया नं. 82 केक्टर 31 नोएडा के खानगी है। पूर्व श्री कृष्ण लाल द्रास सुपुत्र स्व. श्री अर किरान बाघवा निवासी - C-382 A सुन्दरन गजियारवा, प्लॉट नं. - 82, अर किरान बाघवा रजिस्टर्ड सुपुत्र आर है। निम्नर रिस्ट्रिक्शन 30/04/91 को इला विसर विरवान बही नं 4 डिविज नं. 1490, 1562, पृष्ठ संख्या- 375,481/486 प्रमाण संख्या नं. 1362 बुक नं. 4 पर अंकित है। वर पालिका श्री कृष्ण लालबाघवा सुपुत्र स्व. श्री बाल किरान बाघवा निवासी C-382 A सुन्दरन गजियारवा द्रास श्री मीरी कृष्ण बाघवा पर्वणी श्री कृष्ण लाल बाघवा निवासी C-382 A सुन्दरन (गो) के पक्ष में द्रासवर किया जा रहा है। यदि इस संवत्स में किसी भी व्यक्ति को किसी प्रकार की आपत्ति है। तो कृपया अपनी आपत्ति साक्ष्य सहित नोएडा विकास प्राधिकरण केक्टर-96 के आवासियों मुख्यालय विभाग में इस सूचना के प्रकाशन की तिथि से 20 दिनों के अन्दर द्रासित करें इस अपेक्षा के उपरान्त किसी भी प्रकार की आपत्ति को स्वीकार नहीं किया जायेगा

For & on behalf of RK Ohri & Krishan Lal Badwina (Advocate)

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans on their Balidan Diwas.

 SUB INSPECTOR MILKHI RAM 33 BN BSF 15.05.1947 – 15.07.1994	 CONSTABLE NARENDER PAL, PMG, SENA MEDAL 69 BN BSF 09.05.1963 – 15.07.1997	 LANCE NAIK SHIV DAYAL SINGH 33 BN BSF 05.10.1954 – 15.07.1994	 CONSTABLE FAYAZ AHMED WANI 145 BN BSF 10.03.1976 – 15.07.2005
 NAIK JASHI RAM 78 BN BSF 02.03.1954 – 15.07.1992	 CONSTABLE AJAIBEEER SINGH 145 BN BSF 05.07.1973 – 15.07.1996	 CONSTABLE DEVI DUTT PANDEY 145 BN BSF 15.07.1972 – 15.07.1996	 CONSTABLE LOKENDRA SINGH 114 BN BSF 27.04.1991 – 15.07.2018
 CONSTABLE MUKHTIYAR SINGH 114 BN BSF 20.01.1980 – 15.07.2018	 CONSTABLE SANJAY KUMAR, PPMG 172 BN BSF 08.02.1969 – 15.07.1992	 CONSTABLE NASIRUDDIN AHMED 54 BN BSF 06.01.1984 – 15.07.2022	

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

 Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Kameshwar Rai 12 Bn 20-1-1950 To 15-7-1999	 Veer Balidani Lance Naik P. K. Singh 12 Bn 1-1-1967 To 15-7-1999	 Veer Balidani Constable P.K. Sharma 12 Bn 18-3-1970 To 15-7-1999
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DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Kameshwar Rai, Lance Naik P. K. Singh, and Constable P. K. Sharma of 12 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in Manipur on 15 July 1999. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable/Driver Mohd. Salim 60 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in a grenade attack by militants in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 15 July 1990. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

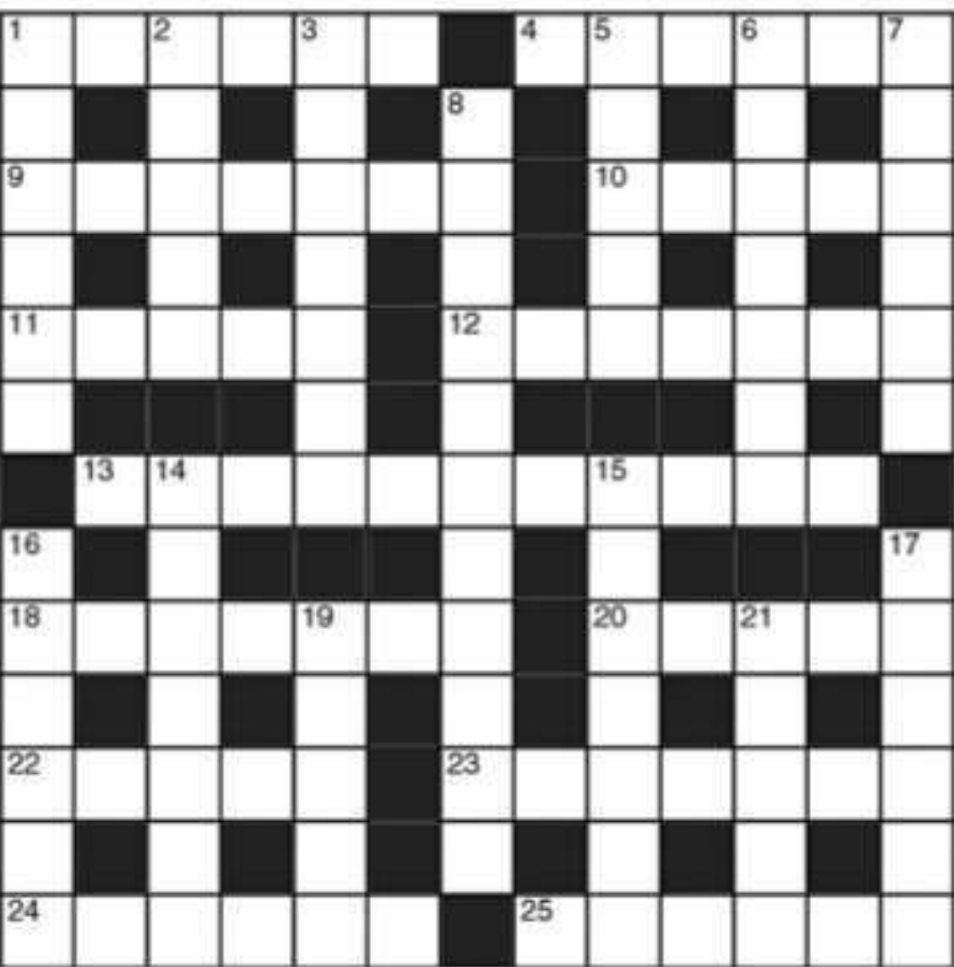
Sr. DEE-TRS-GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender against Tender No- 230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-04. The details are as under:

1. Name of the work	The different mechanical work of 'Dismantling of Loco Equipment / Sub-Assemblies of WAP5 locomotive' at Electric Loco Shed, Ghaziabad.
2. Approx. cost of work	₹ 46,60,168.00
3. Earnest Money to be deposited	₹ 93,200.00
4. Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender	14.08.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)
5. Date & Time of opening of tender document	14.08.2026 (After 15:00 Hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

Note : (i) The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in e-tender system. (ii) For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable. (iv) Cost of Tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. No- 230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-04 Dated: 13.07.2026 2419/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 The wig may give authority (6)
- 4 Emblem on a famous Swiss bank (6)
- 9 Raise the spirits of tot in depression (7)
- 10 A number get a bad omen having fatal results (5)
- 11 Best at the barbecue? (5)
- 12 Anxiety for a business organisation (7)
- 13 Brought into force? (11)
- 18 Collar the boy - he's a hoodlum (7)
- 20 Deduce it's a finer organisation (5)
- 22 Rectangular area of Nepal? (5)
- 23 Glowered as flat-bottomed boat came in first (7)
- 24 Such things happen even on the way back (6)
- 25 The raffia-weaving business (6)
- DOWN
- 1 In we go for a duck (6)
- 2 Unsuitable camouflage paint (5)
- 3 Ugly house I'd convert (7)
- 5 It flies a welcome in the British fleet (5)
- 6 What letter-writers often claim to be (7)
- 7 Old man cracks a nut (6)
- 8 A case of mixed dates (11)
- 14 Aggressive action taken by those insulted (7)
- 15 Put two and two together (4,3)
- 16 Ice-cold (6)
- 17 Revolutionary painting put up by dealer (6)
- 19 Piece of land is on lease (5)
- 21 Come a cropper with a Spanish composer (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6040 ACROSS: 1 Off-load, 5 Toque, 8 Forget oneself, 9 Raise, 10 Satanic, 11 Honest, 12 Drifts, 15 Sits out, 17 Views, 19 Admission free, 20 Eases, 21 Guessed DOWN: 1 Offer, 2 Foreign stamps, 3 Oneness, 4 Drowsy, 5 Theft, 6 Queen of hearts, 7 Effects, 11 Hostage, 13 Revenue, 14 String, 16 Oasis, 18 Speed

JUMBLD WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

My friends are my _____. - Emily Dickinson (6)

RUVVE

●●●●●●

ASSTUT

●●●●●●

HAKES

●●●●●●

AEHHLT

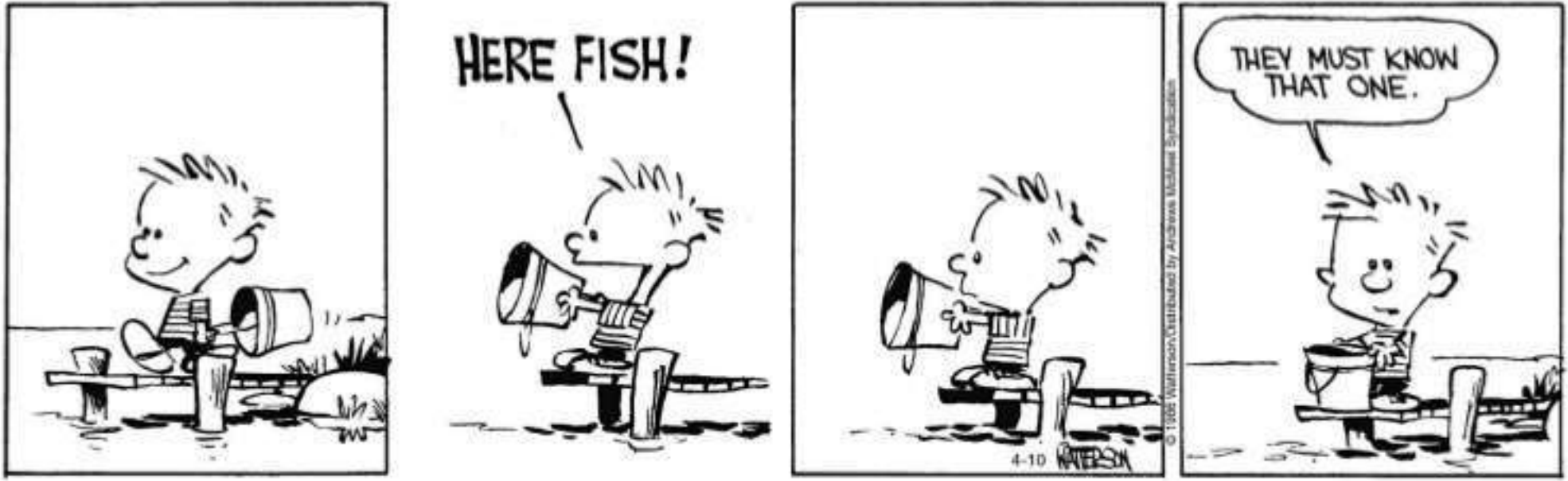
●●●●●●

ANSWER: My friends are my estate. - Emily Dickinson

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6380

		8	9	3				
			2	4				
1		7	5		3	6		2
	6						5	
9	2						4	3
	8						2	
4		5	9		6	2		8
			8	1				
			6	3	1			

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6379

4	6	2	9	7	8	5	1	3
7	8	1	4	3	5	9	2	6
3	9	5	2	6	1	7	4	8
8	3	6	5	9	2	4	7	1
1	5	7	8	4	6	2	3	9
2	4	9	7	1	3	8	6	5
9	2	3	6	8	4	1	5	7
6	7	4	1	5	9	3	8	2
5	1	8	3	2	7	6	9	4

ROYAL STARS

- ♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): An unusual idea or event might take you into an entirely new headspace today. You might entertain the notion of a new kind of future for yourself than you had previously thought. Tonight: Socialise.
- ♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): You are certainly aware of the value of wealth in practical terms. However, today you might receive a new interpretation of the energy of wealth and what is possible to achieve, for yourself or for others. Tonight: Relax at home.
- ♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Something might occur today that makes you deeply appreciate a friend or a group to which you might belong. Tonight: Discussions.
- ♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Today you might be admired for taking a stand on a certain issue or speaking up about something that is important to you. What you do will reveal a level of compassion and understanding that might inspire someone else. Tonight: Check your belongings.
- ♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Some kind of subtle shift might take place that prompts you to think about a different future for yourself, or perhaps a different path. Whatever it is, it's heartening. Tonight: You're powerful.
- ♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): With Venus in your sign, you are gracious and diplomatic, which is a good thing, because someone in authority might do something that catches you off guard. Ironically, that might open your eyes to a new way of doing things. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.
- ♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): People admire you right now. In an unexpected way, something related to travel, further education, medicine or the law might catch you off guard and open new worlds for you. Tonight: Be friendly.
- ♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Be aware that people notice you today. Perhaps this is because something unexpected benefits you — an inheritance, a bonus or a gift. Tonight: You're admired.
- ♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Listen to the ideas of partners, spouses and close friends, because they might be the source of something that can lead to a positive shift in your life. It could be a deeper understanding or appreciation of what you have and who you are. Tonight: Explore.
- ♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Something related to your health, your job or even a pet might have the power to inspire you to consider something in a new light. You might not be content with old goals, because suddenly, new insights promise a refreshing level of consciousness. Tonight: Check your finances.
- ♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You might feel more inspired by romance or something related to kids that lifts you to a new level of appreciation and ambition. It's as if you are suddenly seeing new possibilities or appreciating things in a new way. Tonight: Cooperate.
- ♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Your appreciation of the value of home and family might take on a new level of meaning today. You might suddenly grasp that it is more important than you thought. Tonight: Get organised.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

Corrigendum No. 2 Corrigendum Publish Date 14.07.2026

Tender No.: 362258 (Open Tender) Closing Date/Time: 20.07.2026, 15:00 Hrs.

Name of work: Refurbishment of LWSCZAG coaches during MLR Schedule at RCKN/SNP

Field Name	Existing Value	Modified Value
Tender closing date and time	15.07.2026, 15:00	20.07.2026, 15:00

Tender No. 362258 Dated: 14.07.2026 2432/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system.

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	07261931A	GRAVITY COCK	277884 NOS	10.08.26
02	07261501	AIR BRAKE HOSE COUPLING FOR BRAKE PIPE	20217 NOS	10.08.26
03	09262118	YOKE PIN	3881 NOS	10.08.26
04	02261158	SCROLL COMPRESSOR THREE PHASE	235 NOS	10.08.26
05	07265049	SUPPLY AND FITMENT OF UPPER TRIM PANEL	40 SET	12.08.26
06	07261077	REAR COVER FOR AXLE BOX (MACHINED)	14696 NOS	19.08.26
07	09262050	SIDE FRAME KEY (FOR CART.G.R.B)	108079 NOS	24.08.26
08	09262014	AXLE END CAP SCREW.	224786 NOS	14.09.26

Note: (i). Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No. 26/2026-2027 Dated: 13/07/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

2402/26

प्रवर्तन निदेशालय
भारत सरकार

DIRECTORATE OF ENFORCEMENT

Government of India

Directorate of Enforcement, HMT Machine Tools Limited Compound, Bangalore Complex, Jalahalli, Bengaluru - 560013.

KABC01-007639-2023 Next Date: 17-08-2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED (See Section 82)

Form No. 4

IN THE COURT OF CCH48 XLVII ADDL. CITY CIVIL AND SESSIONS JUDGE-SPL.C/623/2023

THE ASSISTANT DIRECTOR DIRECTORATE OF ENFORCEMENT Vs A1 M/S MAD ELEPHANT NETWORK TECHNOLOGY PVT LTD

WHEREAS complaint has been made before me that A10 TANUJ SINGH, Age - 0 years, R/o. RZD 104, GALI NO.07, RAJNAGAR 2 BAGDOLA SOUTH WEST DELHI 77 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence of punishable under section 3,70U/SEC4 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said A10 TANUJ SINGH cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said A10 TANUJ SINGH has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that the said A10 TANUJ SINGH, Age - 0 R/o. RZD 104, GALI NO.07, RAJNAGAR 2 BAGDOLA SOUTH WEST DELHI 77 is required to appear at before to answer the said complaint on the day of 17-08-2026.

Dated, this day of 04-07-2026

CCH48 XLVII ADDL. CITY CIVIL AND SESSIONS JUDGE BENGALURU

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of work and its location 98-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27 Electrical Work in Connection with provision of video surveillance system at stations over DLI Division.

Address of the office Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055

Approx. Cost of the work ₹59,48,047/- Earnest Money ₹1,19,000/-

Last Date & Time of Submission of Tender 05.08.2026 at 16:00 hrs.

Opening of Tender 05.08.2026 at 16:00 hrs.

Website & Notice Board www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi

2413/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. DEE-TRS-GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender against Tender No. 230-TRS-GZB-2024-25-30-2RT. The details are as under:

1. Name of the work	Removal, fitment, maintenance and repairing of Battery box of WAPS, WAP7, AND WAG9 locomotive during Inspection Schedule/ Unscheduled visit for a period of 36 Months at Electric Loco Shed, Ghaziabad.
2. Approx. cost of work:	₹ 45,31,235.50
3. Earnest Money to be deposited:	₹ 90,600.00
4. Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender	14.08.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)
5. Date & Time of opening of tender document:	14.08.2026 (After 15:00 Hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen:	www.ireps.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in e-tender system. (ii) For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable. (iv) Cost of Tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. 230-TRS-GZB-2024-25-30-2RT Dated: 13.07.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

2418/26

GOVERNMENT OF CHHATTISGARH,

WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

E/M LIGHT MACHINERY TUBE WELL & GATE DIVISION SAKRI, BILASPUR (C.G.)

e-Procurement Tender Notice

eProcurement Portal: <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>

(SECOND-CALL)

System Tender No. 195063/NIT No.: 06/SAC/2026-27 Dated: 10.07.2026

Online Tenders are invited for the following works up to 27.07.2026 at 17.30 Hour

Name of work REPAIR & RENOVATION WORK OF GATES, PAINTING WORK, REMOTE CONTROL SYSTEM AND LIGHTING ARRANGEMENTS AT SITE OF LACHHANPUR DIVERSION SCHEME IN BLOCK-BILHA, DISTT-BILASPUR.

Probable Amount of Contract: Rs. 125.24 Lakhs (Excluding GST) (Probable Amount of Contract based on SOR 22.08.2022)

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh Integrated e-Procurement Portal (<https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>) from Date 17.07.2026, at 17.31 Hours.(IST) onwards.

NOTE:

1- All eligible/intrested contractors/bidders are mandated to get enrolled on the Integrated e-procurement portal (<https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>) and get approval on specific vendor class from PWD under Centralized Contractor/Supplier Registration in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

2- It is mandatory for the tenderer to use the certificate issued for Pre Bid Qualification (Valid up to 30.09.2026) in the year 2025 in this tender.

3. For Prequalification Submit Necessary document as mentioned in Tender Form B Clause 2.1.1.(S. No.4&5) & ANNEXURE-I (P.Q. & Tender Form B Document)

4. The Tenderer has to exclude GST in his financial proposal.

Sd/- Executive Engineer E/M L.M.T.W. & Gate Division Sakri, Bilaspur (C.G.)

Ro. No. 262702061/6

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused (1) Prem @ Premu, S/o Vasaru Ram @ Veeru R/o D-122, JJ Colony, Sawda Kanjhawala Delhi, (2) Gilin @ Gileen S/o Mani Lal R/o H.No. 539, H-Block, JJ Colony, Sawda, Kanjhawala, Delhi and (3) Neenu S/o Jeevan Lal R/o H.No.885, O-Block, JJ Colony, Sawda, Kanjhawala, Delhi have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.101/2026 u/s 318(4)/(3/5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Sunlight Colony, Delhi and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Prem @ Premu, Gilin @ Gileen and Neenu cannot be found and whereas it have been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Prem @ Premu, Gilin @ Gileen and Neenu have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Prem @ Premu, Gilin @ Gileen and Neenu of FIR No.101/2026 u/s 318(4)/(3/5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Sunlight Colony, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 29.08.2026.

By Order
Ms. Divyam Lila
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
South East District, Room No.508
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/9546/SE/2026

झारखण्ड सरकार

स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग

सूचना

विभागीय अधिसूचना संख्या-364(9) दिनांक-18.06.2026 तथा 165(9) दिनांक-18.03.2026 द्वारा कतिपय सहायक प्राध्यापकों की नियुक्ति एवं पदस्थापन किया गया। इनमें से योगदान नहीं करने वाले निम्नांकित सहायक प्राध्यापक की नियुक्ति अधिसूचना विलोपित की जानी है। निम्नांकित सहायक प्राध्यापक द्वारा पदस्थापन स्थल पर योगदान समर्पित नहीं किया गया है:-

क्र.सं.	नियुक्ति अधिसूचना संख्या / तिथि	नाम, पदनाम, विभाग एवं पदस्थापन
1.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० रोहित, सहायक प्राध्यापक, दंत रोग विभाग, एम०डी०एच० चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, जमशेदपुर
2.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० मनीष कुमार गुप्ता, सहायक प्राध्यापक, टी०बी० एच० वेंट्र विभाग, शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महा०, धनबाद।
3.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० अभिषेक जयसवाल, सहायक प्राध्यापक, रेडियोलॉजी विभाग, शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महा०, धनबाद।
4.	165(9) / 18.03.2026	डॉ० विनीत मर्म, सहायक प्राध्यापक, निश्चेतना विभाग, शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महा०, धनबाद।
5.	165(9) / 18.03.2026	डॉ० कार्तिक चन्द्र बेसरा, सहायक प्राध्यापक, निश्चेतना विभाग, शेख निखारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, इजरायीबाग
6.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० अजिना कुमार, सहायक प्राध्यापक, मार्डोकायोलॉजी विभाग, मेडिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, पलामू।
7.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० कुशल राज, सहायक प्राध्यापक, औषधि विभाग, मेडिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, पलामू।
8.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० दिशा रॉय, सहायक प्राध्यापक, मनोरोग रोग विभाग, मेडिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, पलामू।
9.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० शिवशंकर गुप्ता, सहायक प्राध्यापक, औषधि विभाग, कुली-झांनो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, दुमका।
10.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० लाल नरेंद्र प्रसाद, सहायक प्राध्यापक, अस्थि रोग विभाग, कुली-झांनो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, दुमका।
11.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० सरोज माकुस, सहायक प्राध्यापक, औषधि विभाग, कुली-झांनो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, दुमका।
12.	364(9) / 24.09.2025	डॉ० तरुण कुमार, सहायक प्राध्यापक, शिशु रोग विभाग, कुली-झांनो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, दुमका।

2. संबंधित सहायक प्राध्यापक दिनांक-28.07.2026 तक वांछित कामजाती के साथ ऑनलाईन माध्यम से E-mail ID - hlthdept.fdi@gmail.com पर अथवा विभाग में अपना पक्ष रख सकते हैं।

3. उक्त अवधि के पश्चात् किसी भी प्रकार का दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।

PR 384873 (Health Med Edu and Family Welfare) 26-27 (D) (आनन्द कुमार सिन्हा) सरकार के अवर सचिव।

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. JHS/Commercial/e-Auction/2026 Date : 10.07.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of The President Of India, The Divisional Railway Manager, (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Category : Advertisement Catalogue No. : JHS-FREIGHT-09

Asset Details : 1. Open E auction to provide refreshment facility for staff and labours at Bhimsen Goods shed (BZM) & Barwa sagar Goods shed (BWR) for a period of 05 years of Jhansi Division in North Central Railway. 2. Contract for installation, operation & maintenance of electronic weighbridge at SANK goods shed (SANK), Datia goods shed (DAA), Rayaru goods shed (RRU), Niwari goods shed (NEW), Dabra goods shed (DBA) of jhansi division in North Central Railway.

Auction Start : 25.07.2026 at 10:30 hrs

Auction End : 25.07.2026 at 12:00 hrs

Note : Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1580/26 (C)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONC

क्रमांक:-अमुअ /अज/ तक./एक-2 (30ए) निविदा/डी-1083 दिनांक:-09.07.2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या 13 वर्ष 2026-2027

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से पोस्टलिवल असेसमेंट पद्धति के अनुसार सी.सी. सड़क एवं भवन निर्माण कार्यों हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं केन्द्रीय / राज्य सरकार व उनके अधिकृत संगठनों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एघम दूर संचार विभाग / रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के विभिन्न श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में कुल 04 पैकेज / कार्यों, जिनकी कुल लागत राशि रु. 2683.11 लाख है, के लिए ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

निविदा फार्म डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तात्ख एवं समय दिनांक 13 जुलाई, 2026 को प्रातः 9.30 बजे से दिनांक 04 अगस्त, 2026 को सांय 6.00 बजे तक।

निविदा से संबंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाईट www.diponline.org पर एवं निविदा दर्तावेज का विवरण वेबसाईट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन सम्पदित की जावेगी। NIB No.- PWD 2627 A1578 हस्ता/- अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियंता, सा.नि.वि., संभाग, अजमेर।

UBN No.- PWD2627WLOB06738 PWD2627WLOB06741 PWD2627WLOB06742

No. DIPR/C/12332/2026

HQ District Police,Ramban

dpo.ramban12@jkpolice.gov.in

NO:-CB/Look out Notice/2026/38926-55

Dated:- 13-07-2026

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by SHO Police Station Ramsoo vide letter No. 422/5-A/PSR/26 dated 13-07-2026, that on 13.07.2026 one un-identified Male dead body is lying at Hewagan Ramsoo, District Ramban under suspicious circumstance, to ascertain the actual cause of death inquest Proceeding U/S 194 BNSS has been initiated at Police Station Ramsoo, District Ramban (UT of J&K) vide DOR No. 09 dated 13-07-2026 and the dead body of the deceased has been shifted to Sub-District Hospital Banihal for identification. The description role/photograph of un-identified Male dead body is as under:-

Description Role	Photograph
Age: 25-30 years (Approx) Height: 5' 5" (Approx) Complexion: Whitish Build: Slim Hair: Black Medium length & Short black beard & moustache Dress: Gray blue and white Checked Half sleeve shirt & black Trouser. Identification Marks: Injury Mark on forehead & left Side of the face.	

Any Other, Identification:

It is therefore requested that, if any missing report of such person has been entered in your respective Police Units, resembling with above description role of said un-identified Male dead body, immediate information may kindly be sent to the web site E-mail ID dpo.ramban12@jkpolice.gov.in, Phone No. 9906926079, 9906925595 (PCR Ramban) Phone No. 9419157737 (SHO P/S Ramsoo) & Phone No. 9103011697 (P/S Ramsoo).

Sd/- (Arun Gupta)-JKPS Sr. Superintendent of Police, Ramban.

DIP NO. DIP/4-5783/26 DATE 14.07.2026

● IS FIFA FAVOURING ARGENTINA?

A look at 4 talking points

1 MESSI'S CHALLENGE ON AISSA MANDI
Argentina vs Algeria

LIONEL MESSI caught Algeria captain Aissa Mandi with a late challenge in the first match. Algeria felt it was worthy of a red card, but not only did Messi avoid a booking, he also went on to score a hat-trick. **CONCLUSION:** This was a controversial decision, as replays made it obvious that Messi had caught Mandi with his studs.

2 MOSTAFA ZICO'S CANCELLED GOAL
Argentina vs Egypt

MOSTAFA ZICO scored in the 58th minute. But after review, French referee Francois Letexier chalked the goal off for a foul that happened at the other end of the pitch. Marwan Attia stepped on Lisandro Martinez's foot, which led to the Egypt counter-attack, and eventually, the goal.

WHAT DOES THE RULE SAY?

VAR is provisioned to review the phase of play that resulted in the goal, and vet for any infringements which might have been overlooked. Since Attia's foul was the point of origin of the Egyptian attack, the foul was looked at. **CONCLUSION:** This remains the tournament's most debatable decision. Not because Attia's foul was particularly contentious, but because it occurred roughly 85 metres from goal and around 13 seconds before Zico scored.

3 MOHAMED SALAH'S PENALTY APPEAL
Argentina vs Egypt

EGYPT FELT aggrieved once again in stoppage time. Mohamed Salah went down inside the penalty area after a challenge from Julián Álvarez, but Letexier immediately waved away the appeals. VAR conducted a routine check and upheld the on-field decision. **CONCLUSION:** Replays revealed that the contact was minimal, and not worthy of a penalty. The referee, hence, cannot be faulted for this decision.

4 BREEL EMBOLLO'S RED CARD
Argentina vs Switzerland

BREEL EMBOLLO threw himself to the ground with enough conviction to convince referee João Pinheiro that he was shoved by Leandro Paredes. Pinheiro duly booked Paredes, but then VAR recommended on-field review. Replays showed no contact between Embollo and Paredes, insinuating the Swiss striker had simulated the dive. Pinheiro then rescinded Paredes' yellow card and brandished one at Embollo instead, for whom, it was the second booking, resulting in a red card.

WHAT DOES THE RULE SAY?

ON THIS occasion, the IFAB's 'mistaken identity' rule was applied. According to the law, a VAR team can review instances where a referee has penalised the wrong player for the offence in question. After review, the referee is provisioned to rescind the wrongful yellow, and penalise the actual perpetrator instead. **CONCLUSION:** There is room for debate about the necessity of the rule, but none regarding its application. Referee Pinheiro had only followed the rulebook. SHUVADITYA BOSE

OPPONENTS' ENVY, GAFFERS' GRIPE



World champions Argentina (left) struggled against 10-man Switzerland; Thomas Tuchel was unhappy with England's performance against Norway. AP

Creaking Argentina, squeaking England

SET FOR A SCRAP



Sandip G
Atlanta, July 14

Unlike smooth-sailing France and Spain, the other two semi-finalists have weathered storms, survived scares and relied on force of personalities to come this far

● Midfield Battle

Neither side has a perfectly settled engine room. Imbalances reek in both camps, be it the Argentines' weariness from late comebacks or England's form, fitness concerns



LEANDRO PAREDES



RODRIGO DE PAUL



DECLAN RICE



EBERECHI EZE

FATIGUE HAS crippled Leandro Paredes and Rodrigo de Paul, both in their early 30s. Running the runs for Lionel Messi in two games decided by extra time has eventually caught up with them. Paredes did not last the game against Switzerland, and when he was substituted, Argentina lost their control in the midfield, and were fortunate that they enjoyed numerical superiority.

ENGLAND MIDFIELD is a superlative product, younger, quicker, stronger and technically sturdier. But the talisman Declan Rice is fighting his fitness; Eberechi Eze, reduced to cameos, has not recreated the same flourish as he had in his Arsenal days; Elliot Anderson, for all his diligence, lacks the all-action-hero verve of Rice.

and a last-gasp comeback against Egypt. Individuals have seized the moments. Harry Kane against Congo, Bellingham versus Norway; Lionel Messi in almost every game, Julian Alvarez with a pearler against Switzerland. Imbalances reek in mid-field and flanks. Argentina's midfield has looked weary. Fatigue has crippled Leandro Paredes and Rodrigo de Paul, both in their early 30s. Running the runs for Messi in two games decided by extra time has eventually caught up with them. Paredes did not last the game against Switzerland, and when he was substituted, Argentina lost their control in the midfield, and were fortunate that they enjoyed numerical superiority. Head-to-head, England midfield is a superlative product, younger, quicker, stronger and technically sturdier. But the talisman Declan Rice is fighting his fitness; Eberechi Eze, reduced to cameos, has not recreated the same flourish as he had in his

For all of England's marginal superiority in midfield, defence, physicality and height, Argentina have a shorthand solution for all their woes: Lionel Messi

Arsenal days; Elliot Anderson, for all his diligence, lacks the all-action-hero verve of Rice. A peak Rice and Bukayo Saka would have been a different story and could have run Argentina's weary midfield ragged. Alexis Mac Allister and Enzo Fernandez are not exactly fierce ball shielders and prone to being dispossessed under pressure and in swift transitions, which Bellingham and Co could orchestrate. Out of possession, Mac Allister and Fernandez can sometimes be a burden. But both have a knack of scoring goals from improbable situations.

If the game boils down to durability and physicality, England would lick their lips in excitement. The caution: Argentina with their doggedness have worn down far superior physical teams.

Concerns on the wings

The right wing bothers both sides. England have a right-side concern. Winger Noni Madueke has pace, but lacks incisiveness, and has a tendency to lose the ball under pressure. His link-up between the right-back is dodgy, compounded by England's injury concerns. If Reece James, reduced to substitute shifts, starts and could sustain his intensity, England could be quicker and stronger on that side. But Ezri Konsa, while aerially superior, can be ponderous at times. Argentina's counterparts, Nahuel Molina and Gonzalo Montiel tend to run out of steam in less than an hour. Both Egypt and Switzerland exploited their susceptibility.



Argentine fans have the Muchachos on the tip of their tongues. AP

Egypt a few days ago in the city. He was waiting for his flight to Kansas for the quarterfinal. He briskly took his earphones out and said: "You should watch this without the earphones, and you feel you are in the stands again." He then recited almost the full chorus of Muchachos. He explained its connection among the fans: "It fills us

with energy and belief. It's something of an identity," he said, raising the volume, to the ire of a security guard's piercing glance. He doesn't stop, and she doesn't care. "Even if you are the only man in the stadium, or if I happen to be amidst non-Argentina fans, I will sing it. Even if it's the English fans," he says. But the reference of the

England chase not just a trophy, but a release from tragedy



David Beckham's sending off against Argentina in the 1998 World Cup was followed by England's Round of 16 elimination. REUTERS

Sandip G
Atlanta, July 14

THE MISSING piece. Harry Kane muttered the words with a forced smile. He was talking in the mixed zone, after defeating Norway, about England's quest to be crowned World Champions. Then the memories rolled in, his eyes shirked away from the cameras and wandered aimlessly.

If he had shut his eyes, he would have relived the worst moment of his life again. The silence of the Al Bayt Stadium when he blazed his penalty in against France in last edition's quarterfinal. In the press conference, he confided he will "probably remember it for the rest of my life."

In the next four years, he had detailed about how he had harnessed the bitterness from the episode to fuel him. But heartbreaks wouldn't forsake England. Two defeats in the Euro finals followed.

There is an English tragedy in most World Cups they have featured in since lifting the trophy in 1966. The Hand of God, Tears of Gazza; the David Beckham Brain-Fade; the Ronaldinho Worldie; the Harry Howler; the Wayne Rooney Petulance, the Frank Lampard Line-trimmer. Those are haunting memories, trapped in the nation's collective consciousness, waiting for a release.

So much so that a new version is sought, a fresh revelation is brought. Some teammates of Paul Gascoigne believe he acted selfishly, after copping a yellow card in the semi-final against Germany (1990) that ruled him out of the final if England qualified. He was so anguished that he refused to take the penalty in the shootout that England lost and was detached from the game since receiving the yellow card in the 100th minute.

Sensing his fragility, his manager Bobby Robson told him: "Look, I know you can't play in the final but what you can do is make sure all the other lads can. Just concentrate on that." But he was so devastated, or self-absorbed, he couldn't see beyond his misfortune. The nation fell in love with him, and he fell in love with the bottle.

A sense of fatalism, thus, looms every time England are in a knockout fixture, an

erie feeling that someone would end the night as a tragic hero, or a slice of irreversible misfortune would shatter them. But often they have let themselves down too, in tactics, mentality, and discipline.

No superstars

But Thomas Tuchel's batch arrived without that baggage, leaving behind an array of riches back home. There are no superstars in the group, just stars. Even their most decorated player Kane is not deified as Beckham or Lampard or Steven Gerrard. Jude Bellingham, the pin-up boy and a Real Madrid galactico, has not yet acquired the aura of Rooney. Perhaps, it has helped that the superstar culture had waned, or that both of them play club football outside the country.

In the course of the tournament, they have exuded a steeliness and flexibility the preceding brigades had not, a streak of doggedness to force their way, to find a solution, and to win the game, even if they hadn't functioned at their optimal capacity.

The red card to Jarell Quansah against Mexico seemed one of those classic freezing points. They flapped momentarily, shipped a goal, but produced a stirring rear-guard that reflected their doggedness, their endurance and the resolve to win.

Maybe, the fight came from the pain. This generation, more than any, knows the pain of losing finals. Six starters against Norway had started against Spain in the Euro finals two years ago; eight of them were in the squad that lost to Italy in 2021. John Stones, Jordan Pickford and Kane would remember the agony of Moscow.

"There's going to be moments where it doesn't quite go your way. But that motivated me to get better. For the team as well, we have suffered heartbreaks together," Kane said. There would be no better match to unburden the past than against Argentina in a semifinal. The curse that began with Diego Maradona's men could end with defeating Messi, denying him a final and title defence. It could make the Hand of God feel more tolerable, and all the tragedies more sufferable.

● SONG THAT GETS MESSI TO DANCE

Muchachos vs Wonderwall in battle of anthems, with Falklands looming large

Sandip G
Atlanta, July 14

A SCHOOLTEACHER in Buenos Aires, Fernando Romero, was cooking breakfast when the lines gushed out of his mind: "I was born in Argentina, land of Diego and Lionel, Of the kids from Malvinas, which I will never forget." He set the lyrics to the background score of a popular song Muchachos, composed by reggae and punk nine-piece band La Mosca Tsé-Tsé at the stroke of the century. What Argentines refer to as Islas Malvinas and claim sovereignty over, are the Falkland Islands - a self-governing British Overseas Territory now, but also the cause of the 10-week war in 1982.

Little did Romero then know that, in December 2020, a week after Maradona's death, his song would become his country's sporting anthem, rendered passionately by the fans in stadia, players in the locker room and by

masses in the streets.

Romero was not the first one to adapt the song which meant "Boys, we will get drunk"; several adaptations could be heard during club games in most stadia around Buenos Aires. But this became the most iconic one, and the band, disbanded several years ago, reunited to re-record the song with Romero's lyrics.

He wanted to sing during a World Cup qualifier between Argentina and Bolivia inside Estadio Monumental in Buenos Aires. But he couldn't procure tickets. He and his friends started singing the song outside the arena, which a local television crew captured and the original band members happened to watch and later re-recorded.

National recognition

The band won the equivalent of a national award and Romero was invited to sing this song to an audience that included Lionel Messi. His

only regret, he told Argentina media outlet EFE, he could not take a picture with Messi.

In the streets, people stop him and thank him. "They've told me that I did more for them with the song than the last 40 years of democracy," he told EFE. For this edition he tweaked the chorus again to suit the context.

"I want to win the third one, I want to be a world champion again." Messi, though prefers his original one penned for the 2022 World Cup. The song still resonates with the fans, and most of them have internalised the lines, and hum it in public spaces.

In fan zones, parks, supermarkets and airports, flooded with Argentinians for the semi-final against England on Wednesday, fans have the song on the tip of their tongues. In the corner of Atlanta airport, Lorenzo Alberto was watching a reel his friend had sent him from Argentina's round-of-16 bout against

Sindhu sails into Japan Open second round; SatChi pull out



PV Sindhu defeated Wong Ling Ching in straight games. FILE

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, July 14

SATWIKSAIRAJ RAN-KIREDDY’S recurring shoulder problem forced him and Chirag Shetty to retire from their Japan Open opener even as P V Sindhu eased into the women’s singles second round with a straight-game win over Malaysia’s Wong Ling Ching here on Tuesday.

The world No.4 Indian pair, who ended a two-year title drought by winning the Singapore Open but had to withdraw from Indonesia Open last month, retired after losing the opening game 19-21 to Denmark’s Daniel Lundgaard and Mads Vestergaard.

Chief doubles coach Tan Kim Her said the Indian duo will be skipping the China Open next week and focus on rehabilitation to get back to shape for the home World Championships in August.

"It still needs some time to recover. We have at least four weeks to get back in shape ahead of World Championships," Tan said.

Compact performance

Two-time Olympic-medallist Sindhu, who is currently world no. 10, produced a compact performance to notch up a 21-14 21-11 win over 37th-ranked Wong Ling Ching of Malaysia in the opening round of the BWF Super 750 event.

India’s Dhruv Kapila and Tanisha Crasto too advanced to the second round after defeating Scotland’s Alexander Dunn and Julie Macpherson 21-16, 21-14 in their mixed doubles opener. However, Rohan Kapoor and Ruthvika Shivani Gadde bowed out in the opening round after losing 11-21, 10-21 to top seeds Feng Yan Zhe and Huang Dong Ping of China.

One day for the captain

Skipper scores 80 before retiring, leaving Axar & Washington to seal 6-wicket win

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, July 14

FOR THE first time on this UK trip, India tasted victory. The format was different and so were the personnel, but none illustrated better than Jasprit Bumrah what they had been lacking in the T20Is.

In the presence of the pace spearhead, Prasidh Krishna appeared a different bowler before the batting unit led by skipper Shubman Gill pulled off a convincing six-wicket win on a testing Edgbaston surface. Securing the win was Axar Patel’s (4/62 and 57 not out) all-round efforts, which should do a world of good to his confidence that appeared to have taken a few blows off late.

That the team got the job done despite Rohit Sharma (11) and Virat Kohli (5) hardly contributing would give them confidence as all through this UK summer they have struggled to get used to the conditions. Setting up the chase of 259 was Gill, who until he retired hurt with cramps for 80 off 75 deliveries, appeared the best batsman on show. He adjusted wonderfully to a surface where the extra bounce troubled everyone. That he found the confidence to walk down the pitch showed how assured he was.

After the two senior pros departed, Gill forged a 101-run stand with his deputy Shreyas Iyer off 103 deliveries that tilted the game in India’s favour. Once the captain departed, there was a brief stutter with Iyer running himself out and KL Rahul dragging one back onto the stumps. But Washington Sundar and Axar, picked over frontline spinner Kuldeep Yadav, completed the job with grinding knocks that adapted to the situation. Axar wasn’t at his best with the ball, as he struggled for rhythm in the middle, but his unbeaten half-century showed why India value him.

Gill’s innings was a reminder that there could still be a place for him in T20Is, particularly when India are scheduled



Shubman Gill scored 80 from 75 balls before returning to the pavilion due to cramps. CREIMAS

Gill’s innings was a reminder that there could still be a place for him in T20Is, particularly when India are scheduled to play most of their series overseas.

to play most of their series overseas. His numbers in the IPL support his case. There is still some work to be done, particularly with regards to the make-up of this batting line-up, but unlike the T20s where India prefer a left-right combination at all points, in ODIs they seem to prefer the ones who will get the job done.

Like his predecessor Rohit, he led the charge, before Iyer settled himself as England hesitated to use leg-spinner Adil Rashid. They eventually turned to him, but didn’t get joy.

Bumrah returns

It was with the ball that India found plenty of encouraging signs. Not ready to compromise on depth in batting or bowling, India had three all-rounders – Axar, Washington and Shivam Dube. It meant there was no space for Kuldeep, whose absence was felt in the second half of England’s innings after the pacers had

run through the top and middle order.

Winning the toss and batting first, England innings was a roller-coaster. From 60 for no loss, they were reduced to 80/5 in the space of 26 deliveries by Bumrah, Prasidh Krishna and Gurnoor Brar. It would eventually become 107/6 by the 22nd over before England found Joe Root (76 not out) and Liam Dawson (68) stopped the slide and put the hosts in a situation from where they could post a total beyond India’s reach. But a late collapse, from 250/7 to 258 all out with Root left stranded with 13 deliveries remaining in the innings, dented their chances.

On a pitch that had some juice, playing his first ODI since the 2023 World Cup final, Bumrah was in his element straight-away having Ben Duckett in all sorts of problems. The pace and movement through the air and off the pitch repeatedly tested the left-hander, and Prasidh at the other end was equally tough to negate with his extra bounce.

It was only when Brar came on in the eighth over that England broke the shackles, but that was only for four overs before India broke through.

In his third over, Brar removed both openers – the extra bounce being the common factor. Bumrah then began his second spell by having Harry

Brook nick one to first slip before Prasidh removed Jos Buttler and Sam Curran to expansive shots.

Combination rethink

India went for the kill, but once the pitch eased down and Dube dropped a regulation catch offered by Root off his own bowling, the tide changed. Perhaps, India need a rethink of their combination that opens a spot for Kuldeep.

To make up for batting depth, they have been pinning their hopes on Harshit Rana, but his fitness remains a major concern. Returning to the team after a long lay-off, he didn’t even last the entire T20 leg, returning home with a hamstring injury. It means they are short of pacers who can be handy with the bat. Hence, they were forced to play both Washington and Axar, two spinners who may have to play a restricting role rather than looking for wickets. The left-arm spinner had four wickets to show on the day, but most of them were lower-order batters.

BRIEF SCORES: England 258 all out in 47.5 overs (Liam Dawson 68, Joe Root 76 not out; Axar Patel 4/62, Prasidh Krishna 2/50) lost to India 262/4 in 45.2 overs (Shubman Gill 80 retired hurt, Axar Patel 57 not out, Washington Sundar 52 not out; Josh Tongue 1/50).

Rohit’s opening template has gone and so has the certainty

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, July 14

THERE IS something Rohit Sharma needs more than runs at the moment. It is the assurance that his place is safe for now as far as the plans for the 2027 World Cup are concerned. Since announcing his retirement from Test cricket ahead of the Australia tour last October, Rohit’s string of scores in ODIs before the IPL read: 8, 73, 121*, 57, 14, 75, 26, 24 and 11 against South Africa and New Zealand.

This season, which began with a cloud of uncertainty around his future darker than ever, he had returns of 16, 48 and 79 against Afghanistan.

On Tuesday, at Edgbaston, he was dismissed for 11 off 21 deliveries.

More than the runs, the noticeable change is that the attacking template which set the tone at the 2023 World Cup has quietly disappeared. It was Rohit who, back in 2022, gauged the trend in white-ball cricket and laid a blueprint that India followed through to the T20 World Cup. The plan was simple: go on the offence from the word go.

Stunning assaults

At the 2023 Asia Cup and World Cup, he ensured games were taken control of by India in the batting powerplay, his stunning assaults making the job easier for the rest to follow.

Even at the 2025 Champions Trophy, on challenging conditions in Dubai, he would not go back on the template. All of this was possible because, as captain, he knew his spot was secured. In the event of failure, there was nothing to worry about.

But times have clearly changed. The same freedom has not been visible in Rohit’s batting of late. In its place is a batsman who needs runs next to his name, runs that would keep him not just in discussion but hard to ignore.

What it has caused is a different version of Rohit, one who appears to be reverting to his old formula of starting watchfully before shifting gears rapidly as he prolongs his stay in the middle. It is what brought him three double centuries in the format and a string of daddy hundreds, including in England and Australia.

That formula was so captivating that Virat Kohli, who had built his own successful ODI



Rohit Sharma tried to hit a lofted cover drive but ended up losing his wicket for 11 runs from 21 balls at Edgbaston. CREIMAS



Virat Kohli scored 5 runs before falling to Jofra Archer. CREIMAS

template, replicated it against South Africa and New Zealand. For a batsman who had been conservative at the start and rarely went aerial, he began to play bold, charge at the pacers, and take a full-blooded swing. All of it happened regularly when he walked in during the powerplay, and once the first powerplay was done, he milked runs effortlessly. It was a clear sign of a template being embraced by everyone.

No man’s land

Instead, the two are in no man’s land as far as their World Cup futures are concerned, Rohit more so.

Chasing 259 for their first win of the tour on a challenging Edgbaston pitch, his knock was filled with caution. Perhaps the extra bounce the seamers extracted all day made him play

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with restraint. But when Shubman Gill showed intent at the other end, one wondered what the Rohit of 2023 would have done. He preferred to take risks. He did not hesitate to charge at the bowlers. Here, instead, Rohit appeared tentative, played a couple of false shots, before falling while charging the medium pace of Sam Curran.

And then came Kohli. Of late he has looked intent on attack, and the urgency with which he pulled Archer, so quick on the seamer’s pace that it raced away to fine leg, suggested the same. A battle loomed.

Kohli, perhaps anticipating the short ball, went deep in his crease. Archer responded with a sucker punch, full, shaping in, thudding into the pads. Archer appealed. The umpire’s finger went up as Nasser Hussain said: "Kohli comes, Kohli goes." The task of finishing it was left to Gill and the middle order.

As for Rohit, he had walked off mouthing to himself, bat swinging through the line of where the ball had been, showing himself how he should have played it.

{ WORLD CUP }

The dichotomy of Tuchel: A fantastic coach but difficult person to work with

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, July 14

"YEAH, WELL, whatever."

Jude Bellingham had just scored both of England’s goals in a 2-1 extra-time win over Norway. It sent the team into the World Cup semi-final, the first goal standing despite Norwegian protests it struck an overhead camera cable in the build-up. Thomas Tuchel (pronounce: Toe-mazs Too-kh-uhl) in the post-match interview, called the win "lucky" and the performance "sloppy." Told what his manager had said, Bellingham didn’t dress it up. "Maybe he doesn’t know what it’s like to play in those kind of conditions against Erling Haaland, Ødegaard, Nusa, Sorloth," he said.

It wasn’t the first time. Tuchel had already apologised once for describing Bellingham’s on-field behaviour as "repulsive." "If he smiles, he wins everyone," he’d said. "But sometimes you see the rage, the hunger and the fire and it comes out in a way that can be a bit repulsive, for example, for my mother when she sits in front of the TV," calling him, in the same breath, "a special boy."

The German coach later said he’d used the word "unintentionally," in his second language. Months on, substituted while visibly furious, Bellingham got the answer he’s had before: "That’s the decision, and he has to accept the decision," Tuchel said. "We will not change our decision just because someone waves their arms."



England head coach Thomas Tuchel (L). AP

Borussia Dortmund’s chief executive, Hans-Joachim Watzke, who worked with Tuchel for two years, summarised him in eight words: "A fantastic coach but a difficult person."

Down but not out

Dortmund sacked Tuchel in 2017, days after he won the German Cup, once Marcel Schmelzer and Marco Reus distanced themselves from his decision to leave Nuri Sahin out of the squad. The trophy didn’t save him. Neither, later, did a Champions League title at Chelsea, where, per journalist Simon Phillips, around 70 per cent of the squad wanted out.

Tuchel was in his mid-twenties when a knee injury ended his playing career at SSV Ulm in 1998. Out of football and needing money, he pursued an MBA and took a job at a Stuttgart bar, collecting glasses, then mixing

cocktails. He might have stayed there, if his old Ulm coach, Ralf Rangnick hadn’t tracked down where he’d ended up and offered him a youth-coaching job. Tuchel was reluctant, until, mid-shift at the bar, he heard Ulm had just been promoted to the Bundesliga. "I always wanted to get to the Bundesliga, and now they are living my dream," he told *Die Zeit*. He left work shortly afterward.

By 2000 he coached Stuttgart’s youth teams. In 2004, his under-19 side beat VfL Bochum to the German championship. It changed nothing. Stuttgart still didn’t renew Tuchel’s contract afterward. He moved to Augsburg’s under-19s, and by 2009, Mainz 05 hired him as head coach. Dortmund, PSG, Chelsea, Bayern Munich followed.

England hired him on an 18-month contract that ran only to this World Cup, since extended

Tuchel has said England suits him better than home ever did. At this World Cup, he left out Palmer, Foden, Maguire and Trent, prioritising tactical shape

through Euro 2028. Philipp Lahm, wrote in *The Athletic* that wherever Tuchel has worked, "at some point there always seems to be tension. It’s never down to tactics, but rather to interpersonal relationships."

Tuchel has said England suits him better than home ever did. "I feel that we are very critical of each other in Germany," he said, "especially with players and coaches." At this World Cup, he left out Cole Palmer, Phil Foden, Harry Maguire and, again, Trent Alexander-Arnold, prioritising tactical shape over reputation. Tuchel’s explanation: "We are trying to select and build the best possible team, which is not necessarily selecting and collecting the 26 most talented players. Teams win championships."

Bellingham has moved past Saturday’s exchange, saying simply that "all of the players have put in a very tough shift." England are in the semi-final regardless. Whether the tension between the two men resolves, or repeats, as Lahm suggested it always does, is the question this tournament will answer.

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, July 14

JORGE LUIS Borges, the Argentine writer, once dismissed football with disdain, saying it was popular because 'stupidity is popular.' It was perhaps the most futile act of resistance in Argentine cultural history. Buenos Aires simply carried on loving football. It argued over it in cafes, lived through it on Sundays and organised entire neighbourhoods around it. As football writer Jonathan Wilson notes in *Angels with Dirty Faces*, football became the city’s common language, discussing the seriousness of politics and the timorousness of family.

London’s relationship with the game is no less profound, only expressed differently. If Buenos Aires made football the subject of endless conversation, London made it part of the city’s fabric. Every weekend, the Underground is taken over by the supporters, each line heading towards a different corner of the English capital, where clubs have come to embody neighbourhoods and traditions.

One city debates football as an idea; the other lives it through institutions that have shaped the modern game. Which is why England against Argentina has always been about more than history. Behind the familiar prism of war, politics and Diego Maradona lies another, richer contest – between two great football cultures, represented by their capitals.

London and Buenos Aires



A Lionel Messi mural in Argentina’s capital Buenos Aires. AP

have each shaped football in their own image. One built the structures of the modern game. The other gave it a language of imagination, identity and romance. London likes to think it is where modern football grew up. It is difficult to argue otherwise. The Football Association codified the game’s laws in England. Professional leagues flourished there.

Depending on promotion and relegation, London routinely has around a dozen professional clubs across England’s top divisions. Football here became part of civic life. Boroughs found identities in clubs. Saturdays were organised around fixtures. The game acquired structure, rituals and institutions.

Humanising football

If London institutionalised football, Buenos Aires humanised it. The Argentine capital is home to more than 35 professional clubs, an astonishing concentration that has made the city

arguably the world’s greatest football metropolis. Around a third of Argentina’s professional clubs are based there.

The city’s football map is almost indistinguishable from its street map. La Boca belongs to Boca Juniors. Nunez belongs to River Plate. Almagro has San Lorenzo. La Paternal has Argentinos Juniors. And so on. Almost every barrio has a club to call its own, and with it a fiercely guarded identity handed down through generations.

The irony, too, is hard to miss. Argentina learnt football from Britain. Railway engineers, dock workers, merchants and teachers carried the game across the Atlantic in the late 19th century. Many of the earliest clubs bore unmistakably British names, and for a while football remained largely an expatriate pastime. Then Buenos Aires made it its own. Wilson argues that somewhere between the railways and the *potreros* – the vacant neighbourhood lots

where children played without coaches or perfectly manicured pitches – the game stopped being English and became unmistakably Argentine.

The *potrero* occupies an almost mythical place in Argentina’s football imagination. Uneven surfaces, broken fences and makeshift goals rewarded ingenuity over instruction. Children learnt balance because the ground demanded it, close control because the ball rarely bounced true, and deception because the quickest way past bigger opponents was with a feint rather than force.

From those neighbourhood pitches emerged *la nuestra* – "our way" – a football philosophy that prized imagination, improvisation and technique over rigid systems. As Eduardo Galeano notes in *Football in Sun and Shadow*, "On the playing fields of Buenos Aires, a style came into being... players created their own language in tiny space where they chose to retain and possess the ball rather than kick it, as if their feet were hands braiding leather together."

That is what makes Wednesday’s semifinal so compelling. Beyond merely the weight of old scores or famous goals, it is the meeting of two capitals that have shaped football.

One is home to pubs where every borough has its club. The other is home to cafés where every conversation eventually returns to football. One exported the game. The other exported its romance. And perhaps that is the rivalry’s richest story of all.